

REQUEST FOR PROPOSALS

Consulting Services

—

Enterprise AI Adoption & Enablement

Addendum No. 1

RFP 739-SL3821039



TEXAS TECH UNIVERSITY
HEALTH SCIENCES CENTER™

Addendum No. 1

Consulting Services

—

Enterprise AI Adoption & Enablement

AMENDMENT (1)

Section 2.4 - Anticipated Term, which previously read:

The anticipated term of any resulting agreement will begin on the date an agreement is executed, and expire on August 31, 2027.

Is deleted in its entirety and replaced with the following:

The anticipated term of any resulting agreement will begin on the date an agreement is executed, and expire on March 31, 2028.

AMENDMENT (2)

Section 5.4 - Services Specifications, paragraph entitled “Project Schedule:”, which previously read:

TTUHSC desires to operate in accordance with the following schedule. These dates are for planning purposes and subject to change:

- Kick-off meeting:
- Completion of Deliverable 1: _____
- Completion of Deliverable 2: _____
- Completion of Deliverable 3: _____
- Completion of Deliverable 4: _____
- Completion of Deliverable 5: _____
- Completion of Deliverable 6: _____

Is deleted in its entirety and replaced with the following:

TTUHSC desires to operate in accordance with the following schedule. These dates are for planning purposes and subject to change:

- Kick-off meeting: February 2027;
- Completion of Deliverable 1: April 2027;
- Completion of Deliverable 2: April 2027;
- Completion of Deliverable 3: September 2027;
- Completion of Deliverable 4: September 2027;
- Completion of Deliverable 5: December 2027;
- Completion of Deliverable 6: February 2028.

AMENDMENT (3)

Section 6.1 Pricing for Services Offered:, which previously read:

1. Provide a “not to exceed” fixed fee for each of the deliverables including associated fees (i.e. printing costs, attendance at meetings, travel), for the Consulting Services - Enterprise AI Adoption & Enablement. A schedule should be included to document the level of effort used to derive the quoted fixed fee.
2. An hourly resource rate card by resource type (e.g., Project Manager, Analyst) valid through August 31, 2027 which will be used as the basis for change orders.

Is deleted in its entirety and replaced with the following:

1. Provide a “not to exceed” fixed fee for each of the deliverables including associated fees (i.e. printing costs, attendance at meetings, travel), for the Consulting Services - Enterprise AI Adoption & Enablement. A schedule should be included to document the level of effort used to derive the quoted fixed fee.
2. An hourly resource rate card by resource type (e.g., Project Manager, Analyst) valid through March 31, 2028 which will be used as the basis for change orders.

RESPONSE TO QUESTIONS

The following responses to participant questions are fully incorporated into RFP 739-SL3821039.

Question	TTUHSC Response
1. Section 3.7 states a VetHUB Subcontracting Plan is required and that TTUHSC has determined subcontracting opportunities are probable under this RFP. Appendix A Section 1.1.6 provides that the selected proposer will not delegate its duties or responsibilities to any subcontractor except as expressly provided in the Agreement. Please confirm the required HSP method and supporting documentation where the proposer is itself a Texas certified Historically Underutilized Business with veteran designation and intends to self perform one hundred percent of the Services with no subcontracting. Specifically, please confirm whether such a proposer completes the self performance justification in lieu of the good faith effort subcontractor solicitation and notice requirements, and identify which sections of the Appendix C form must be completed in that circumstance.	As described the Proposer would complete and submit on the basis of the self performance justification.
2. Section 5.4(E) states the Contractor shall provide solutions via a software platform, managed analytics services, or integrated reporting tools, and the Overview states the specification does not mandate a single proprietary methodology or commercial software delivery mechanism. Please confirm that a managed analytics and reporting service, built on TTUHSC's existing enterprise AI telemetry and reporting tools rather than a separately licensed contractor platform, is a responsive approach to Deliverable 5. If TTUHSC has a preference for a licensed platform, please indicate whether platform license costs should be priced inside the Deliverable 5 not to exceed fixed fee under Section 6.1 or presented as a separate line.	- A solution that meets the requirements and built on TTUHSC existing enterprise AI telemetry would be considered responsive. - TTUHSC does not have a preference as to how this specification would be met. - Costing for any solution offered is at the discretion of the Proposer. Cost breakdown within a deliverable line or a separate cost line is not a differentiator for TTUHSC reviewers. Please ensure costing is clear and discernable to the evaluating reader.
3. Section 5.2 lists compliance with the Texas Risk and Authorization Management Program (TX-RAMP) "as may be required." Section 5.4(E) permits adoption and impact analytics to be delivered via a software platform, managed analytics services, or integrated reporting tools. Please confirm whether TX-RAMP certification is required where a proposer delivers Deliverable 5 as a managed analytics and reporting service operating within TTUHSC's existing enterprise environment and approved tooling, with no contractor hosted cloud service and no institutional data leaving TTUHSC controlled systems. If TX-RAMP would still apply in that delivery model, please identify the	Under Texas Government Code § 2054.0593 and Texas Department of Information Resources guidelines, TX-RAMP applies specifically to Cloud Service Providers offering hosted cloud computing services (SaaS, PaaS, IaaS). As described in Question 3 specifically, Deliverable 5 is executed strictly as a professional/managed service operating inside TTUHSC's approved enterprise environment, using TTUHSC's certified infrastructure and tooling, and keeping all institutional data on-premise systems, the managed service itself is not classified as an out-of-scope third-party cloud product.

applicable certification level and the required timing relative to award.	
4. Has TTUHSC established a budget, appropriation, or not-to-exceed amount for the Services described in Section 5.4? If a specific figure cannot be published, would TTUHSC indicate a range so that proposers can calibrate the depth and sequencing of the six deliverables appropriately?	The cost shall not exceed \$750,000.
5. Section 2.4 states that the anticipated term expires August 31, 2027, and Section 2.3 shows evaluation continuing through November 30, 2026. Does TTUHSC expect all six deliverables to be completed within that remaining window, and does TTUHSC anticipate renewal, extension, or a follow-on term beyond August 31, 2027 for continuing enablement and adoption support?	TTUHSC is seeking the completion of all deliverables and will work collaboratively in constructing a contract term that accommodates that position.
6. Section 4.8.1 reserves the right to award an agreement for all or any portion of the requirements, or to award multiple agreements. Will TTUHSC consider a phased award, or an award covering a subset of the six deliverables? If so, should the Pricing Schedule be structured so that individual deliverables can be selected independently?	It is TTUHSC's intention to issue a single award, however in accordance with the terms of the RFP, reserves the right to award an agreement for all or any portion of the requirements proposed by reason of this request, award multiple agreements, or to reject any and all proposals if deemed to be in the best interests of TTUHSC and to resolicit for proposals, or temporarily or permanently abandon the solicitation.
7. If the full scope described in Requirements A through G cannot be delivered at full depth within the initial term, which requirement areas does TTUHSC regard as the highest priority for the first phase of work?	TTUHSC is seeking the completion of all deliverables and will work collaboratively in constructing a contract term that accommodates that position.
8. Section 5.4 notes that TTUHSC has already provisioned enterprise AI tools including large language models and embedded AI productivity assistants. Which tools are currently licensed and deployed, and is a systems integrator, reseller, or implementation partner presently engaged in adoption, training, or governance work that the Contractor would be expected to coordinate with?	- Microsoft Copilot is currently the enterprise generative AI tool that has been deployed. Other GenAI tools are being evaluated. Examples of other tools provided enterprise-wide include Zoom AI Companion, Epic, Grammarly, etc. - There is no incumbent systems integrator, reseller, or implementation partner engaged; there is no incumbent vendor engaged to provide these consulting services.
9. Requirement E.4 describes ROI modeling and verification using TTUHSC supplied baseline metrics and assumptions. Are those baseline metrics presently established? Will they be made available to proposers during this solicitation, or provided to the successful Contractor at kickoff?	- Baseline metrics have not been established. TTUHSC conducted some AI baseline surveys in 2025 and 2026, but the Contractor is expected to bring a method for measuring the baseline and, later, the ROI. - Baselines are not established today; they will be provided to the successful Contractor at kickoff where available, and the Contractor is expected to establish the measurement framework.
10. Has TTUHSC completed any prior AI readiness or maturity assessment, acceptable use directive, governance policy, or inventory of AI use cases that the Contractor should build upon rather than originate?	- TTUHSC has some governance structure already in place and seeks to align with both the NIST AI Risk Management Framework and the Texas DIR framework. TTUHSC has a responsible AI use policy (OP 52.21) and maintains an active AI tool inventory. - No formal maturity or readiness assessment exists; the Contractor is expected to conduct the first baseline assessment and build upon the existing inventory and policy rather than originate everything from scratch.
11. Approximately how many employees fall within the scope of the Requirement C workforce upskilling program, and how are they distributed across the five campuses and across the functional domains named in C.1 (procurement, finance, clinical administration, academic operations)? Approximately how many leaders are anticipated for the Requirement B.1 leadership education sessions?	- Total number of employees: about 6,000. Abilene: ~100; Amarillo: ~700; Dallas: ~90; Lubbock: ~3,710; Permian Basin: ~600; Strategic Initiatives (Correctional Managed Care): ~800. - Functional domains (some groups overlap): Clinical: ~2,000; Academic: ~2,000; Research: ~1,300; Other (Admin, Operational, Supporting): ~2,000. - Number of leaders: around 150-200. - The initial rollout will target about 3,000 individuals.
12. Requirement D.1 refers to evaluating functional departmental processes for AI-driven redesign, and the Objective in Section 5.4 references clinical operational units. Please confirm whether the clinical element of	The clinical scope may extend to clinical decision support, diagnostic, and patient-facing applications. Any solution must comply with applicable regulatory requirements, with human-in-the-loop controls and clinical validation before any production clinical deployment.

scope is limited to administrative and operational workflows, or whether it is intended to extend to clinical decision support, diagnostic, or patient-facing applications.	
13. Requirement A.4 calls for a governance framework addressing permissible use, data privacy, IP management, algorithmic accountability, and risk mitigation. Does TTUHSC expect the framework to be aligned to a specified external reference, such as the NIST AI Risk Management Framework or Texas Department of Information Resources guidance, or is the Contractor to propose the governance structure?	• TTUHSC has some governance structure already in place and seeks to align with both the NIST AI Risk Management Framework and the Texas DIR framework. TTUHSC has a responsible AI use policy (OP 52.21) and maintains an active AI tool inventory. • The Contractor is to propose the governance structure, aligned to the NIST AI RMF and the Texas DIR framework, building on OP 52.21 rather than replacing it.
14. Deliverable 5 describes an Analytics and ROI Reporting Dashboard or Service, and Requirement E permits delivery via a software platform, managed analytics services, or integrated reporting tools. Would TTUHSC accept an analytics and reporting capability built and operated inside TTUHSC's own Microsoft 365 and Azure environment, with all institutional data remaining under TTUHSC control and no Contractor-hosted service, in place of a vendor platform? The same question applies to the institutional knowledge repository in Requirement C.5.	• Yes. An analytics and reporting capability built and operated inside TTUHSC's own Microsoft 365 and Azure environment, with all institutional data remaining under TTUHSC control and no Contractor-hosted service, is acceptable. Power BI is available. The same applies to the institutional knowledge repository, which may leverage existing TTUHSC systems (e.g., SharePoint/Teams).
15. Section 5.2 states that the Proposer is to be compliant with the Texas Risk and Authorization Management Program as may be required. Please confirm whether TX-RAMP certification is required for this procurement and, if so, which components of the scope it applies to, given that professional consulting services which do not host or process institutional data on Contractor-operated cloud infrastructure fall outside the program's stated scope.	• Under Texas Government Code § 2054.0593 and Texas Department of Information Resources guidelines, TX-RAMP applies specifically to Cloud Service Providers offering hosted cloud computing services (SaaS, PaaS, IaaS). • If a proposal does not include the above, TX-RAMP likely would not apply.
16. Will Protected Health Information be made available to the Contractor in the course of this engagement, or will data provided be limited to de-identified, administrative, and operational information? Is execution of the Business Associate Agreement expected at award in either case?	• PHI is not expected to be made available; TTUHSC has test patient data that may be used, and data will be made available based on need. Where any PHI is involved, the Business Associate Agreement would apply. • The Business Associate Agreement would be executed where the approved scope of work requires access to PHI; it is included so that it is in place if PHI access is required.
17. Section 1.53.11 of the Business Associate Agreement restricts access to, transmission of, and storage of PHI beyond the boundaries and jurisdiction of the United States absent written authorization. Please confirm whether this restriction is intended to apply to PHI only, or to all institutional data provided under the Agreement, so that proposers can staff and price accordingly.	• This restriction applies to all institutional data.
18. Given that TTUHSC operates across five campuses spanning a large geography, is onsite facilitation required? If so, at which campuses and at approximately what frequency? Would TTUHSC accept a predominantly virtual delivery model with onsite presence concentrated at defined milestones such as executive alignment sessions and leadership workshops?	• TTUHSC expects some on-site presence but does not have strict requirements for delivery frequency or duration. A predominantly virtual/hybrid model is acceptable, with on-site presence concentrated at defined milestones such as executive alignment sessions and leadership workshops. The initial kickoff is preferred on all campuses (negotiable), and the leadership enablement meeting is preferred on-site in Lubbock, TX. Overall, a hybrid model is preferred. Travel is to be included in the fee.
19. Section 6.1 requires a not-to-exceed fixed fee for each deliverable inclusive of associated fees such as printing, meeting attendance, and travel. May travel and expenses be shown as a separately itemized not-to-exceed line within each deliverable total, so that TTUHSC can evaluate the professional services component distinctly?	• Costing for any solution offered is at the discretion of the Proposer. Cost breakdown within a deliverable line or a separate cost line is not a differentiator for TTUHSC reviewers. Please ensure costing is clear and discernable to the evaluating reader.
20. Does TTUHSC impose a page limit, minimum font size, or file format requirement on the proposal or on any individual section? Section 5.3 does not specify one, and we wish to avoid submitting a response that is	• No limit exists as a requirement under the RFP. Please ensure proposals are clear and discernable to the evaluating reader.

longer or shorter than TTUHSC's evaluation team would prefer.	
21. Section 5.3 requires at least three references from current or recent clients whose specifications and requirements are most similar to those in this RFP. Should these be three separate client organizations? Will TTUHSC consider references from public sector clients outside higher education and healthcare where the scope of services, scale, and institutional complexity are comparable?	- The intention is to request three “separate” reference clients. - References provided are at the discretion of the Proposer and can be from any sector that compares favorably to the services requested within this RFP.
22. Section 3.7 states that TTUHSC has determined subcontracting opportunities are probable under this RFP. Would a self-performing HUB Subcontracting Plan, documenting that the Proposer will perform the entire contract with its own personnel and resources, be considered responsive? Is there a HUB participation goal or target percentage applicable to this procurement, and does TTUHSC maintain or recommend a list of certified HUB or veteran-owned vendors under NIGP commodity code 91878 with capability in AI enablement, training delivery, or change management?	- A completed VetHub Subcontracting Plan indicating Proposer self performance is responsive. - VetHUB goals, etc., can be viewed here: https://www.fiscal.ttuhs.edu/purchasing/hub/findavendor.aspx - The VetHUB directory is maintained by the Texas Comptroller and does not identify services to that level of granularity (“AI enablement, training delivery, or change management”).
23. Section 1.3 of the Agreement provides that all writings, reports, and materials produced by Consultant are works made for hire owned by University. Will TTUHSC consider a clarification confirming that University owns all deliverables and work product created under the Agreement, while Consultant retains ownership of the pre-existing methodologies, frameworks, and templates it uses to produce them, licensed to University for its unrestricted internal use? Relatedly, please confirm that Section 1.4 is directed at University property and is not intended to restrict Consultant's own pre-existing materials.	- Please note from Section 7 – GENERAL TERMS AND CONDITIONS. <i>If Proposer takes exception to any of the Required Terms, Proposer will submit a list of the exceptions as part of its proposal.</i> - Section 1.4 is referencing University property.
24. Section 1.7 of the Agreement and Section 1.1.9 of the Execution of Offer provide for indemnification without stated limitation. Will TTUHSC consider a mutually agreeable cap on Consultant's aggregate liability under the Agreement? Will TTUHSC accept defense conducted by Consultant's own counsel, subject to TTUHSC's reasonable approval, rather than counsel approved in advance by TTUHSC?	Please note from Section 7 – GENERAL TERMS AND CONDITIONS. <i>If Proposer takes exception to any of the Required Terms, Proposer will submit a list of the exceptions as part of its proposal.</i>
25. Hosting Approach for Deliverables D and E: Would a Proposer's solution for Deliverable D (Workflow Automation & Agentic Strategy) and Deliverable E (Analytics & ROI) be considered compliant — without requiring independent TX-RAMP certification by the Proposer — if it is built and operated entirely within TTUHSC's own existing, already-licensed cloud environment (e.g., TTUHSC's Microsoft 365/Azure tenant), rather than as a separately hosted platform?	Yes. A solution built and operated entirely within TTUHSC's own existing, already-licensed cloud environment (e.g., TTUHSC's Microsoft 365/Azure tenant), rather than as a separately hosted platform, would not independently trigger TX-RAMP certification by the Proposer. Where a proposal includes a contractor-hosted cloud service, TX-RAMP would apply.
26. Deliverable D Scope and Pricing Structure: For purposes of the not-to-exceed fixed fee required under Section 6.1.1, would it be acceptable for the "functional prototypes" referenced in Section 5.4-D to be scoped as proof-of-concept-level demonstrations validated in a limited or test environment (rather than production-hardened systems), with the number of prototypes determined through the Deliverable A and D discovery process and defined within the fixed fee — and any additional prototypes or complexity identified beyond that defined scope addressed through the hourly rate card as a change order under Section 6.1.2?	- TTUHSC is planning to have at least two workflows/use cases from each functional area (Academic, Clinical, Research, and Admin) evaluated by the Contractor, for a total of about 8 to 10 workflows. Solutions should be either pilot-ready or fully production-ready; the associated cost should not be included in the fixed fee but may be listed as an optional item for TTUHSC to consider. - Prototypes may be scoped as proof-of-concept demonstrations validated in a limited/test environment, with the number determined through discovery and defined within the fixed fee; additional prototypes or complexity beyond that scope may be handled through the hourly rate card as a change order.

27. AI Tool Use by Proposer: Does the data-use restriction in Section 5.4-F, which prohibits use of TTUHSC institutional data to train or fine-tune AI models, apply specifically to TTUHSC's institutional data, or does it also restrict a Proposer's internal use of general-purpose AI tools for tasks such as drafting deliverables, where no TTUHSC data is entered into those tools?	Section 5.4-F applies to TTUHSC institutional data and does not prohibit a Proposer's internal use of AI-enabled tool. However, the Proposer must ensure that TTUHSC institutional data, confidential information, protected health information (PHI), personally identifiable information (PII), or other TTUHSC-sensitive information is not submitted to, processed by, or used to train any artificial intelligence systems unless expressly authorized in writing by TTUHSC.
28. PHI Scope by Deliverable: Which of the six deliverables under Section 5.4 does TTUHSC anticipate will involve Protected Health Information (subject to the Business Associate Agreement at Appendix A), as distinct from FERPA-covered or other institutional data?	PHI is not expected to be made available for any deliverable; TTUHSC has test patient data that may be used. Where any deliverable requires PHI access, the Business Associate Agreement would apply. FERPA-covered and other institutional data will be provided based on need.
29. Deliverable E Data Scope: What source systems does TTUHSC anticipate making available for adoption and usage analytics under Deliverable E (e.g., AI tool usage reporting, learning management system data), and what is the approximate scale of the covered user population?	- Total number of employees: about 6,000. Abilene: ~100; Amarillo: ~700; Dallas: ~90; Lubbock: ~3,710; Permian Basin: ~600; Strategic Initiatives (Correctional Managed Care): ~800. - Functional domains (some groups overlap): Clinical: ~2,000; Academic: ~2,000; Research: ~1,300; Other (Admin, Operational, Supporting): ~2,000. Number of leaders: around 150-200. - The initial rollout will target about 3,000 individuals. - Source systems for adoption/usage analytics (e.g., AI tool usage reporting, LMS data) will be made available based on need; Access to telemetry data will be provided to the Contractor if needed.
30. Project Schedule Section 5.4 leaves the kickoff and Deliverables 1–6 milestone dates blank. Please provide TTUHSC's anticipated contract execution date, kickoff date, and desired completion date for each deliverable.	- The following proposed Project Schedule may change based on RFP progress: - Kick-off meeting: February 2027; - Deliverable 1: April 2027; - Deliverable 2: April 2027; - Deliverable 3: September 2027; - Deliverable 4: September 2027; - Deliverable 5: December 2027; - Deliverable 6: February 2028. - TTUHSC is seeking completion of all deliverables and will work collaboratively in constructing a contract term that accommodates that position. - Proposers may propose their own timeline within the term; TTUHSC will work collaboratively on sequencing and dependencies.
31. Budget Range Does TTUHSC have an anticipated budget or budget range for this engagement that may be shared with proposers?	The cost shall not exceed \$750,000.
32. Population and Organizational Scope Approximately how many employees, faculty, clinicians, researchers, students, departments, schools, campuses, and/or functional areas should proposers assume are within scope of the assessment, training, and adoption activities?	- Total number of employees: about 6,000. Abilene: ~100; Amarillo: ~700; Dallas: ~90; Lubbock: ~3,710; Permian Basin: ~600; Strategic Initiatives (Correctional Managed Care): ~800. - Functional domains (some groups overlap): Clinical: ~2,000; Academic: ~2,000; Research: ~1,300; Other (Admin, Operational, Supporting): ~2,000. Number of leaders: around 150-200. - The initial rollout will target about 3,000 individuals. - Students are not the primary focus of the workforce upskilling scope.
33. Depth of Enterprise Assessment Does TTUHSC expect detailed readiness and workflow assessments across all organizational units, or should proposers assume an enterprise-wide framework with deeper assessment of a prioritized subset of departments or functions?	An enterprise-wide framework with deeper assessment of a prioritized subset of departments or functions is acceptable; depth of assessment may be prioritized with the Contractor based on the current-state assessment. Prototypes are expected across Academic, Clinical, Research, and Admin functional areas (about 8-10 workflows).
34. Current AI Technology Environment Please identify the enterprise AI tools, Large Language Models, productivity assistants, and related platforms currently provisioned or approved by TTUHSC,	Microsoft Copilot is currently the enterprise generative AI tool that has been deployed. Other GenAI tools are being evaluated. Examples of other tools provided enterprise-wide include Zoom AI Companion, Epic, Grammarly, etc.

including the approximate number of licensed or active users where available.	Specific license/seat counts will be provided to the selected Contractor based on need.
35. Workflow Discovery Volume Approximately how many departmental workflows or use cases should proposers assume will be evaluated during workflow discovery and opportunity mapping?	The number of workflows evaluated during discovery may be proposed by the Contractor based on the current-state assessment; TTUHSC anticipates about 8-10 workflows across the four functional areas.
36. Number of Automation Prototypes For Deliverable 4, how many functional automation prototypes or custom solutions should proposers include within the fixed-fee scope?	TTUHSC is planning to have at least two workflows/use cases from each functional area (Academic, Clinical, Research, and Admin) evaluated by the Contractor, for a total of about 8 to 10 workflows. Solutions should be either pilot-ready or fully production-ready; the associated cost should not be included in the fixed fee but may be listed as an optional item for TTUHSC to consider.
37. Prototype Maturity Should Deliverable 4 solutions be considered proof-of-concept prototypes, pilot-ready solutions, or fully production-ready applications? If production deployment is expected, should ongoing hosting, licensing, maintenance, and operational support be included in the fixed fee?	- TTUHSC is planning to have at least two workflows/use cases from each functional area (Academic, Clinical, Research, and Admin) evaluated by the Contractor, for a total of about 8 to 10 workflows. Solutions should be either pilot-ready or fully production-ready; the associated cost should not be included in the fixed fee but may be listed as an optional item for TTUHSC to consider. - Solutions should be either pilot-ready or fully production-ready. Associated ongoing hosting, licensing, maintenance, and operational support costs should not be included in the fixed fee but may be listed as optional items for TTUHSC to consider.
38. Agentic AI Expectations Does TTUHSC expect the Contractor to deploy production agentic AI workflows during the engagement, or primarily develop an agentic AI architecture, governance framework, controls, and selected prototype use cases?	- TTUHSC does not mandate a specific framework. The preference is for the Contractor to design and recommend the agentic AI architecture, governance framework, controls, and selected prototype use cases. - The primary expectation is to develop the agentic AI architecture, governance framework, controls, and selected prototype use cases rather than deploy production agentic workflows at scale.
39. Analytics Platform For Deliverable 5, does TTUHSC prefer that the Contractor use existing institutional business-intelligence and reporting platforms, such as Power BI or equivalent tools, or is TTUHSC seeking a new Contractor-provided analytics platform or managed analytics service?	Either route is acceptable, with no preference here. Power BI is available; the Contractor may build on existing institutional BI/reporting platforms or propose a solution.
40. AI Usage and Adoption Data What usage telemetry and adoption data are currently available from TTUHSC's enterprise AI platforms, and will the selected Contractor receive appropriate access to this data through administrative reporting, exports, or APIs?	Access to telemetry data will be provided to the Contractor if needed. Access to admin/telemetry data (e.g., Microsoft 365 admin data) will be provided to the Contractor based on need, through administrative reporting, exports, or APIs where available.
41. ROI Baselines Does TTUHSC currently maintain baseline data for labor hours, process cycle times, operating costs, service levels, or other measures that may be used to calculate and validate AI-related ROI and productivity improvements?	- Baseline metrics have not been established. TTUHSC conducted some AI baseline surveys in 2025 and 2026, but the Contractor is expected to bring a method for measuring the baseline and, later, the ROI. - TTUHSC does not maintain established baselines for labor hours, cycle times, operating costs, or service levels for these processes; the Contractor is expected to help establish them.
42. Training Population Approximately how many individuals should proposers assume will receive live or instructor-led training, and approximately how many role-based learning pathways or functional curricula should be included in the fixed-fee scope?	- Total number of employees: about 6,000. Abilene: ~100; Amarillo: ~700; Dallas: ~90; Lubbock: ~3,710; Permian Basin: ~600; Strategic Initiatives (Correctional Managed Care): ~800. - Functional domains (some groups overlap): Clinical: ~2,000; Academic: ~2,000; Research: ~1,300; Other (Admin, Operational, Supporting): ~2,000. Number of leaders: around 150-200. - The initial rollout will target about 3,000 individuals. - The number of role-based learning pathways/curricula may be proposed by the Contractor based on the readiness assessment.

43. PHI and Business Associate Requirements Does TTUHSC anticipate that the selected Contractor will access, receive, maintain, or transmit Protected Health Information during this engagement? Where feasible, may assessment, training, prototyping, and development activities be performed using sanitized, de-identified, synthetic, or non-production data?	• PHI is not expected to be made available; assessment, training, prototyping, and development activities may be performed using sanitized, de-identified, synthetic, or non-production data. TTUHSC has test patient data that may be used. Where any PHI access is required, the BAA would apply.
44. TX-RAMP Applicability Section 5.2 states that TX-RAMP compliance is required "as may be required." Please clarify the circumstances under which TX-RAMP certification or authorization will apply to this engagement, particularly where the Contractor performs consulting and development within TTUHSC-controlled environments rather than providing a Contractor-hosted cloud service.	• Under Texas Government Code § 2054.0593 and Texas Department of Information Resources guidelines, TX-RAMP applies specifically to Cloud Service Providers offering hosted cloud computing services (SaaS, PaaS, IaaS). • If a proposal does not include the above, TX-RAMP likely would not apply.
45. Deliverable Acceptance Criteria Please clarify the acceptance criteria TTUHSC intends to use for Deliverables 1–6, including the expected review period and number of review/comment cycles proposers should include within the fixed-fee pricing.	• Deliverable acceptance is by the Chief AI Transformation Officer, the AI Steering Committee, and the President, and will depend on TTUHSC review cycles. • Formal acceptance criteria and a work plan are required per Section 5.3.2; specific acceptance criteria, review periods, and revision cycles will be agreed with the Contractor and may be reflected in fixed-fee pricing.
46. Onsite Expectations Does TTUHSC anticipate a minimum number of required onsite executive sessions, workshops, training events, or project meetings, and which TTUHSC campuses should proposers include when estimating travel?	• TTUHSC expects some on-site presence but does not have strict requirements for delivery frequency or duration. A predominantly virtual/hybrid model is acceptable, with on-site presence concentrated at defined milestones such as executive alignment sessions and leadership workshops. The initial kickoff is preferred on all campuses (negotiable), and the leadership enablement meeting is preferred on-site in Lubbock, TX. Overall, a hybrid model is preferred. Travel is to be included in the fee.
47. Pricing Assumptions and Change Orders May proposers state explicit fixed-fee assumptions regarding the number of departments assessed, workshops, training cohorts, automation prototypes, integrations, and onsite trips, with work exceeding those assumptions handled through change orders using the required hourly rate card?	• Costing for any solution offered is at the discretion of the Proposer. Cost breakdown that includes fixed fee assumptions is not a differentiator for TTUHSC reviewers. Please ensure costing is clear and discernable to the evaluating reader.
48. Will TTUHSC consider awarding by deliverable or by scope area, ie, Strategy, Governance, Workflow, and Analytics deliverables separately from Workforce Upskilling delivery under Section C, or must a responsive proposal address all six deliverables identified in Section 5.4?	• It is TTUHSC's intention to issue a single award, however in accordance with the terms of the RFP, reserves the right to award an agreement for all or any portion of the requirements proposed by reason of this request, award multiple agreements, or to reject any and all proposals if deemed to be in the best interests of TTUHSC and to resolicit for proposals, or temporarily or permanently abandon the solicitation.
49. Section 4.8.1 reserves the right to award multiple agreements. Does TTUHSC anticipate multiple awards under this RFP, and if so, how does it expect scope to be allocated among awardees?	• It is TTUHSC's intention to issue a single award, however in accordance with the terms of the RFP, reserves the right to award an agreement for all or any portion of the requirements proposed by reason of this request, award multiple agreements, or to reject any and all proposals if deemed to be in the best interests of TTUHSC and to resolicit for proposals, or temporarily or permanently abandon the solicitation.
50. Is there an incumbent or prior contractor currently performing any portion of the scope described in Section 5.4?	• None.
51. What is the anticipated budget or not-to-exceed value for the total engagement, and are funds allocated across the six deliverables in any particular proportion?	• The cost shall not exceed \$750,000. • Costing for any solution offered is at the discretion of the Proposer. Cost breakdown within a deliverable line or a separate cost line is not a differentiator for TTUHSC reviewers. Please ensure costing is clear and discernable to the evaluating reader.
52. The project schedule at Section 5.4 is left blank for the proposer to populate. Given that the anticipated term expires August 31, 2027 (Section 2.4), does TTUHSC have a target kick-off date and a preferred sequence or completion window for the six deliverables?	• The following proposed Project Schedule may change based on RFP progress: ○ Kick-off meeting: February 2027; ○ Deliverable 1: April 2027; ○ Deliverable 2: April 2027; ○ Deliverable 3: September 2027; ○ Deliverable 4: September 2027; ○ Deliverable 5: December 2027;

	○ Deliverable 6: February 2028. • TTUHSC is seeking completion of all deliverables and will work collaboratively in constructing a contract term that accommodates that position.
53. For Deliverable 5, which enterprise AI tools are currently deployed, and what telemetry and administrative access will TTUHSC make available to the Contractor for adoption, engagement, and proficiency reporting?	• Microsoft Copilot is currently the enterprise generative AI tool that has been deployed. Other GenAI tools are being evaluated. Examples of other tools provided enterprise-wide include Zoom AI Companion, Epic, Grammarly, etc. • Access to telemetry data will be provided to the Contractor if needed.
54. Approximately how many employees fall within the scope of the Section C workforce upskilling requirements, broken down by campus and by population (academic, clinical, administrative, and research)?	• Total number of employees: about 6,000. Abilene: ~100; Amarillo: ~700; Dallas: ~90; Lubbock: ~3,710; Permian Basin: ~600; Strategic Initiatives (Correctional Managed Care): ~800. • Functional domains (some groups overlap): Clinical: ~2,000; Academic: ~2,000; Research: ~1,300; Other (Admin, Operational, Supporting): ~2,000. Number of leaders: around 150-200. • The initial rollout will target about 3,000 individuals.
55. Section A.2 calls for an assessment of data architecture, security policies, and cultural adoption barriers. Has TTUHSC previously conducted an AI readiness or maturity assessment, and if so, will the results be made available to the Contractor at kick-off?	• TTUHSC has some governance structure already in place and seeks to align with both the NIST AI Risk Management Framework and the Texas DIR framework. TTUHSC has a responsible AI use policy (OP 52.21) and maintains an active AI tool inventory. No formal AI readiness or maturity assessment exists; the Contractor is expected to conduct the first assessment. Available inputs (e.g., 2025 and 2026 AI baseline surveys) will be shared with the selected Contractor.
56. Does the Texas Risk and Authorization Management Program (TX-RAMP) requirement at Section 5.2 apply to this engagement, and specifically to any analytics or reporting platform provided under Deliverable 5? If it applies, is certification required at award, or may it be achieved during the term?	• Under Texas Government Code § 2054.0593 and Texas Department of Information Resources guidelines, TX-RAMP applies specifically to Cloud Service Providers offering hosted cloud computing services (SaaS, PaaS, IaaS). • If a proposal does not include the above, TX-RAMP likely would not apply. • If it applies, certification would be required prior to award. Note the DIR program includes - Provisional Status - Granted for up to 18 months while a full product assessment is underway.
57. Will TTUHSC consider a delivery model under which the Contractor does not create, receive, maintain, or transmit Protected Health Information, relying on the sanitized institutional scenarios contemplated by Section C.3, and if so, would execution of the Business Associate Agreement still be required?	• Yes. A delivery model relying on sanitized institutional scenarios (per Section 5.4.C.3) in which the Contractor does not create, receive, maintain, or transmit PHI is acceptable. The BAA would be executed where the approved scope requires PHI access; it is included so that it is in place if needed.
58. Budget: Is TTUHSC able to share a budget range or not-to-exceed amount contemplated for this engagement, to help proposers scale their level of effort appropriately?	• The cost shall not exceed \$750,000.
59. Project schedule: Section 5.4 lists the kick-off and deliverable completion dates as blanks. Can TTUHSC share target dates or expected durations for each deliverable within the term ending August 31, 2027?	• The following proposed Project Schedule may change based on RFP progress: ○ Kick-off meeting: February 2027; ○ Deliverable 1: April 2027; ○ Deliverable 2: April 2027; ○ Deliverable 3: September 2027; ○ Deliverable 4: September 2027; ○ Deliverable 5: December 2027; ○ Deliverable 6: February 2028. • TTUHSC is seeking completion of all deliverables and will work collaboratively in constructing a contract term that accommodates that position.
60. TX-RAMP applicability: Section 5.2 references TX-RAMP compliance "as may be required." If a proposer's solution for Deliverable 5 (Analytics & ROI Reporting) uses a cloud-hosted platform, would TX-RAMP certification be required at proposal submission, at contract execution, or prior to production deployment? Would a reporting service delivered within TTUHSC's existing enterprise environment (rather than a vendor-hosted platform) be subject to TX-RAMP?	• Under Texas Government Code § 2054.0593 and Texas Department of Information Resources guidelines, TX-RAMP applies specifically to Cloud Service Providers offering hosted cloud computing services (SaaS, PaaS, IaaS). • As described in Question 60 specifically, because Deliverable 5 is executed a cloud-hosted platform, there is a high likelihood that TX-RAMP certification is required. This element will be evaluated and determined by the TTUHSC IT Governance, Risk, and Compliance office in accordance with Texas Department of Information Resources guidelines and guidance.

	If a proposal does not include the above, TX-RAMP likely would not apply.
61. Enterprise AI environment: Can TTUHSC identify the enterprise AI tools and platforms currently provisioned (e.g., the LLM platform(s) and embedded productivity assistants referenced in Section 5.4 Background), so proposers can tailor training content and integration approaches accordingly?	Microsoft Copilot is currently the enterprise generative AI tool that has been deployed. Other GenAI tools are being evaluated. Examples of other tools provided enterprise-wide include Zoom AI Companion, Epic, Grammarly, etc.
62. Incumbent/prior work: Has any consultant or vendor performed AI strategy, readiness assessment, or related advisory work for TTUHSC that informs this RFP? If so, will any resulting artifacts be made available to the awarded Contractor?	None.
63. Data access for ROI baseline: For Deliverable 5, will TTUHSC provide baseline operational metrics and usage telemetry from its AI platforms, or is the Contractor expected to instrument data collection?	- Baseline metrics have not been established. TTUHSC conducted some AI baseline surveys in 2025 and 2026, but the Contractor is expected to bring a method for measuring the baseline and, later, the ROI. - Access to telemetry data will be provided to the Contractor if needed.
64. Travel expectations: Are executive sessions and training under Deliverables 1–3 expected to be delivered on-site across all five campuses, or will TTUHSC accept a hybrid model with periodic on-site presence primarily in Lubbock?	TTUHSC expects some on-site presence but does not have strict requirements for delivery frequency or duration. A predominantly virtual/hybrid model is acceptable, with on-site presence concentrated at defined milestones such as executive alignment sessions and leadership workshops. The initial kickoff is preferred on all campuses (negotiable), and the leadership enablement meeting is preferred on-site in Lubbock, TX. Overall, a hybrid model is preferred. Travel is to be included in the fee.
65. BAA scope: Is it anticipated that the Contractor will access PHI in the course of this engagement, thereby triggering the Business Associate Agreement, or is the BAA included as a contingency?	The Business Associate Agreement would be executed where the approved scope of work requires access to PHI; it is included so that it is in place if PHI access is required. PHI access is not anticipated; PHI is not expected to be made available.
66. Scope of response. Section 4.8.2 states that any resulting agreement is non-exclusive and that TTUHSC reserves the right to enter into one or more agreements with third parties covering the same or similar Services, and Section 6.1 requests a "not to exceed" fixed fee for each deliverable. Would a proposal that addresses a subset of the requirement areas in Section 5.4 -- for example A (AI Strategy, Governance and Transformation Planning), B (Leadership Activation and Change Management), C (Workforce Upskilling, Training and Capability Building) and E (Analytics, Adoption Tracking and Impact Measurement), without D (Workflow Automation, Custom Solutions and Agentic Strategy) -- be evaluated, or would it be considered non-responsive?	It is TTUHSC's intention to issue a single award, however in accordance with the terms of the RFP, reserves the right to award an agreement for all or any portion of the requirements proposed by reason of this request, award multiple agreements, or to reject any and all proposals if deemed to be in the best interests of TTUHSC and to resolicit for proposals, or temporarily or permanently abandon the solicitation.
67. Population and scale. To size the effort accurately, please provide the approximate number of employees in the intended target population, the number of departments or operational units in scope, and which of the five campuses (Abilene, Amarillo, Dallas/Fort Worth, Lubbock, Permian Basin) are included. For requirement B.1 specifically, approximately how many VPs, Deans, Department Heads and People Managers are anticipated to participate in the leadership education sessions?	- Total number of employees: about 6,000. Abilene: ~100; Amarillo: ~700; Dallas: ~90; Lubbock: ~3,710; Permian Basin: ~600; Strategic Initiatives (Correctional Managed Care): ~800. - Functional domains (some groups overlap): Clinical: ~2,000; Academic: ~2,000; Research: ~1,300; Other (Admin, Operational, Supporting): ~2,000. Number of leaders: around 150-200. - The initial rollout will target about 3,000 individuals. - For Requirement B.1, there are around 150-200 leaders; the Contractor may propose the participant set based on role and organizational level.
68. Onsite delivery expectations. Section 6.1 requires that travel and meeting attendance be included within the fixed fee for each deliverable. Approximately how many onsite days does TTUHSC anticipate over the course of the engagement, and at which campuses?	TTUHSC expects some on-site presence but does not have strict requirements for delivery frequency or duration. A predominantly virtual/hybrid model is acceptable, with on-site presence concentrated at defined milestones such as executive alignment sessions and leadership workshops. The initial kickoff is preferred on all campuses (negotiable), and the leadership enablement meeting is preferred on-site in Lubbock, TX. Overall, a hybrid model is preferred. Travel is to be included in the fee. The Proposer may state its on-site assumptions across the five campuses; travel is included in the fixed fee.

69. Deliverable 5, Analytics and ROI. Requirement E contemplates a software platform, managed analytics services, or integrated reporting tools. Would TTUHSC accept adoption and ROI reporting developed from its existing enterprise AI administrative telemetry and reporting exports, or does TTUHSC expect the Contractor to provide a separate vendor-hosted analytics platform? Relatedly, where a proposed approach introduces no new vendor-hosted cloud service, does the TX-RAMP requirement referenced in Section 5.2 still apply?	• Yes. Adoption and ROI reporting may be developed from TTUHSC's existing enterprise AI administrative telemetry and reporting exports; Power BI is available and no separate vendor-hosted platform is required. Under Texas Government Code Sec. 2054.0593 and Texas Department of Information Resources guidelines, TX-RAMP applies specifically to Cloud Service Providers offering hosted cloud computing services (SaaS, PaaS, IaaS). Where the solution is delivered as a professional/managed service operating inside TTUHSC's approved enterprise environment, using TTUHSC's certified infrastructure and tooling, with no contractor-hosted cloud service and no institutional data leaving TTUHSC-controlled systems, TX-RAMP would likely not apply. Where the approach introduces no new vendor-hosted cloud service, TX-RAMP would not independently apply.
70. Budget and schedule. Has TTUHSC established a budget or not-to-exceed amount for this engagement? In addition, the Project Schedule in Section 5.4 lists deliverable dates as to be determined and Section 2.4 states that the anticipated term expires August 31, 2027. What kickoff date does TTUHSC anticipate, and would TTUHSC consider a term extension if the agreed deliverable schedule extends beyond August 31, 2027?	• The cost shall not exceed \$750,000. • The following proposed Project Schedule may change based on RFP progress: ○ Kick-off meeting: February 2027; ○ Deliverable 1: April 2027; ○ Deliverable 2: April 2027; ○ Deliverable 3: September 2027; ○ Deliverable 4: September 2027; ○ Deliverable 5: December 2027; ○ Deliverable 6: February 2028. • TTUHSC is seeking completion of all deliverables and will work collaboratively in constructing a contract term that accommodates that position. • TTUHSC will work collaboratively in constructing a contract term that accommodates completion of all deliverables, including any extension if the agreed schedule warrants.
71. Current-state information: Will TTUHSC provide the selected contractor with an inventory of current AI tools, licensed platforms, active pilots, data architecture, governance policies and adoption levels? Which AI products and cloud environments are currently approved or deployed, such as Microsoft Copilot, Azure OpenAI, AWS, Google Cloud or ServiceNow?	• TTUHSC will provide the selected Contractor with available inputs, including the active AI tool inventory, governance materials, and relevant current-state information, based on need. Microsoft Copilot is currently the enterprise generative AI tool that has been deployed. Other GenAI tools are being evaluated. Examples of other tools provided enterprise-wide include Zoom AI Companion, Epic, Grammarly, etc. • TTUHSC operates within a Microsoft enterprise environment.
72. Project duration: What is the anticipated contract term and expected timing for each of the six deliverables? The completion dates in the RFP appear to be blank.	• The following proposed Project Schedule may change based on RFP progress: ○ Kick-off meeting: February 2027; ○ Deliverable 1: April 2027; ○ Deliverable 2: April 2027; ○ Deliverable 3: September 2027; ○ Deliverable 4: September 2027; ○ Deliverable 5: December 2027; ○ Deliverable 6: February 2028. • TTUHSC is seeking completion of all deliverables and will work collaboratively in constructing a contract term that accommodates that position.
73. Operational scope: How many campuses, schools, departments and operating units are expected to participate in the initial phase? Does the scope include academic, administrative, clinical and research functions?	• The scope includes academic, administrative, clinical, and research functions across the five campuses. Total number of employees: about 6,000. Abilene: ~100; Amarillo: ~700; Dallas: ~90; Lubbock: ~3,710; Permian Basin: ~600; Strategic Initiatives (Correctional Managed Care): ~800. • Functional domains (some groups overlap): Clinical: ~2,000; Academic: ~2,000; Research: ~1,300; Other (Admin, Operational, Supporting): ~2,000. Number of leaders: around 150-200. Depth of assessment and the units participating in the initial phase may be prioritized with the Contractor based on the current-state assessment. • The initial rollout will target about 3,000 individuals.
74. Workflow volume: Approximately how many workflows or use cases should be discovered, prioritized, redesigned, prototyped and prepared for implementation?	• TTUHSC anticipates about 8-10 workflows across the four functional areas (Academic, Clinical, Research, Admin) for discovery, prioritization, redesign, and prototyping; the Contractor may propose the number based on the current-state assessment.

75. Production implementation: For workflow automation and agentic AI, does TTUHSC expect production-ready deployments or primarily discovery, architecture, specifications and validated prototypes?	• TTUHSC is planning to have at least two workflows/use cases from each functional area (Academic, Clinical, Research, and Admin) evaluated by the Contractor, for a total of about 8 to 10 workflows. Solutions should be either pilot-ready or fully production-ready; the associated cost should not be included in the fixed fee but may be listed as an optional item for TTUHSC to consider. • The emphasis is on discovery, architecture, specifications, and validated prototypes; solutions should be pilot-ready or production-ready, with production hosting/support treated as optional items.
76. Implementation responsibility: Does TTUHSC expect the contractor to implement and operate the AI transformation directly, or primarily assess, design, train, prototype and assist TTUHSC's IT and functional teams with implementation?	• TTUHSC primarily expects the Contractor to assess, design, train, prototype, and assist TTUHSC's IT and functional teams with implementation. TTUHSC plans to operate and maintain deliverables internally after the term.
77. Subcontracting: May a respondent use disclosed subcontractors and specialist partners, subject to TTUHSC's review and approval?	• Yes.
78. Leadership participation: Which leadership groups are expected to participate in executive alignment and education—for example, the President's Cabinet, vice presidents, deans, department heads, faculty leadership and people managers?	• Leadership groups expected to participate include the President's Cabinet, vice presidents, deans, department heads, faculty leadership, and people managers; there are around 150-200 leaders. The Contractor may propose the participant set based on role and organizational level.
79. Training population: Approximately how many employees, faculty members, researchers, clinicians and administrators are expected to participate in workforce assessment, training and coaching?	• Total number of employees: about 6,000. Abilene: ~100; Amarillo: ~700; Dallas: ~90; Lubbock: ~3,710; Permian Basin: ~600; Strategic Initiatives (Correctional Managed Care): ~800. • Functional domains (some groups overlap): Clinical: ~2,000; Academic: ~2,000; Research: ~1,300; Other (Admin, Operational, Supporting): ~2,000. Number of leaders: around 150-200. The number of role-based learning pathways/curricula may be proposed by the Contractor based on the readiness assessment.
80. Training volume: Is there a required minimum number of workshops, cohorts, office hours or train-the-trainer sessions, or should respondents recommend the volume based on the readiness assessment?	• There is no required minimum number of workshops, cohorts, office hours, or train-the-trainer sessions; respondents may recommend the volume based on the readiness assessment.
81. Analytics access: Will TTUHSC provide platform telemetry, usage data, workforce information, and operational and financial baselines needed to measure adoption, proficiency, time savings and ROI?	• Access to telemetry data will be provided to the Contractor if needed. Workforce information and operational/financial baselines will be provided based on need; where baselines do not exist, the Contractor is expected to help establish them.
82. ROI methodology: Does TTUHSC have an established benefits-realization or financial-validation methodology, or should the contractor propose the baseline, attribution and verification framework?	• Baseline metrics have not been established. TTUHSC conducted some AI baseline surveys in 2025 and 2026, but the Contractor is expected to bring a method for measuring the baseline and, later, the ROI. • TTUHSC does not have an established benefits-realization or financial-validation methodology; the Contractor is expected to propose the baseline, attribution, and verification framework.
83. Data sensitivity: Which workstreams are expected to involve protected health information, student education records, research data or other regulated or confidential information?	• PHI is not expected to be made available; workstreams should generally rely on sanitized, de-identified, or non-production data. Where any PHI, student education records, research data, or other regulated/confidential information is involved, applicable protections (including the BAA for PHI) would apply.
84. Offshore participation: May an approved subcontractor located outside the United States support activities that do not require access to identifiable, confidential or regulated institutional information?	• The preference is to have everything located inside the US. Offshore participation may be permitted for work that does not involve institutional data, but this requires further discussion with the Contractor; if PHI is involved, PHI must not be stored offshore. Any offshore personnel/subcontractors would need to be approved by TTUHSC.
85. Offshore data access: If offshore participation is permitted, must such work be limited to synthetic or properly de-identified information within TTUHSC-approved environments? Are there any country, personnel-location or data-location restrictions?	• If offshore participation is permitted, such work must be limited to synthetic or properly de-identified information within TTUHSC-approved environments, and PHI must not be accessed, stored, or transmitted outside the United States. The preference is US-based; any offshore personnel/subcontractors would require TTUHSC approval.
86. HUB participation: Are there Historically Underutilized Business subcontracting goals, documentation or reporting requirements applicable to this engagement?	87. VetHUB goals, etc., can be viewed here: https://www.fiscal.ttuhs.edu/purchasing/hub/findavendor.aspx

88. TX-RAMP applicability: Will TX-RAMP authorization apply only if the contractor provides or hosts a cloud service, or could it also apply when the contractor performs services using TTUHSC-approved platforms and infrastructure?	- Under Texas Government Code § 2054.0593 and Texas Department of Information Resources guidelines, TX-RAMP applies specifically to Cloud Service Providers offering hosted cloud computing services (SaaS, PaaS, IaaS). - If a proposal does not include the above, TX-RAMP likely would not apply.
89. Security qualifications: Are SOC 2 Type II, ISO 27001, HITRUST, CMMC or similar certifications mandatory, preferred, or applicable only to vendors that host or process covered institutional data?	SOC 2 Type II, ISO 27001, HITRUST, CMMC, or similar certifications are not mandated for proposal responsiveness; they are most relevant where a vendor hosts or processes covered institutional data. Any solution must meet the RFP's security and data-privacy requirements. Where a hosted cloud service is proposed, TX-RAMP applies.
90. Security review: Will TTUHSC conduct its own security, privacy and architecture reviews before any prototype or solution may access institutional systems or data?	Yes. TTUHSC will conduct its own security, privacy, and architecture reviews before any prototype or solution may access institutional systems or data; this will be coordinated with TTUHSC IT security.
91. Agentic AI autonomy: Does TTUHSC expect the contractor to recommend an autonomy-classification framework defining what AI agents may observe, recommend, initiate or execute, including where human approval is mandatory?	Yes. The Contractor is expected to recommend an autonomy-classification framework defining what AI agents may observe, recommend, initiate, or execute, including where human approval is mandatory, as part of the agentic AI architecture and governance. Data-mutating and higher-risk actions are expected to require human approval.
92. Governance authority: Does TTUHSC currently have an AI governance body, or should the contractor recommend and help establish its structure, membership, authority and decision rights?	- The Chief AI Transformation Officer is the executive sponsor. TTUHSC has an AI Steering Committee which is the oversight body of the effort. - TTUHSC has an AI Steering Committee; the Contractor may recommend and help further develop its structure, membership, authority, and decision rights, building on the existing body.
93. Institutional policies: Should the contractor revise existing policies and procedures, or recommend changes for review and adoption by TTUHSC's legal, compliance, security and governance authorities?	The Contractor should build upon and integrate with existing policies (e.g., OP 52.21), identifying and addressing gaps and recommending changes for review and adoption by TTUHSC's legal, compliance, security, and governance authorities, rather than replacing them wholesale.
94. Commercial structure: Are time-and-materials, not-to-exceed, fixed-fee by deliverable, or hybrid pricing structures acceptable?	- Costing for any solution offered is at the discretion of the Proposer. Cost breakdown within a deliverable line or a separate cost line is not a differentiator for TTUHSC reviewers. Please ensure costing is clear and discernable to the evaluating reader. - A not-to-exceed fixed fee per deliverable is expected per Section 6.1, with a rate card for change-order/scope-change purposes; fixed-fee, not-to-exceed, and hybrid structures are acceptable. Please ensure costing is clear and discernable.
95. Budget: Is there an anticipated budget range or maximum contract value respondents should use when determining the proposed number of workflows, training cohorts, prototypes, dashboards and technical resources?	- The cost shall not exceed \$750,000. - Respondents may size the number of workflows, training cohorts, prototypes, dashboards, and technical resources to the scope; costing is at the Proposer's discretion and is not a differentiator.
96. Deliverable acceptance: Who will approve each deliverable, and what review period, revision cycle and acceptance criteria will apply?	- Deliverable acceptance is by the Chief AI Transformation Officer, the AI Steering Committee, and the President, and will depend on TTUHSC review cycles. - Review periods, revision cycles, and acceptance criteria will be agreed with the Contractor per Section 5.3.2.
97. Proposal assumptions: May respondents state workload assumptions—including stakeholder counts, workshops, workflows, prototypes and dashboards—and provide unit pricing for quantities beyond the proposed baseline?	Costing for any solution offered is at the discretion of the Proposer. Cost breakdown that includes fixed fee assumptions is not a differentiator for TTUHSC reviewers. Please ensure costing is clear and discernable to the evaluating reader.
98. Regarding Section 5.4.D (Workflow Automation, Custom Solutions & Agentic Strategy), what existing enterprise platforms, ERP systems, EHRs, or cloud environments (e.g., Microsoft Azure, AWS, Google Cloud, Ellucian, Epic/Cerner) are in scope for agentic integrations and workflow redesign?	TTUHSC operates within a Microsoft enterprise environment. In-scope systems (e.g., ERP, EHR/Epic, cloud environments) will be prioritized with the Contractor based on the current-state assessment; access and documentation will be provided based on need.
99. For Section 5.4.F (Enterprise Security & Data Privacy Compliance), will TTUHSC provide a dedicated sandbox or private tenant environment for prototyping AI solutions, or is the contractor expected to host	TTUHSC will not provide a dedicated sandbox, private tenant, or hosted environment for prototype development unless otherwise specified in the solicitation or subsequent contract documents. Proposers should assume responsibility for providing and managing any environments required to

prototypes within a TX-RAMP certified vendor cloud environment?	develop, host, demonstrate, and test proposed AI solutions. Any vendor-hosted environment used to store, process, or transmit TTUHSC data must comply with the security, privacy, and regulatory requirements defined in the RFP, including any applicable State of Texas and TTUHSC requirements.
100. In Section 5.4.C (Workforce Upskilling), what is the estimated total number of personnel across the targeted operational units (procurement, finance, clinical admin, academic ops) anticipated to participate in live or virtual role-based training cohorts?	- Total number of employees: about 6,000. Abilene: ~100; Amarillo: ~700; Dallas: ~90; Lubbock: ~3,710; Permian Basin: ~600; Strategic Initiatives (Correctional Managed Care): ~800. - Functional domains (some groups overlap): Clinical: ~2,000; Academic: ~2,000; Research: ~1,300; Other (Admin, Operational, Supporting): ~2,000. Number of leaders: around 150-200. The Proposer may recommend prioritization among the functional domains based on the readiness assessment. - The initial rollout will target about 3,000 individuals.
101. Regarding Deliverable 5 (Analytics & ROI Reporting Dashboard/Service), does TTUHSC prefer the dashboard to be hosted natively within TTUHSC's existing business intelligence infrastructure (e.g., Power BI, Tableau) or delivered as an external reporting artifact/service?	Either route is acceptable, with no preference here. Power BI is available; the dashboard may be hosted natively within TTUHSC's existing BI infrastructure or delivered as a reporting artifact/service.
102. Does TTUHSC have established baseline performance metrics and process cost data available for the initial discovery phase, or will baseline data collection and discovery workshops be part of Deliverable 1 level of effort?	- Baseline metrics have not been established. TTUHSC conducted some AI baseline surveys in 2025 and 2026, but the Contractor is expected to bring a method for measuring the baseline and, later, the ROI. - Established baseline performance metrics and process cost data are not available today; baseline data collection and discovery are expected to be part of the Contractor's scope.
103. What specific SSO identity providers (e.g., Microsoft Entra ID / Azure AD, Okta, Shibboleth) and protocols (SAML 2.0 / OAuth2) must be integrated for role-based access control during AI tool enablement and training portal access?	SSO via SAML 2.0/OAuth2 is required per Section 5.4.F.3, within TTUHSC's Microsoft enterprise environment. Specific identity provider configuration will be provided to the selected Contractor at kickoff.
104. For Deliverable 2 (Leadership Enablement Package), how many distinct executive and departmental leadership workshops (VPs, Deans, Department Heads, Managers) does TTUHSC anticipate across campuses (Lubbock, Amarillo, Abilene, Permian Basin, Dallas)?	The number of leadership workshops may be proposed by the Contractor across the five campuses; there are around 150-200 leaders. Leadership enablement is preferred on-site in Lubbock, with a hybrid model preferred overall.
105. Are there specific third-party foundation models or enterprise AI subscriptions (e.g., Microsoft Copilot / Azure OpenAI, AWS Bedrock, Google Vertex AI) already licensed or preferred by TTUHSC for adoption enablement?	- Microsoft Copilot is currently the enterprise generative AI tool that has been deployed. Other GenAI tools are being evaluated. Examples of other tools provided enterprise-wide include Zoom AI Companion, Epic, Grammarly, etc. - The Proposer is free to propose its own stack, provided the solution meets the RFP requirements. Costing is at the Proposer's discretion.
106. In the evaluation criteria (Section 5 weighting), what specific documentation or evidence is preferred to evaluate 'Proposer's Experience and Reputation' (15%) beyond the 3 client references and corporate profile?	Content proposed for this section is at the discretion of the Proposer. Section 5.3, Item 1 outlines the details of the request.
107. Regarding Appendix C (VetHUB Subcontracting Plan), if a proposer intends to self-perform 100% of the scope of services using direct W-2 employees without utilizing subcontractors, is Section 2a/Method A self-performance justification required and sufficient on the Texas Comptroller HUB form?	Yes.
108. Regarding Section 5.4.B (Change Champions Network), does TTUHSC anticipate on-site presence for change management and champion activation workshops, or will hybrid/virtual delivery across satellite campuses be accepted?	TTUHSC expects some on-site presence but does not have strict requirements for delivery frequency or duration. A predominantly virtual/hybrid model is acceptable, with on-site presence concentrated at defined milestones such as executive alignment sessions and leadership workshops. The initial kickoff is preferred on all campuses (negotiable), and the leadership enablement meeting is preferred on-site in Lubbock, TX. Overall, a hybrid model is preferred. Travel is to be included in the fee.
109. For the Deliverable Schedule to be proposed in Section 5.3/6, is there a preferred sequential timeline or hard milestone deadline prior to the August 31, 2027 contract expiration date?	- The following proposed Project Schedule may change based on RFP progress: - Kick-off meeting: February 2027; - Deliverable 1: April 2027; - Deliverable 2: April 2027; - Deliverable 3: September 2027; - Deliverable 4: September 2027;

	○ Deliverable 5: December 2027; ○ Deliverable 6: February 2028. • TTUHSC is seeking completion of all deliverables and will work collaboratively in constructing a contract term that accommodates that position. • There is no hard milestone deadline beyond seeking completion of all deliverables within the term; TTUHSC will work collaboratively on sequencing.
110. Will TTUHSC require Business Associate Agreements (BAAs) to be executed for all contractor personnel involved in workflow discovery, or only for staff directly interacting with environments containing Protected Health Information (PHI)?	• The Business Associate Agreement would apply only where the approved scope requires access to environments containing PHI, not for all personnel involved in workflow discovery. PHI is not expected to be made available.
111. What is the estimated budget for this contract?	• The cost shall not exceed \$750,000.
112. Which enterprise AI tools and LLMs are already live at TTUHSC?	• Microsoft Copilot is currently the enterprise generative AI tool that has been deployed. Other GenAI tools are being evaluated. Examples of other tools provided enterprise-wide include Zoom AI Companion, Epic, Grammarly, etc.
113. For this first term, is clinical or PHI work in scope, or should the year stay on academic and administrative workflows?	• The clinical scope may extend to clinical decision support, diagnostic, and patient-facing applications; however, PHI is not expected to be made available, and activities may rely on sanitized/de-identified/test data. Where any PHI is involved, the BAA would apply.
114. Do you prefer one firm for all six deliverables, or might you split the award?	• It is TTUHSC's intention to issue a single award, however in accordance with the terms of the RFP, reserves the right to award an agreement for all or any portion of the requirements proposed by reason of this request, award multiple agreements, or to reject any and all proposals if deemed to be in the best interests of TTUHSC and to resolicit for proposals, or temporarily or permanently abandon the solicitation.
115. For Deliverable 4, how many workflows should be in production by August 31, 2027, versus prototype only?	• TTUHSC is planning to have at least two workflows/use cases from each functional area (Academic, Clinical, Research, and Admin) evaluated by the Contractor, for a total of about 8 to 10 workflows. Solutions should be either pilot-ready or fully production-ready; the associated cost should not be included in the fixed fee but may be listed as an optional item for TTUHSC to consider. • The number of solutions reaching production versus remaining prototype may be proposed by the Contractor; production deployment costs may be listed as optional items.
116. What on-site time do you expect, and on which campuses?	• TTUHSC expects some on-site presence but does not have strict requirements for delivery frequency or duration. A predominantly virtual/hybrid model is acceptable, with on-site presence concentrated at defined milestones such as executive alignment sessions and leadership workshops. The initial kickoff is preferred on all campuses (negotiable), and the leadership enablement meeting is preferred on-site in Lubbock, TX. Overall, a hybrid model is preferred. Travel is to be included in the fee.
117. If the work stays inside TTUHSC systems and we are not hosting a product, is TX-RAMP required?	• Under Texas Government Code § 2054.0593 and Texas Department of Information Resources guidelines, TX-RAMP applies specifically to Cloud Service Providers offering hosted cloud computing services (SaaS, PaaS, IaaS). • If a proposal does not include the above, TX-RAMP likely would not apply.
118. Is there a budget range or expected team size for the term?	• The cost shall not exceed \$750,000. • Team size is at the Proposer's discretion to propose based on the scope and level of effort.
119. If a firm self-performs and does not subcontract, is a no-subcontracting VetHUB plan acceptable?	• For clarity, The VetHUB subcontracting must be completed and return as a component of the RFP response. A self-performance designation is considered responsive.
120. Whether a company incorporated in Spain may submit as the prime respondent.	• A company incorporated in Spain may submit as the prime respondent provided it can satisfy the solicitation's contractual, insurance, security, and data-handling requirements and complete any required Texas registrations (e.g., Secretary of State registration to transact business, Comptroller

	payee/TIN setup, Form 1295) prior to award or execution as applicable. The preference is that work be performed within the US, and all TTUHSC institutional data must not be stored offshore.
121. Whether international firms may participate through a joint venture or as a subcontractor to a U.S.-registered prime.	Yes. International firms may participate through a joint venture or as a subcontractor to a U.S.-registered prime, subject to TTUHSC's prior written approval of any subcontracting and to the security and data-handling requirements. The preference is US-based performance, and all TTUHSC institutional data must not be stored offshore.
122. Which vendor registration, insurance, security, and Texas presence requirements are mandatory at proposal submission versus contract award.	Evidence of requirements would be mandatory for the execution of a contract award.
123. Whether the full solicitation documents are available through a public portal, and the exact registration route required to access them.	https://www.txsmartbuy.gov/esbd Search - (Texas Tech Health Science Cnt – Agency 739) And https://bids.scquest.com/apps/Router/PublicEvent?CustomerOrg=TexasTech
124. May an independent sole proprietor / individual consultant submit a responsive proposal, or must the respondent be an incorporated consulting firm with a larger organizational team?	Yes, sole-proprietors are welcome to participate in the solicitation.
125. Is the engagement eligible to be performed primarily or fully remotely, or does the scope require material on-site presence at TTUHSC locations?	The engagement may be performed predominantly virtually/hybrid, with on-site presence concentrated at defined milestones. The initial kickoff is preferred on all campuses (negotiable), and the leadership enablement meeting is preferred on-site in Lubbock. A fully remote model is not preferred; some material on-site presence is expected at milestones.
126. Whether consortium/team submissions or named subcontractors are permitted	Both are acceptable.
127. Whether a newly formed firm may participate if its individual key personnel can demonstrate relevant technical capabilities, or whether minimum firm-level past performance is mandatory	Yes, newly formed entities are welcome to participate in the solicitation.
128. Where the complete current solicitation package and any addenda should be downloaded/submitted	https://www.txsmartbuy.gov/esbd Search - (Texas Tech Health Science Cnt – Agency 739) And https://bids.scquest.com/apps/Router/PublicEvent?CustomerOrg=TexasTech
129. What is TTUHSC's anticipated contract budget or not-to-exceed funding range?	The cost shall not exceed \$750,000.
130. Approximately how many employees, departments, campuses, and enterprise AI users are expected to participate in the engagement?	- Total number of employees: about 6,000. Abilene: ~100; Amarillo: ~700; Dallas: ~90; Lubbock: ~3,710; Permian Basin: ~600; Strategic Initiatives (Correctional Managed Care): ~800. - Functional domains (some groups overlap): Clinical: ~2,000; Academic: ~2,000; Research: ~1,300; Other (Admin, Operational, Supporting): ~2,000. Number of leaders: around 150-200. - The initial rollout will target about 3,000 individuals.
131. Which enterprise AI tools, productivity assistants, cloud platforms, identity providers, learning-management systems, and analytics platforms are currently provisioned by TTUHSC?	- Microsoft Copilot is currently the enterprise generative AI tool that has been deployed. Other GenAI tools are being evaluated. Examples of other tools provided enterprise-wide include Zoom AI Companion, Epic, Grammarly, etc. - TTUHSC operates within a Microsoft enterprise environment. Power BI is available and TTUHSC has an LMS. SSO is via TTUHSC's Microsoft enterprise identity provider using SAML 2.0/OAuth2.
132. The project schedule in Section 5.4 contains blank milestone dates. Does TTUHSC have anticipated dates or preferred durations for the kickoff and six deliverables?	- The following proposed Project Schedule may change based on RFP progress: - Kick-off meeting: February 2027; - Deliverable 1: April 2027; - Deliverable 2: April 2027; - Deliverable 3: September 2027; - Deliverable 4: September 2027;

	○ Deliverable 5: December 2027; ○ Deliverable 6: February 2028. • TTUHSC is seeking completion of all deliverables and will work collaboratively in constructing a contract term that accommodates that position.
133. Will TTUHSC consider relevant project references belonging to proposed key personnel or approved subcontractors when evaluating the required three references, or must all three contracts have been performed directly by the prime proposer?	• The intention is to request three “separate” reference clients. • References provided are at the discretion of the Proposer and can be from any experience that compares favorably to the services requested within this RFP.
134. Does TTUHSC anticipate that the contractor will host, process, transmit, or store Confidential Information, FERPA-protected information, PHI, or electronic PHI? If so, will a Business Associate Agreement be required?	• The Business Associate Agreement would be executed where the approved scope of work requires access to PHI; it is included so that it is in place if PHI access is required. PHI is not expected to be made available; where the Contractor would host, process, transmit, or store PHI/ePHI, the BAA would be required. FERPA-protected and other confidential information will be handled under applicable protections.
135. If a proposed solution uses only TTUHSC-approved systems and does not independently host or process confidential data, would separate TX-RAMP certification be required of the contractor?	• Under Texas Government Code § 2054.0593 and Texas Department of Information Resources guidelines, TX-RAMP applies specifically to Cloud Service Providers offering hosted cloud computing services (SaaS, PaaS, IaaS). • If a proposal does not include the above, TX-RAMP likely would not apply.
136. Are onsite workshops required? If so, please identify the anticipated campuses, number of onsite sessions, and expected travel frequency.	• TTUHSC expects some on-site presence but does not have strict requirements for delivery frequency or duration. A predominantly virtual/hybrid model is acceptable, with on-site presence concentrated at defined milestones such as executive alignment sessions and leadership workshops. The initial kickoff is preferred on all campuses (negotiable), and the leadership enablement meeting is preferred on-site in Lubbock, TX. Overall, a hybrid model is preferred. Travel is to be included in the fee.
137. For adoption analytics, will TTUHSC provide access to usage telemetry and baseline operational data from its existing enterprise platforms?	• Access to telemetry data will be provided to the Contractor if needed. Baseline operational data will be provided based on need.
138. May proposers recommend a phased implementation in which prototypes and automations are prioritized after the readiness assessment and workflow-discovery activities?	• Yes. A phased implementation prioritizing prototypes and automations after the readiness assessment and workflow-discovery activities may be proposed.
139. Are there minimum requirements concerning the number of prototypes, departments, training sessions, participants, or instructional hours?	• TTUHSC anticipates about 8-10 workflows across the four functional areas. Minimums for departments, training sessions, participants, or instructional hours may be proposed by the Contractor based on the readiness assessment; there is no fixed minimum mandated.
140. Please confirm whether electronic submission through TechBid constitutes the authorized signature for the Execution of Offer, Pricing Schedule, and Addenda Checklist, or whether separately signed copies must also be uploaded.	• Yes, as stated in the RFP. Proposals must be signed by the responding company’s official authorized to commits such proposals. Failure to sign the Execution of Offer will be basis for proposal disqualification. The TechBid system contains a mandatory “Bidder Affirmation” checkbox certifying this information. By submitting their proposal online, proposers automatically qualify as having a valid signature.
141. Please describe the enterprise AI solutions currently approved and/or deployed across TTUHSC. For each solution, identify the business function(s) or operational area(s) where it is being utilized (e.g., clinical, academic, research, administrative, IT, revenue cycle, HR, finance).	• Microsoft Copilot is currently the enterprise generative AI tool that has been deployed. Other GenAI tools are being evaluated. Examples of other tools provided enterprise-wide include Zoom AI Companion, Epic, Grammarly, etc. • Utilization is currently isolated and low-complexity across functional areas; the Contractor is expected to assess current usage by function during discovery.
142. Please outline TTUHSC's strategic vision for artificial intelligence adoption, including key objectives, governance considerations, implementation priorities, and anticipated timelines for future AI initiatives.	• TTUHSC has some governance structure already in place and seeks to align with both the NIST AI Risk Management Framework and the Texas DIR framework. TTUHSC has a responsible AI use policy (OP 52.21) and maintains an active AI tool inventory. • TTUHSC seeks to move from isolated, low-complexity AI utilization to durable, measurable, high-value adoption. Priorities are strategy and governance, change management, workforce upskilling, and adoption analytics and ROI. The Contractor is expected to help develop the strategy, prioritized use cases, and timelines.

143. Please provide a list of enterprise-approved AI, analytics, automation, and productivity tools that may be incorporated into training, adoption, and change management activities under this engagement.	- Microsoft Copilot is currently the enterprise generative AI tool that has been deployed. Other GenAI tools are being evaluated. Examples of other tools provided enterprise-wide include Zoom AI Companion, Epic, Grammarly, etc. - Enterprise-approved analytics, automation, and productivity tools include the Microsoft environment and Power BI; the active AI tool inventory will be shared with the selected Contractor.
144. Please provide any available baseline performance metrics relevant to the scope of work, including current-state process measures, productivity indicators, and operational outcomes. Additionally, describe any targeted efficiency improvements, performance goals, or expected benefits associated with this initiative.	- Baseline metrics have not been established. TTUHSC conducted some AI baseline surveys in 2025 and 2026, but the Contractor is expected to bring a method for measuring the baseline and, later, the ROI. - Targeted efficiency improvements and performance goals will be defined collaboratively; the Contractor is expected to establish baselines and the measurement framework.
145. Please describe TTUHSC's policies and requirements regarding data access for offshore personnel. Specifically, indicate whether offshore team members may be granted access to systems, applications, or data necessary to support project delivery, and identify any applicable security, compliance, or contractual restrictions.	The preference is to have everything located inside the US. Offshore participation may be permitted for work that does not involve institutional data, but this requires further discussion with the Contractor; if PHI is involved, PHI must not be stored offshore. Any offshore personnel/subcontractors would need to be approved by TTUHSC.
146. Section 5.3 requires proposers to provide at least three references from current or recent clients for services similar to those described in the RFP. Section 5.3 also permits proposed project teams to include sub-consultants and requests information regarding their qualifications and experience. May a proposer include client references and relevant past-performance experience from proposed sub-consultants or teaming partners to satisfy or supplement the three-reference requirement and the Proposer's Experience and Reputation evaluation criterion?	- The intention is to request three "separate" reference clients. - References provided are at the discretion of the Proposer and can be from any experience that compares favorably to the services requested within this RFP.
147. Section 5.2 states that the proposer shall be compliant with the Texas Risk and Authorization Management Program (TX-RAMP) "as may be required." Please clarify whether TX-RAMP certification is required for this engagement if the proposer provides consulting, custom development, workflow automation, AI governance, and analytics services using TTUHSC-approved or TTUHSC-controlled infrastructure and does not provide a separately hosted cloud or SaaS product.	- Under Texas Government Code § 2054.0593 and Texas Department of Information Resources guidelines, TX-RAMP applies specifically to Cloud Service Providers offering hosted cloud computing services (SaaS, PaaS, IaaS). - If a proposal does not include the above, TX-RAMP likely would not apply.
148. Section 5.4 includes executive alignment sessions, leadership workshops, workforce training, workflow discovery, implementation support, and ongoing project management activities. Please clarify the anticipated amount of work that must be performed in person at TTUHSC locations versus work that may be performed remotely. If on-site participation is expected, please identify the anticipated locations, frequency, and approximate number of on-site days or sessions.	TTUHSC expects some on-site presence but does not have strict requirements for delivery frequency or duration. A predominantly virtual/hybrid model is acceptable, with on-site presence concentrated at defined milestones such as executive alignment sessions and leadership workshops. The initial kickoff is preferred on all campuses (negotiable), and the leadership enablement meeting is preferred on-site in Lubbock, TX. Overall, a hybrid model is preferred. Travel is to be included in the fee.
149. Section 3.7 states that TTUHSC has determined subcontracting opportunities are probable and requires submission of a completed VetHUB Subcontracting Plan. For a proposer that intends to self-perform a substantial portion of the engagement but may use specialized subcontractors for selected workstreams, please clarify the required good-faith effort, outreach, and documentation that must be completed before proposal submission. Please also clarify whether the proposer must identify specific subcontractors at the time of proposal submission or may identify subcontracting categories and finalize individual firms after award.	- A self-performance designation is considered responsive. - Good faith effort requires prime contractors and agencies to document active outreach to certified Service Disabled Veteran Owned Businesses when subcontracting opportunities exist. - VetHUB Subcontracting Plan may be modified after submission or post-award, with prior written approval from TTUHSC's VetHUB Coordinator.

150. Section 6.2 states that TTUHSC’s standard payment terms are Net 30, and Appendix A provides for payment for each deliverable upon completion. Please clarify the process and expected timeframe for TTUHSC review and acceptance of each completed deliverable prior to invoicing. Please also clarify whether partial or milestone-based invoicing within a major deliverable may be permitted when the work spans an extended period.	• TTUHSC is required to operate in accordance with Texas Government Code, Chapter 2251. • As deliverables, milestones or other tangible work product is finalized, TTUHSC is amenable to considering fair and appropriate payment schedules in accordance and reasonable periods for review and acceptance.
151. Please clarify whether TTUHSC intends to award all six deliverables/workstreams to a single contractor, or whether TTUHSC may make multiple or partial awards to different proposers for individual deliverables or workstreams. If multiple or partial awards are contemplated, may a proposer submit pricing and a technical response for selected deliverables/workstreams rather than the entire scope?	• It is TTUHSC’s intention to issue a single award, however in accordance with the terms of the RFP, reserves the right to award an agreement for all or any portion of the requirements proposed by reason of this request, award multiple agreements, or to reject any and all proposals if deemed to be in the best interests of TTUHSC and to resolicit for proposals, or temporarily or permanently abandon the solicitation.
152. Section 5.4 states that TTUHSC has already provisioned enterprise AI tools, including Large Language Models and embedded AI productivity assistants, and requires adoption analytics, workforce training, workflow redesign, and custom integrations. For proposal planning and pricing purposes, please provide the approximate number of employees/users expected to be in scope, the primary enterprise AI platforms/tools currently deployed, and any major systems or platforms expected to be integrated with the proposed services. If exact figures or product names cannot be provided during the solicitation, please provide reasonable planning assumptions that proposers should use.	• Total number of employees: about 6,000. Abilene: ~100; Amarillo: ~700; Dallas: ~90; Lubbock: ~3,710; Permian Basin: ~600; Strategic Initiatives (Correctional Managed Care): ~800. • Functional domains (some groups overlap): Clinical: ~2,000; Academic: ~2,000; Research: ~1,300; Other (Admin, Operational, Supporting): ~2,000. Number of leaders: around 150-200. • The initial rollout will target about 3,000 individuals. • Microsoft Copilot is currently the enterprise generative AI tool that has been deployed. Other GenAI tools are being evaluated. Examples of other tools provided enterprise-wide include Zoom AI Companion, Epic, Grammarly, etc. Major systems expected to be integrated will be prioritized with the Contractor based on the current-state assessment.
153. Section 6 requests not-to-exceed fixed-fee pricing by deliverable, while portions of the scope may depend on factors such as the number and complexity of workflows selected, integrations required, users trained, and custom solutions developed. Please clarify the assumptions proposers should use when establishing fixed-fee pricing, including any anticipated quantities or ranges for workflows, integrations, training participants/cohorts, prototypes, and production implementations. Please also confirm how work exceeding the stated or agreed assumptions would be handled through the resource rate card and change-order process.	• Costing for any solution offered is at the discretion of the Proposer. Cost breakdown that includes fixed fee assumptions is not a differentiator for TTUHSC reviewers. Please ensure costing is clear and discernable to the evaluating reader. • Any modifications to price through a change order process would require an amendment to the contract that may require approvals up to and including the Texas Tech System Board of Regents. All costing increases would require confirmation of best value on the basis of Contractor Proposal, Proposal Rate Card, and resulting contract award.
154. Appendix A addresses ownership of work product produced under the resulting agreement. Please clarify the treatment of a contractor’s pre-existing intellectual property, proprietary methodologies, software components, reusable code, frameworks, templates, models, automation tools, and other materials developed independently of this engagement. May the contractor retain ownership of such pre-existing materials while granting TTUHSC the rights necessary to use project-specific deliverables produced under the agreement?	• Please note from Section 7 – GENERAL TERMS AND CONDITIONS. • <i>If Proposer takes exception to any of the Required Terms, Proposer will submit a list of the exceptions as part of its proposal.</i> • It is not the intention of TTUHSC to make claim to pre-existing intellectual property.
155. Section 5.4 requires compliance with HIPAA, FERPA, Texas DIR requirements, access controls, encryption, and restrictions on use of TTUHSC data. Please clarify whether the selected contractor is expected to access, receive, store, transmit, or process protected health information (PHI), personally identifiable information (PII), or other regulated institutional data during this engagement. If access to PHI is anticipated, please confirm whether TTUHSC will require execution of a Business Associate Agreement and whether proposers	• PHI is not expected to be made available; TTUHSC has test patient data that may be used, and data will be made available based on need. Where any PHI is involved, the Business Associate Agreement would apply. • The Business Associate Agreement would be executed where the approved scope of work requires access to PHI; it is included so that it is in place if PHI access is required. Sanitized/de-identified data may be used for discovery, prototyping, training, and testing; production clinical data is not expected to be used.

should assume that production clinical data will be used, or whether sanitized/de-identified data may be used for discovery, prototyping, training, and testing activities.																																					
156. Section 5.4 identifies six required deliverables, but the project schedule currently leaves the kick-off date and completion dates for Deliverables 1 through 6 blank. Please provide TTUHSC's anticipated contract start/kick-off date, desired completion date for each deliverable, and any firm deadlines or sequencing dependencies that proposers should use when developing the proposed project schedule, staffing plan, and pricing. If exact dates have not yet been established, please provide the anticipated overall project duration and preferred timing between major deliverables.	- The following proposed Project Schedule may change based on RFP progress: - Kick-off meeting: February 2027; - Deliverable 1: April 2027; - Deliverable 2: April 2027; - Deliverable 3: September 2027; - Deliverable 4: September 2027; - Deliverable 5: December 2027; - Deliverable 6: February 2028. - TTUHSC is seeking completion of all deliverables and will work collaboratively in constructing a contract term that accommodates that position. - Proposers may propose the schedule and sequencing within the term; TTUHSC will work collaboratively on dependencies.																																				
157. Appendix A requires employer's liability and workers' compensation insurance, as well as general liability and automobile insurance with stated limits, and provides that certificates of insurance are due prior to commencement of services. Please clarify the complete insurance requirements applicable to this engagement, including required limits for general liability, workers' compensation/employer's liability, automobile liability, professional/errors and omissions liability, and cyber/privacy liability, if applicable. Please also clarify whether automobile coverage is required when project personnel do not use owned vehicles in performance of the work, and whether any insurance requirements may be satisfied or adjusted based on the proposer's business structure and actual scope of services.	See the standard requirements associated with services provided to TTUHSC. TTUHSC in concert with the TTU System Risk Management Office does consider modifications based on applicability: Presence on TTUHSC's premises of Supplier's employees, agents, suppliers or subcontractors (if any), Supplier agrees to maintain and to cause its agents, suppliers and subcontractors (if any) to maintain the following insurance coverages for at least the specified limits: <table border="1" data-bbox="829 846 1528 1583"> <thead> <tr> <th>Coverages:</th><th>Limits:</th></tr> </thead> <tbody> <tr> <td>Commercial General Liability</td><td></td></tr> <tr> <td>General Aggregate</td><td>\$2,000,000</td></tr> <tr> <td>Products/Completed Operations Aggregate</td><td>\$2,000,000</td></tr> <tr> <td>Each Occurrence Limit</td><td>\$1,000,000</td></tr> <tr> <td>Personal/Advertising Injury</td><td>\$1,000,000</td></tr> <tr> <td>Damage to Rented Premises</td><td>\$50,000</td></tr> <tr> <td>Medical Payments (Any One Person)</td><td>\$5,000</td></tr> <tr> <td>Liquor Liability (if applicable)</td><td></td></tr> <tr> <td>Each Occurrence</td><td>\$1,000,000</td></tr> <tr> <td>Aggregate</td><td>\$2,000,000</td></tr> <tr> <td>Automobile Liability</td><td></td></tr> <tr> <td>Bodily Injury/Property Damage (Each Accident)</td><td>\$1,000,000</td></tr> <tr> <td>Personal Injury Protection (if applicable)</td><td>Statutory</td></tr> <tr> <td>Workers' Compensation</td><td></td></tr> <tr> <td>Coverage A (Workers' Compensation)</td><td>Statutory</td></tr> <tr> <td>Coverage B (Employers' Liability)</td><td>\$1,000,000 \$1,000,000 \$1,000,000</td></tr> <tr> <td>Crime Coverage (if applicable)</td><td>50% of the contract value; or \$100,000, whichever is greater</td></tr> </tbody> </table>	Coverages:	Limits:	Commercial General Liability		General Aggregate	\$2,000,000	Products/Completed Operations Aggregate	\$2,000,000	Each Occurrence Limit	\$1,000,000	Personal/Advertising Injury	\$1,000,000	Damage to Rented Premises	\$50,000	Medical Payments (Any One Person)	\$5,000	Liquor Liability (if applicable)		Each Occurrence	\$1,000,000	Aggregate	\$2,000,000	Automobile Liability		Bodily Injury/Property Damage (Each Accident)	\$1,000,000	Personal Injury Protection (if applicable)	Statutory	Workers' Compensation		Coverage A (Workers' Compensation)	Statutory	Coverage B (Employers' Liability)	\$1,000,000 \$1,000,000 \$1,000,000	Crime Coverage (if applicable)	50% of the contract value; or \$100,000, whichever is greater
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158. Section 6.1 requires proposers to include travel and attendance-related costs within the not-to-exceed fixed fee for each deliverable, while Appendix A states that travel expenses may be reimbursed if pre-approved in writing and subject to applicable Texas Comptroller rates. Please clarify whether proposers should include all anticipated travel costs within the fixed-fee pricing, or whether approved travel may be invoiced separately in addition to the fixed fee. If travel should be included in the fixed fee, please provide the anticipated on-site locations and expected frequency of travel that proposers should use for pricing assumptions.	Travel and attendance-related costs are to be included within the not-to-exceed fixed fee for each deliverable per Section 6.1; approved travel is not separately invoiced in addition to the fixed fee. TTUHSC expects some on-site presence but does not have strict requirements for delivery frequency or duration. A predominantly virtual/hybrid model is acceptable, with on-site presence concentrated at defined milestones such as executive alignment sessions and leadership workshops. The initial kickoff is preferred on all campuses (negotiable), and the leadership enablement meeting is preferred on-site in Lubbock, TX. Overall, a hybrid model is preferred. The Proposer may state its on-site assumptions for pricing.																																				

159. The RFP identifies six major deliverables and provides for payment upon completion of each deliverable, but it does not specify detailed acceptance criteria, review cycles, or revision limits for each deliverable. Please clarify whether TTUHSC will establish written acceptance criteria for each deliverable at project kickoff or during development of the Project Plan. Please also clarify the anticipated review period, number of revision cycles, and process for resolving requested changes that are outside the originally agreed scope or acceptance criteria.	• Deliverable acceptance is by the Chief AI Transformation Officer, the AI Steering Committee, and the President, and will depend on TTUHSC review cycles. • TTUHSC will establish written acceptance criteria at kickoff or during the Project Plan; review periods, revision cycles, and the process for out-of-scope changes (handled through the change-order process) will be agreed in the Agreement.
160. Section 5.4 includes custom development, API integrations, workflow automation, analytics, and agentic AI capabilities. Please clarify what level of access TTUHSC expects to provide to the selected contractor for relevant enterprise systems, APIs, identity platforms, data sources, and AI tools. Please also clarify whether TTUHSC will provide appropriate development, sandbox, or test environments for prototyping and integration work before any production deployment. If access restrictions or approval processes are anticipated, please identify any major security, onboarding, credentialing, or technical review requirements that proposers should account for in their project schedule and pricing.	• Access to relevant enterprise systems, APIs, identity platforms, data sources, and AI tools will be provided based on need and coordinated with TTUHSC IT. TTUHSC will not provide a dedicated sandbox, private tenant, or hosted environment for prototype development unless otherwise specified in the solicitation or subsequent contract documents. Proposers should assume responsibility for providing and managing any environments required to develop, host, demonstrate, and test proposed AI solutions. Any vendor-hosted environment used to store, process, or transmit TTUHSC data must comply with the security, privacy, and regulatory requirements defined in the RFP, including any applicable State of Texas and TTUHSC requirements. Security, onboarding, credentialing, and technical review requirements will be coordinated with TTUHSC and should be accounted for in the schedule.
161. Please clarify any security review, vendor risk assessment, background screening, training, credentialing, or onboarding requirements that the selected contractor and its personnel or subcontractors must complete before receiving access to TTUHSC systems, data, facilities, or production environments. Please also identify whether these requirements are expected to occur before contract execution, before project kickoff, or during implementation, and whether TTUHSC anticipates any associated lead times that proposers should include in the project schedule.	• Vendor personnel access requirements - such as security review/vendor risk assessment, background checks, HIPAA training, credentialing, and badging - will be coordinated with TTUHSC based on the systems accessed, generally before project kickoff or before access is granted. Credentialing lead times will be provided at onboarding and should be reflected in the schedule.
162. Section 5.4 permits respondents to propose analytics platforms, custom engineering, model orchestration, and other technology-enabled approaches, while also imposing restrictions on institutional data usage and requiring compliance with TTUHSC security and privacy requirements. Please clarify whether proposers may include third-party commercial AI services, cloud-hosted model APIs, analytics platforms, or other external technology components as part of the proposed solution. If permitted, please identify any required security review, contracting, data residency, hosting, or vendor-approval requirements that should be incorporated into the proposal, schedule, and pricing. Please also clarify whether TTUHSC prefers solutions to operate primarily within existing TTUHSC-approved technology environments rather than introducing new externally hosted platforms.	• Third-party commercial AI services, cloud-hosted model APIs, and analytics platforms may be included where they meet the RFP's security and data-privacy requirements, subject to TTUHSC security review and any required contracting/data-residency terms. The preference is to operate primarily within existing TTUHSC-approved technology environments before introducing new externally hosted platforms.
163. Section 5.3 requires proposers to identify key individuals, including sub-consultants, along with their qualifications, expected involvement, and time commitments. Section 5.4 also requires the contractor to designate a Project Lead. Please clarify whether proposed key personnel are considered committed for the full engagement and whether TTUHSC approval is required before replacing a Project Lead, key team member, or sub-consultant after award. If substitutions are permitted, please clarify whether replacement personnel must possess equal or greater qualifications and whether resumes or other documentation must be submitted for approval.	• Proposed key personnel are considered committed for the engagement; substitution of a Project Lead, key team member, or sub-consultant after award requires TTUHSC approval, and replacement personnel are expected to possess equal or greater qualifications, with resumes submitted for approval.

164. Please clarify whether there is a page limit for the technical proposal or any individual response section. Please also confirm whether resumes, project examples/case studies, organizational charts, implementation schedules, technical diagrams, and other supporting materials may be included as appendices or attachments without counting toward any applicable page limit. If there are formatting requirements such as font size, margins, file-size limits, or maximum number of uploaded files, please identify those requirements.	No limit exists as a requirement under the RFP. Please ensure proposals are clear and discernable to the evaluating reader.
165. Please clarify the required period for which proposals and pricing must remain valid following the September 21, 2026 proposal deadline. Please also provide TTUHSC's anticipated evaluation, negotiation, notice-of-award, and contract execution timeline, including the approximate date on which the selected contractor should expect to begin performance.	Each proposal must state that it will remain valid for TTUHSC's acceptance for a minimum of ninety (90) days after the Submittal Deadline, to allow time for evaluation, selection, and any unforeseen delays.
166. Section 5.3 requires at least three references from current or recent clients and requests contact information for each reference. Please clarify whether TTUHSC intends to contact all submitted references during evaluation and whether proposers may submit more than three references. Please also clarify whether references from private-sector, higher-education, healthcare, or government clients are weighted differently, and what TTUHSC considers "recent" for purposes of this requirement.	- References provided are at the discretion of the Proposer and can be from any sector that compares favorably to the services requested within this RFP. - Additional references beyond the three minimum is acceptable. - The RFP evaluation committee may contact references provided as a component of their evaluation.
167. Section 4.5 states that selected proposers may be invited to participate in oral presentations or interviews. Please clarify whether any oral presentation or interview would be conducted virtually or in person, the anticipated duration and format, the expected TTUHSC audience, and whether specific proposed key personnel would be required to participate. Please also clarify whether demonstrations of proposed technology, prototypes, dashboards, workflow automations, or other solution components may be requested as part of the presentation or interview process.	TTUHSC will provide an agenda with many of these answers to any finalist presenters in advance of any presentation request.
168. Section 4.3 assigns 15% of the evaluation to Proposer's Experience and Reputation, and Section 5.3 requires identification of key individuals and sub-consultants proposed for the project team. Please clarify how TTUHSC will evaluate the experience and reputation of a proposer that uses a team consisting of the prime contractor and one or more sub-consultants. Will TTUHSC consider the combined qualifications, relevant project experience, certifications, and past performance of the proposed team, or will this evaluation criterion primarily consider experience performed directly by the prime contractor?	TTUHSC will evaluate on the basis of the full proposal solution presented regardless of role designation by resources proposed.
169. Section 5.4 requires solution engineering and prototyping and also refers to deploying workflow automations, custom AI integrations, and agentic AI capabilities. Please clarify whether the selected contractor is expected to deliver production-ready implementations for identified use cases, or whether the required scope is primarily discovery, design, functional prototyping, validation, and handoff to TTUHSC personnel for production deployment. If production deployment is expected, please clarify the anticipated number of production solutions and whether TTUHSC technical staff will participate in deployment, testing, security review, and ongoing support.	The required scope is primarily discovery, design, functional prototyping, validation, and handoff to TTUHSC personnel. Solutions should be pilot-ready or production-ready; TTUHSC anticipates about 8-10 workflows, with production hosting/support treated as optional items. TTUHSC technical staff will participate as appropriate, and TTUHSC plans to operate and maintain deliverables internally after the term.

170. Appendix A, Section 1.3 provides that all writings, reports, or other materials produced relating to the services shall be deemed “works made for hire” owned by University “without any restrictions.” Will TTUHSC confirm whether this provision is intended to apply to the project-specific deliverables described in Section 5.4 and Exhibit “A,” rather than to a Contractor's pre-existing methodologies, frameworks, templates, instruments, tools, models, and software that a Contractor brings to the engagement and uses to produce those deliverables?	- Please note from Section 7 – GENERAL TERMS AND CONDITIONS. <i>If Proposer takes exception to any of the Required Terms, Proposer will submit a list of the exceptions as part of its proposal.</i> - It is not the intention of TTUHSC to make claim to pre-existing intellectual property.
171. Appendix A, Section 1.26.1 expressly recognizes materials “in the possession of Consultant prior to this Agreement.” Is Section 1.26.1 intended to inform the scope of Section 1.3, such that pre-existing Contractor materials remain outside the works-made-for-hire transfer while TTUHSC receives full and unrestricted rights to the deliverables themselves and to their continued internal use, modification, and re-use?	It is not the intention of TTUHSC to make claim to pre-existing intellectual property.
172. Where a Contractor's pre-existing framework or instrument is embedded within, or necessary to the ongoing use of, a delivered work product, will TTUHSC accept a perpetual, irrevocable, royalty-free license to that embedded component — sufficient to permit unrestricted institutional use, including after the term and by any successor contractor — as an alternative to outright assignment?	It is not the intention of TTUHSC to make claim to pre-existing intellectual property.
173. Appendix A, Section 1.4 provides that Consultant will not remove intellectual property from University premises without prior written consent. Will TTUHSC confirm how this provision is applied to (a) a Contractor's own pre-existing materials brought onto a campus, and (b) work performed remotely rather than on University premises?	It is not the intention of TTUHSC to make claim to pre-existing intellectual property.
174. Section 7 provides that exceptions to the Required Terms may result in disqualification as non-responsive. Will TTUHSC address clarifications concerning the Agreement's intellectual property provisions by Addendum applicable to all proposers, so that proposers seeking clarification rather than modification are not required to submit those items as exceptions under Section 7?	It is not the intention of TTUHSC to disqualify any Proposer or proposal. However, TTUHSC reserves that right in the event contractual differences would result in negotiation deadlock, likely compromising the ability to meet RFP objectives.
175. Appendix B, Section 1.1.6 provides that Proposer “will not delegate any of its duties or responsibilities ... to any sub-contractor, except as expressly provided in the Agreement,” and Appendix A, Section 1.27 requires prior written approval to subcontract. Will TTUHSC confirm that sub-consultants identified in the proposal under Section 5.3 (“Project Team ... including sub-consultants if applicable”) and in the VetHUB Subcontracting Plan, and incorporated into the resulting Agreement, satisfy both the “expressly provided in the Agreement” standard of Section 1.1.6 and the prior-written-approval requirement of Section 1.27?	Very likely. Any delegation would be documented in the award agreement, evidencing TTUHSC acceptance.
176. If a named sub-consultant must be added, replaced, or re-scoped after award, what approval process and lead time does TTUHSC anticipate, and does any such change require an amendment to the VetHUB Subcontracting Plan?	Changes to this area would require an amendment or other form or executed change document and may additionally require an updated VetHUB Subcontracting Plan.
177. Under the Section 4.3.2 evaluation weighting, how will TTUHSC evaluate proposals that allocate defined workstreams among a prime and named sub-consultants? Specifically, is the allocation of work among team members itself a consideration under Proposer's Service Specifications (55%), under Proposer's Experience and Reputation (15%), or both?	Potentially both.

178. Do the Section 5.2 minimum requirements and certifications — including TX-RAMP compliance, the Section 889 and Section 1260H NDAA certifications, and the foreign adversaries certifications — apply solely to the Proposer, or must each named sub-consultant independently satisfy and certify to them?	The responsibility will lie with the Contractor that executes the award agreement.
179. Section 3.7 states that TTUHSC has determined subcontracting opportunities are probable under this RFP and identifies NIGP commodity code 91878. Beyond submission of the required VetHUB Subcontracting Plan, does TTUHSC have specific subcontracting goals, percentages, or preferred workshare expectations for this procurement?	180. VetHUB goals, etc., can be viewed here: https://www.fiscal.ttuhsc.edu/purchasing/hub/findavendor.aspx
181. Section 5.3 requests identification of key individuals with their “expected amount of involvement and time commitment.” Does TTUHSC expect all key personnel to be committed by name at proposal submission, or is a combination of named leadership and described role profiles for delivery staff acceptable?	The response to this requirement is at the discretion of the Proposer.
182. Section 5.2 requires that Proposer “is in compliant with the Texas Risk and Authorization Management Program (TX-RAMP) as may be required.” Under what circumstances does TTUHSC consider TX-RAMP certification to be required for this engagement — specifically, does it attach to cloud computing services or hosted software components that store or process TTUHSC data, or to the consulting Contractor independent of any hosted platform? If required, must certification be in place at proposal submission, at award, or prior to deployment of any applicable component?	- Under Texas Government Code § 2054.0593 and Texas Department of Information Resources guidelines, TX-RAMP applies specifically to Cloud Service Providers offering hosted cloud computing services (SaaS, PaaS, IaaS). - If it applies, certification would be required prior to award. Note the DIR program includes - Provisional Status - Granted for up to 18 months while a full product assessment is underway.
183. The RFP includes a Business Associate Agreement. Does TTUHSC anticipate that performance of the scope described in Section 5.4 will require Contractor access to PHI or EPHI, or may the engagement be structured around sanitized, de-identified, limited-data-set, or synthetic institutional data — consistent with Section 5.4.C.3, which directs that training modules leverage “practical, sanitized institutional scenarios”?	Yes. The engagement may be structured around sanitized, de-identified, limited-data-set, or synthetic institutional data, consistent with Section 5.4.C.3. PHI/ePHI access is not anticipated; TTUHSC has test patient data that may be used.
184. Is execution of the Business Associate Agreement required of every awarded Contractor, or only where the approved scope of work requires access to PHI or EPHI?	The Business Associate Agreement would be executed where the approved scope of work requires access to PHI; it is included so that it is in place if PHI access is required.
185. Section 5.4.F.3 requires Role-Based Access Control, single sign-on integration (SAML 2.0 / OAuth2), encryption in transit (TLS 1.3), and encryption at rest (AES-256). Will TTUHSC confirm that these controls apply to software components or data-transfer mechanisms introduced by the Contractor, and that Contractor personnel working within TTUHSC-provisioned environments operate under TTUHSC's existing enterprise controls?	Yes. RBAC, SSO (SAML 2.0/OAuth2), encryption in transit (TLS 1.3), and encryption at rest (AES-256) apply to software components and data-transfer mechanisms introduced by the Contractor. Contractor personnel working within TTUHSC-provisioned environments operate under TTUHSC's existing enterprise controls.
186. Business Associate Agreement Section 1.53.11 restricts access, storage, transmission, use, or disclosure of PHI beyond the boundaries and jurisdiction of the United States. Does TTUHSC apply an equivalent U.S.-boundary requirement to non-PHI institutional data handled under this engagement, including any hosted analytics or reporting components?	This restriction applies to all institutional data.
187. Section 5.4.F.2 prohibits use of institutional data to train, fine-tune, or improve vendor, public, or third-party models. Will TTUHSC provide the list of enterprise-approved AI models and platforms, together with any required data-residency or model-hosting environments, that are to be used for institutional use cases under this engagement?	- Microsoft Copilot is currently the enterprise generative AI tool that has been deployed. Other GenAI tools are being evaluated. Examples of other tools provided enterprise-wide include Zoom AI Companion, Epic, Grammarly, etc. - Institutional data shall not be used to train, fine-tune, or improve vendor, public, or third-party models. Enterprise-approved models and any required data-residency/model-hosting environments will be confirmed with the

	selected Contractor.
188. The Section 5.4 Objective references adoption across “academic, administrative, clinical, and research operational units.” Does the clinical component of the initial engagement contemplate integration with clinical systems or electronic health record environments, or is it directed to administrative and workforce workflows within clinical operational units?	The clinical component is directed to administrative and workforce workflows within clinical operational units, though the clinical scope may extend to clinical decision support, diagnostic, and patient-facing applications, subject to human-in-the-loop controls and clinical validation before any production deployment. Integration with clinical/EHR systems will be prioritized with the Contractor based on the current-state assessment.
189. Section 5.4.D.2 requires functional prototypes “including bespoke application development, API integrations, and custom model orchestration where warranted.” Will TTUHSC confirm that the type and volume of such engineering work is contingent upon the findings of the Workflow Discovery and Opportunity Mapping activity (Section 5.4.D.1), rather than a fixed quantity established at proposal? If TTUHSC has a planning assumption for the number of automations, prototypes, custom applications, or API integrations anticipated during the initial term, that figure would materially assist proposers in scoping level of effort.	Yes. The type and volume of engineering work is contingent on the findings of Workflow Discovery and Opportunity Mapping rather than a fixed quantity established at proposal. For planning, TTUHSC anticipates about 8-10 workflows across the four functional areas.
190. The Section 5.4 Background states that TTUHSC has already provisioned enterprise AI tools, including Large Language Models and embedded AI productivity assistants. Will TTUHSC identify the currently provisioned and approved enterprise AI platforms, productivity assistants, automation platforms, integration tooling, cloud environments, and analytics or business-intelligence platforms expected to be used under this engagement?	- Microsoft Copilot is currently the enterprise generative AI tool that has been deployed. Other GenAI tools are being evaluated. Examples of other tools provided enterprise-wide include Zoom AI Companion, Epic, Grammarly, etc. - TTUHSC operates within a Microsoft enterprise environment. Power BI is available; the analytics/BI, automation, integration tooling, and cloud environments expected to be used will be confirmed with the selected Contractor.
191. Section 5.4 states that the specification does not mandate a single proprietary methodology or commercial software delivery mechanism. Does TTUHSC prefer that proposed solutions be built primarily on its existing approved enterprise tools before additional platforms or software are introduced?	TTUHSC operates within a Microsoft enterprise environment. The preference is to build on TTUHSC's existing approved enterprise tools where practical; additional platforms or software may be proposed where warranted. There is no mandated single proprietary methodology or delivery mechanism.
192. Section 5.4.E permits delivery “via a software platform, managed analytics services, or integrated reporting tools.” Will TTUHSC confirm that Deliverable 5 may be satisfied through integration with TTUHSC's existing analytics and business-intelligence environment, and clarify whether licensing for any Contractor-furnished platform would be carried by the Contractor or procured by TTUHSC?	Yes. Deliverable 5 may be satisfied through integration with TTUHSC's existing analytics and business-intelligence environment; Power BI is available. Any Contractor-furnished platform licensing is at the Proposer's discretion to include (carried by the Contractor) rather than procured by TTUHSC unless otherwise agreed.
193. Section 5.4.E.4 requires ROI modeling “using TTUHSC-supplied baseline metrics and assumptions.” At what point in the engagement will these baseline metrics be provided, and will the Contractor be granted access to source system data necessary to validate them?	- Baseline metrics have not been established. TTUHSC conducted some AI baseline surveys in 2025 and 2026, but the Contractor is expected to bring a method for measuring the baseline and, later, the ROI. - Baseline metrics will be provided to the successful Contractor at kickoff where available; access to source-system data needed to validate them will be provided based on need.
194. For the purpose of scoping training delivery and executive workshops under Sections 5.4.B and 5.4.C, will TTUHSC indicate the approximate population in scope — total workforce, number of functional units, and number of leadership personnel (VPs, Deans, Department Heads, People Managers) — and confirm which of the five campuses are within the initial engagement?	- Total number of employees: about 6,000. Abilene: ~100; Amarillo: ~700; Dallas: ~90; Lubbock: ~3,710; Permian Basin: ~600; Strategic Initiatives (Correctional Managed Care): ~800. - Functional domains (some groups overlap): Clinical: ~2,000; Academic: ~2,000; Research: ~1,300; Other (Admin, Operational, Supporting): ~2,000. Number of leaders: around 150-200. - The initial rollout will target about 3,000 individuals. - All five campuses are within scope; on-site presence is concentrated at defined milestones, with the leadership enablement meeting preferred on-site in Lubbock.

195. What portion of executive workshops, training delivery, workflow-discovery sessions, implementation activity, and project management does TTUHSC anticipate will require on-site performance versus remote delivery, and across which campuses?	TTUHSC expects some on-site presence but does not have strict requirements for delivery frequency or duration. A predominantly virtual/hybrid model is acceptable, with on-site presence concentrated at defined milestones such as executive alignment sessions and leadership workshops. The initial kickoff is preferred on all campuses (negotiable), and the leadership enablement meeting is preferred on-site in Lubbock, TX. Overall, a hybrid model is preferred. Travel is to be included in the fee.
196. Section 5.3 states that “a desired project schedule has been included in Section 5.4 Services Specifications” and requests that proposers respond with their ability to meet that timeline. The Project Schedule at Section 5.4 lists the kick-off meeting and completion dates for Deliverables 1 through 6 as blank. Will TTUHSC provide target dates by Addendum, or should proposers propose the complete implementation schedule and sequencing?	- The following proposed Project Schedule may change based on RFP progress: - Kick-off meeting: February 2027; - Deliverable 1: April 2027; - Deliverable 2: April 2027; - Deliverable 3: September 2027; - Deliverable 4: September 2027; - Deliverable 5: December 2027; - Deliverable 6: February 2028. - TTUHSC is seeking completion of all deliverables and will work collaboratively in constructing a contract term that accommodates that position. - Proposers may propose the complete implementation schedule and sequencing; TTUHSC will work collaboratively on any target dates.
197. Section 2.3 indicates evaluation of proposals from September 21 through November 30, 2026, while Appendix A, Section 1.12 provides that the Agreement continues through August 31, 2027 irrespective of execution date. Does TTUHSC anticipate that all six deliverables will be completed within that period, or does TTUHSC contemplate renewal, extension, or a follow-on agreement for later-phase deliverables?	TTUHSC is seeking the completion of all deliverables and will work collaboratively in constructing a contract term that accommodates that position.
198. Section 6.1.1 requires a “not to exceed” fixed fee for each deliverable “including associated fees (i.e. printing costs, attendance at meetings, travel).” Appendix A, Section 1.9 provides that University will reimburse pre-approved travel at rates not exceeding current Texas Comptroller rates. Will TTUHSC confirm which governs — travel included within the fixed fee per deliverable, or travel reimbursed separately against the Comptroller schedule?	- TTUHSC requires a not to exceed fixed fee inclusive of travel. - For travel reimbursement within this framework, TTUHSC will reimburse pre-approved travel at rates not exceeding current Texas Comptroller rates.
199. Is the “not to exceed” amount established per deliverable individually, or as an aggregate not-to-exceed amount across all six deliverables for purposes of Appendix A, Section 1.9?	All six deliverables.
200. Section 1.3 authorizes other Texas institutions of higher education to contract under this RFP through the group purchasing method. Should proposers structure the hourly resource rate card required by Section 6.1.2 to accommodate participation by additional Texas institutions, and would any such participation be treated as a change order under the existing rate card?	Any participation by other Texas institutions would be wholly separate from the services contemplated under this RFP.
201. Section 2.2 requires that all questions and concerns be received no later than August 21, 2026. Will TTUHSC confirm the cutoff time and time zone for receipt of written questions on that date?	11:59PM
202. Section 3.1 requires one complete copy of the proposal, and Section 3.2 indicates a preference for submission through the TechBid system. Are there file format, file size, or page limitations applicable to proposal documents uploaded through TechBid, and does TTUHSC prefer a single consolidated file or separately uploaded components corresponding to the Submittal Checklist?	- No limit exists as a requirement under the RFP. Please ensure proposals are clear and discernable to the evaluating reader. - As a best practice, TTUHSC finds that a single file upload is most advantages in presenting information in the form and order intended for the evaluation team readers.
203. Existing Enterprise AI Environment: Section 5.4 states that TTUHSC has provisioned enterprise AI tools, including Large Language Models (LLMs) and embedded AI productivity assistants. Please identify the primary enterprise AI platforms and productivity	Microsoft Copilot is currently the enterprise generative AI tool that has been deployed. Other GenAI tools are being evaluated. Examples of other tools provided enterprise-wide include Zoom AI Companion, Epic, Grammarly, etc.

assistants currently approved or deployed by TTUHSC that the selected Contractor will be expected to support or integrate with.	
204. Technology and Cloud Environment: Does TTUHSC have preferred or existing cloud, AI, data, integration, or automation platforms that respondents should prioritize when developing the proposed technical approach? If so, please identify those platforms.	• TTUHSC operates within a Microsoft enterprise environment. Power BI is available. The Proposer may prioritize TTUHSC's existing Microsoft environment and tooling; either building on existing tooling or a proposed approach is acceptable, with no preference.
205. Workforce Training Population: For purposes of developing the staffing model, level of effort, project schedule, and fixed-fee pricing for Deliverable 3, please provide an approximate number of employees expected to participate in the workforce upskilling and training program, including any estimated breakdown by functional group or role, if available.	• Total number of employees: about 6,000. Abilene: ~100; Amarillo: ~700; Dallas: ~90; Lubbock: ~3,710; Permian Basin: ~600; Strategic Initiatives (Correctional Managed Care): ~800. • Functional domains (some groups overlap): Clinical: ~2,000; Academic: ~2,000; Research: ~1,300; Other (Admin, Operational, Supporting): ~2,000. Number of leaders: around 150-200. The Proposer may recommend the staffing model and level of effort based on the readiness assessment. • The initial rollout will target about 3,000 individuals.
206. Training Delivery Expectations: Does TTUHSC anticipate a minimum number of onsite instructor-led workshops or executive sessions at its campuses, or may respondents propose an appropriate combination of onsite, live virtual, self-paced, and other training methods based on the proposed adoption strategy?	• Respondents may propose an appropriate combination of onsite, live virtual, and self-paced methods based on the adoption strategy. TTUHSC expects some on-site presence but does not have strict requirements for delivery frequency or duration. A predominantly virtual/hybrid model is acceptable, with on-site presence concentrated at defined milestones such as executive alignment sessions and leadership workshops. The initial kickoff is preferred on all campuses (negotiable), and the leadership enablement meeting is preferred on-site in Lubbock, TX. Overall, a hybrid model is preferred. Travel is to be included in the fee.
207. TX-RAMP Applicability: Section 5.2 requires TX-RAMP compliance "as may be required." Please clarify whether TX-RAMP certification is required of the consulting Contractor itself or only for Contractor-provided cloud computing services that receive, process, or store TTUHSC data. If the Contractor performs advisory, training, integration, or development services utilizing TTUHSC-approved platforms without providing a separate cloud service, please confirm whether TX-RAMP certification would be required.	• Under Texas Government Code § 2054.0593 and Texas Department of Information Resources guidelines, TX-RAMP applies specifically to Cloud Service Providers offering hosted cloud computing services (SaaS, PaaS, IaaS). • If a proposal does not include the above, TX-RAMP likely would not apply.
208. Client References: Section 5.3 requires at least three current or recent client references whose services include specifications and requirements most similar to those described in the RFP. May the three references collectively demonstrate relevant experience across the required service areas (e.g., AI strategy/governance, workforce enablement, workflow automation, analytics, security, and change management), or is each individual reference expected to demonstrate substantially the full scope of services described in Section 5.4?	• References provided are at the discretion of the Proposer and can be from any experience that compares favorably to the services requested within this RFP.
209. Teaming and Sub-Consultant Experience: Section 5.3 permits proposers to identify sub-consultants as members of the proposed project team. For purposes of demonstrating experience and reputation, may a prime proposer include relevant past performance, client references, and qualifications of proposed sub-consultants and key personnel as part of the team's demonstrated experience?	• References provided are at the discretion of the Proposer and can be from any experience that compares favorably to the services requested within this RFP.
210. Sections 2.2 and 2.3 set the written-question deadline as August 21, 2026, with no time of day. What is the official cutoff time in Central Time? Please confirm that email to solicitations@ttuhsc.edu is the only accepted channel, and that Jaggaer / TechBid Q&A is not a substitute.	• 11:59PM • RFP instructions require submission by email at solicitations@ttuhsc.edu, however TTUHSC will not discount questions received through the TechBid Q&A portal.

211. Section 5.2 says the proposer “is in compliant with the Texas Risk and Authorization Management Program (TX-RAMP) as may be required.” Is TX-RAMP authorization required in the proposal, only if we host a cloud or SaaS analytics or agent platform, or not required if the work runs in TTUHSC’s already-approved environment on TTUHSC-provisioned models? If TX-RAMP applies, which level?	- Under Texas Government Code § 2054.0593 and Texas Department of Information Resources guidelines, TX-RAMP applies specifically to Cloud Service Providers offering hosted cloud computing services (SaaS, PaaS, IaaS). - If a proposal does not include the above, TX-RAMP likely would not apply.
212. Appendix A includes a full Business Associate Agreement. Will the contractor be given PHI or ePHI, or can Deliverables 1–6 be performed on sanitized or non-PHI operational data only? If no PHI is shared, will TTUHSC still require the BAA?	PHI/ePHI is not expected to be shared; Deliverables 1-6 may be performed on sanitized or non-PHI operational data. The BAA would be executed where the approved scope requires PHI access; it is included so that it is in place if needed.
213. Section 5.4 F requires that services, platforms, and custom solutions strictly comply with FERPA, HIPAA, and Texas DIR policies. The RFP does not name SOC 2 or HITRUST as bid attachments. Will a proposal be deemed non-responsive if the prime cannot attach a current HIPAA, SOC 2 Type II, or HITRUST certificate at submission, provided the prime will sign the BAA if PHI is in scope and will meet Section 5.4 F technically?	A proposal will not be deemed non-responsive solely because the prime cannot attach a HIPAA, SOC 2 Type II, or HITRUST certificate at submission, provided the prime will sign the BAA if PHI is in scope and will meet the Section 5.4.F technical requirements. These certifications are not named as required bid attachments.
214. Deliverable 4 calls for workflow redesign specifications, functional automation prototypes/custom solutions, and an Agentic AI Governance Policy. Is that satisfied by working prototypes plus specifications, with TTUHSC IT owning production, or must the contractor deploy production-grade custom applications or agents in TTUHSC clinical or administrative systems by August 31, 2027? How many production use cases are expected?	- TTUHSC is planning to have at least two workflows/use cases from each functional area (Academic, Clinical, Research, and Admin) evaluated by the Contractor, for a total of about 8 to 10 workflows. Solutions should be either pilot-ready or fully production-ready; the associated cost should not be included in the fixed fee but may be listed as an optional item for TTUHSC to consider. - Working prototypes plus specifications satisfy Deliverable 4, with TTUHSC IT owning production; solutions should be pilot-ready or production-ready. TTUHSC anticipates about 8-10 workflows, with production deployment treated as an optional item.
215. Section 5.3.1 asks for at least three references from current or recent clients for services most similar to this RFP. Will three non-healthcare enterprise AI adoption or custom-workflow engagements count as “most similar,” or must the references be academic medical or HIPAA-covered? Separately, what numeric HUB subcontracting goal applies, and will a self-perform HSP (Section 3 justification) be accepted given TTUHSC already found subcontracting probable?	- References provided are at the discretion of the Proposer and can be from any experience that compares favorably to the services requested within this RFP. - A completed VetHub Subcontracting Plan indicating Proposer self performance is responsive. - VetHUB goals, etc., can be viewed here: https://www.fiscal.ttuhsc.edu/purchasing/hub/findavendor.aspx
216. Project Schedule: Section 5.4 lists the kickoff and completion dates for Deliverables 1–6 as blank. Should proposers develop and propose their own project schedule, or does TTUHSC have preferred completion dates or an anticipated project duration?	- The following proposed Project Schedule may change based on RFP progress: - Kick-off meeting: February 2027; - Deliverable 1: April 2027; - Deliverable 2: April 2027; - Deliverable 3: September 2027; - Deliverable 4: September 2027; - Deliverable 5: December 2027; - Deliverable 6: February 2028. - TTUHSC is seeking completion of all deliverables and will work collaboratively in constructing a contract term that accommodates that position.
217. TX-RAMP: Please confirm whether TX-RAMP certification is required for any SaaS, AI, analytics, workflow automation, or cloud-based platform proposed under this engagement. If required, please specify the applicable TX-RAMP certification level.	- Under Texas Government Code § 2054.0593 and Texas Department of Information Resources guidelines, TX-RAMP applies specifically to Cloud Service Providers offering hosted cloud computing services (SaaS, PaaS, IaaS). - If it applies, certification would be required prior to award. Note the DIR program includes - Provisional Status - Granted for up to 18 months while a full product assessment is underway.
218. HIPAA / PHI: Does TTUHSC anticipate that the selected contractor or its proposed solutions will access, process, store, or transmit Protected Health Information (PHI), thereby requiring execution of the Business Associate Agreement included in the RFP?	The Business Associate Agreement would be executed where the approved scope of work requires access to PHI; it is included so that it is in place if PHI access is required. PHI access is not anticipated; PHI is not expected to be made available.

219. Existing AI Environment: Please identify the enterprise AI tools/platforms currently provisioned by TTUHSC that the selected contractor will be expected to support or integrate with.	Microsoft Copilot is currently the enterprise generative AI tool that has been deployed. Other GenAI tools are being evaluated. Examples of other tools provided enterprise-wide include Zoom AI Companion, Epic, Grammarly, etc.
220. Incumbent Contractor: Is there an incumbent contractor currently providing similar AI strategy, enablement, training, automation, analytics, or related consulting services to TTUHSC? If so, please provide the incumbent contractor name, current scope of services, and contract expiration date, if available.	None.
221. User Population: Approximately how many TTUHSC employees/users should proposers consider when developing the approach and pricing for workforce training, change management, and adoption analytics?	- Total number of employees: about 6,000. Abilene: ~100; Amarillo: ~700; Dallas: ~90; Lubbock: ~3,710; Permian Basin: ~600; Strategic Initiatives (Correctional Managed Care): ~800. - Functional domains (some groups overlap): Clinical: ~2,000; Academic: ~2,000; Research: ~1,300; Other (Admin, Operational, Supporting): ~2,000. Number of leaders: around 150-200. - The initial rollout will target about 3,000 individuals.
222. Onsite Requirements: Please clarify whether services may be performed remotely or if onsite presence is required for workshops, training, discovery sessions, or other activities. If onsite participation is expected, please identify the anticipated campus location(s) and frequency.	TTUHSC expects some on-site presence but does not have strict requirements for delivery frequency or duration. A predominantly virtual/hybrid model is acceptable, with on-site presence concentrated at defined milestones such as executive alignment sessions and leadership workshops. The initial kickoff is preferred on all campuses (negotiable), and the leadership enablement meeting is preferred on-site in Lubbock, TX. Overall, a hybrid model is preferred. Travel is to be included in the fee.
223. VetHUB/HUB Subcontracting: Please confirm whether TTUHSC has established a specific HUB/VetHUB subcontracting participation goal or percentage for this RFP.	VetHUB goals, etc., can be viewed here: https://www.fiscal.ttuhsc.edu/purchasing/hub/findavendor.aspx
224. Budget: Has TTUHSC established an anticipated budget, not-to-exceed amount, or funding range for this engagement?	The cost shall not exceed \$750,000.
225. Adoption Analytics: Will TTUHSC provide the selected contractor with the necessary administrative access, APIs, usage telemetry, and baseline data from its existing enterprise AI tools to support the adoption, proficiency, and ROI measurement requirements in Section 5.4?	Yes. TTUHSC will provide the selected Contractor with appropriate administrative access, APIs, usage telemetry, and available baseline data from its existing enterprise AI tools, based on need.
226. Section 1.3 of Appendix A deems all writings, reports, and materials produced under the Agreement to be works made for hire owned exclusively by University. Where a Proposer delivers services using a pre-existing, independently developed software platform or methodology framework, will TTUHSC consider a background-IP provision under which the Proposer retains ownership of pre-existing intellectual property and grants University a perpetual, irrevocable, royalty-free license to use it for University purposes, with Section 1.3 applying to work product newly created under the Agreement?	It is not the intention of TTUHSC to make claim to pre-existing intellectual property.
227. Deliverable 6 requires "code/architecture documentation (where applicable)." If a Proposer delivers capability via a commercially licensed platform rather than bespoke code, does TTUHSC interpret Deliverable 6 to require documentation sufficient for University operation and administration, rather than transfer of ownership in the underlying platform?	Yes. Where capability is delivered via a commercially licensed platform rather than bespoke code, Deliverable 6 is interpreted to require documentation sufficient for University operation and administration, rather than transfer of ownership in the underlying platform. It is not the intention of TTUHSC to make claim to pre-existing intellectual property. Please note Section 7 - General Terms and Conditions; if a Proposer takes exception to any Required Term, the Proposer should submit a list of the exceptions as part of its proposal.
228. Section 1.4 of Appendix A requires the Consultant to return "all information developed to date" upon completion or termination. Does this provision extend to a Proposer's pre-existing methodologies and platform components, or is it limited to University-provided materials and Agreement work product?	It is not the intention of TTUHSC to make claim to pre-existing intellectual property.

229. Will TTUHSC consider a limitation of Consultant's liability under Section 1.7 to a stated multiple of the Agreement value, exclusive of claims arising from willful misconduct or breach of the Business Associate Agreement?	Please note from Section 7 – GENERAL TERMS AND CONDITIONS. <i>If Proposer takes exception to any of the Required Terms, Proposer will submit a list of the exceptions as part of its proposal.</i>
230. Section 7 states that exceptions to the Required Terms may result in disqualification as non-responsive. Will TTUHSC confirm that the submission of exceptions is not automatically disqualifying, and that exceptions will be evaluated on their substance in accordance with Section 7?	It is not the intention of TTUHSC to disqualify any Proposer or proposal. However, TTUHSC reserves that right in the event contractual differences would result in negotiation deadlock, likely compromising the ability to meet RFP objectives.
231. Appendix A, Section 1.6 specifies general liability and automobile coverage limits. Section 1.68 of the Business Associate Agreement additionally requires insurance sufficient to support the Consultant's indemnification obligations. What minimum cyber liability and professional liability (E&O) limits does TTUHSC require for this engagement?	Undetermined.
232. Will the Contractor be expected to create, receive, maintain, or transmit Protected Health Information in the performance of these Services, or is the Business Associate Agreement included as a precautionary measure? If PHI access is anticipated, in connection with which Requirements (A through G) does TTUHSC expect it to occur?	PHI access is not anticipated; the BAA is included so that it is in place if an approved use case requires PHI. If PHI access occurs, it would most likely relate to workflow automation/prototyping in clinical operational units (Requirements D and, to a lesser extent, E), subject to human-in-the-loop controls and clinical validation.
233. Regarding the TX-RAMP requirement in Section 5.2: (a) must certification be in place at the Submittal Deadline, or is certification prior to contract execution acceptable; and (b) does TX-RAMP apply where analytics or automation components are deployed on infrastructure within TTUHSC's own network rather than delivered as a hosted cloud service?	- Under Texas Government Code § 2054.0593 and Texas Department of Information Resources guidelines, TX-RAMP applies specifically to Cloud Service Providers offering hosted cloud computing services (SaaS, PaaS, IaaS). - If a proposal does not include the above, TX-RAMP likely would not apply.
234. Approximately how many TTUHSC employees are within scope for the Requirement C workforce upskilling program, and how is that population distributed across the Abilene, Amarillo, Dallas/Fort Worth, Lubbock, and Permian Basin campuses?	- Total number of employees: about 6,000. Abilene: ~100; Amarillo: ~700; Dallas: ~90; Lubbock: ~3,710; Permian Basin: ~600; Strategic Initiatives (Correctional Managed Care): ~800. - Functional domains (some groups overlap): Clinical: ~2,000; Academic: ~2,000; Research: ~1,300; Other (Admin, Operational, Supporting): ~2,000. Number of leaders: around 150-200. - The initial rollout will target about 3,000 individuals.
235. Which enterprise AI tools are currently provisioned, and does TTUHSC have administrative or API access to usage telemetry for those tools sufficient to support the adoption analytics described in Requirement E.1?	- Microsoft Copilot is currently the enterprise generative AI tool that has been deployed. Other GenAI tools are being evaluated. Examples of other tools provided enterprise-wide include Zoom AI Companion, Epic, Grammarly, etc. - Access to telemetry data will be provided to the Contractor if needed.
236. Requirement E.4 references "TTUHSC-supplied baseline metrics and assumptions." Do current-state baseline measurements exist today? If not, should Proposers include baseline establishment in the scope and pricing of Deliverable 1 or Deliverable 5?	- Baseline metrics have not been established. TTUHSC conducted some AI baseline surveys in 2025 and 2026, but the Contractor is expected to bring a method for measuring the baseline and, later, the ROI. - Current-state baseline measurements do not exist today; Proposers should include baseline establishment in scope (within Deliverable 1 or Deliverable 5, as proposed).
237. Section 4.8.1 reserves TTUHSC's right to award an agreement for any portion of the requirements and to award multiple agreements. Will TTUHSC accept a proposal addressing a subset of Requirements A through G, and if so, how will a partial-scope proposal be scored against the Section 4.3.2 criteria relative to a full-scope proposal?	It is TTUHSC's intention to issue a single award, however in accordance with the terms of the RFP, reserves the right to award an agreement for all or any portion of the requirements proposed by reason of this request, award multiple agreements, or to reject any and all proposals if deemed to be in the best interests of TTUHSC and to resolicit for proposals, or temporarily or permanently abandon the solicitation.
238. Does TTUHSC anticipate the resulting agreement being renewed or extended beyond the August 31, 2027 expiration date stated in Section 2.4, and should Proposers price a rate card contemplating work beyond that date?	TTUHSC is seeking the completion of all deliverables and will work collaboratively in constructing a contract term that accommodates that position.

239. Is there an estimated budget range or prior-year expenditure for these Services that TTUHSC can share to assist Proposers in scaling level of effort?	The cost shall not exceed \$750,000.
240. Are these Services currently being performed by an incumbent contractor?	None.
241. Where a Proposer proposes a teaming arrangement, will subcontracted effort performed by a certified Texas HUB or SDVOSB firm count toward the VetHUB Subcontracting Plan goals under Appendix C?	Potentially.
242. What business outcomes is TTUHSC seeking to achieve through this engagement that are not being achieved today?	TTUHSC seeks to move from isolated, low-complexity AI utilization to durable, measurable, high-value adoption, with improved workforce capability, workflow efficiency, and measurable ROI. Priorities are strategy and governance, change management, workforce upskilling, and adoption analytics and ROI.
243. What enterprise AI platforms, tools, and capabilities are currently available across TTUHSC today including knowledge repository platform?	- Microsoft Copilot is currently the enterprise generative AI tool that has been deployed. Other GenAI tools are being evaluated. Examples of other tools provided enterprise-wide include Zoom AI Companion, Epic, Grammarly, etc. - The institutional knowledge repository may leverage existing TTUHSC systems (e.g., SharePoint/Teams); a contractor-provided option may be proposed as an optional item.
244. Does TTUHSC have internal organizational change management, communications, and training resources available to support this project?	This capability is being built; the Contractor is expected to support change management, communications, and training. TTUHSC has a President's Cabinet and Council structure that can be leveraged as initial change champions. The Vendor is expected to develop training content and curriculum from scratch.
245. What organizational change management (OCM) methodologies, frameworks, or approaches does TTUHSC currently use or prefer?	TTUHSC does not mandate a specific change-management methodology; the Proposer may propose its approach (e.g., Prosci/ADKAR, Kotter, or an internal model).
246. What is the approximate size of each in-scope audience, including leaders, managers, faculty, staff, researchers, clinicians, and other employee groups?	- Total number of employees: about 6,000. Abilene: ~100; Amarillo: ~700; Dallas: ~90; Lubbock: ~3,710; Permian Basin: ~600; Strategic Initiatives (Correctional Managed Care): ~800. - Functional domains (some groups overlap): Clinical: ~2,000; Academic: ~2,000; Research: ~1,300; Other (Admin, Operational, Supporting): ~2,000. Number of leaders: around 150-200. - The initial rollout will target about 3,000 individuals.
247. How many operational units or departments across the five campuses are in scope for the readiness and maturity assessment, and does scope include clinical practice entities and sponsored research units, or administrative and academic units only?	- The scope spans the five campuses and includes academic, administrative, clinical, and research units. Total number of employees: about 6,000. Abilene: ~100; Amarillo: ~700; Dallas: ~90; Lubbock: ~3,710; Permian Basin: ~600; Strategic Initiatives (Correctional Managed Care): ~800. - Functional domains (some groups overlap): Clinical: ~2,000; Academic: ~2,000; Research: ~1,300; Other (Admin, Operational, Supporting): ~2,000. Number of leaders: around 150-200. - The initial rollout will target about 3,000 individuals. - Depth of assessment across units may be prioritized with the Contractor based on the current-state assessment.
248. How many executive alignment sessions does TTUHSC anticipate, at what audience size and level, and are they expected on site at each campus or centrally in Lubbock? Are virtual sessions acceptable for any of them?	The number of executive alignment sessions may be proposed by the Contractor; virtual sessions are acceptable, with on-site presence concentrated at milestones. The initial kickoff is preferred on all campuses (negotiable) and the leadership enablement meeting on-site in Lubbock.
249. How many workflows should proposers assume for discovery, and how many of those will be selected for prototyping and for deployment during the term? Is there a target number per campus or per functional area?	TTUHSC anticipates about 8-10 workflows across the four functional areas for discovery; the number selected for prototyping and deployment may be proposed by the Contractor based on the assessment.

250. Does TTUHSC expect strategic recommendations, working prototypes, production deployments, or a combination of these during the contract term?	A combination is expected: strategic recommendations, working prototypes, and selected pilot-ready or production-ready solutions. TTUHSC plans to operate and maintain deliverables internally after the term.
251. Are any agentic or multi-step autonomous workflows in production or pilot at TTUHSC today, and is there an approved agent platform? Should agent oversight (auditing, approval, access control, human-in-the-loop) integrate with an existing ITSM or change management system, or be delivered as a standalone framework?	Current AI utilization is isolated and low-complexity; no agentic/multi-step autonomous workflows are in production today, and no specific agent platform is mandated. Agent oversight (auditing, approval, access control, human-in-the-loop) may integrate with existing systems where appropriate or be delivered as a framework; the Contractor may propose the approach.
252. Please provide details of specific departments, functions, or user populations that should be in scope and confirm any prioritization for AI adoption, automation, and agentic AI initiatives?	In-scope departments, functions, and user populations, and any prioritization for AI adoption, automation, and agentic AI, will be prioritized with the Contractor based on the current-state assessment. Prototypes are expected across Academic, Clinical, Research, and Admin functional areas (about 8-10 workflows).
253. Are there any additional security, compliance, data residency, or TXRAMP requirements beyond those explicitly stated in the RFP that vendors should consider in their proposed solution?	- Under Texas Government Code Sec. 2054.0593 and Texas Department of Information Resources guidelines, TX-RAMP applies specifically to Cloud Service Providers offering hosted cloud computing services (SaaS, PaaS, IaaS). Where the solution is delivered as a professional/managed service operating inside TTUHSC's approved enterprise environment, using TTUHSC's certified infrastructure and tooling, with no contractor-hosted cloud service and no institutional data leaving TTUHSC-controlled systems, TX-RAMP would likely not apply. - Beyond the controls explicitly stated in the RFP (HIPAA, FERPA, Texas DIR, RBAC, SSO, encryption), standard TTUHSC enterprise security and data-classification controls apply; specifics will be provided to the selected Contractor. The US-only requirement applies to PHI.
254. Does TTUHSC have current-state process documentation or process mining tooling for the candidate workflows, or should proposers assume current-state mapping is built from scratch?	Current-state process documentation and process-mining tooling are limited; opportunity mapping will rely on a combination of available telemetry and stakeholder interviews/workshops. Proposers should generally assume current-state mapping is built collaboratively, with TTUHSC providing available inputs based on need.
255. Do documented baseline metrics exist today for the target processes (cycle time, FTE effort, cost per transaction, volume), or is baseline construction part of Contractor scope?	- Baseline metrics have not been established. TTUHSC conducted some AI baseline surveys in 2025 and 2026, but the Contractor is expected to bring a method for measuring the baseline and, later, the ROI. - Documented baselines (cycle time, FTE effort, cost per transaction, volume) do not exist today for the target processes; baseline construction is part of the Contractor's scope.
256. Section 1.3 of Appendix A deems all writings, reports, and materials produced under the Agreement to be works made for hire owned exclusively by University. Where a Proposer delivers services using a pre-existing, independently developed software platform or methodology framework, will TTUHSC consider a background-IP provision under which the Proposer retains ownership of pre-existing intellectual property and grants University a perpetual, irrevocable, royalty-free license to use it for University purposes, with Section 1.3 applying to work product newly created under the Agreement?	It is not the intention of TTUHSC to make claim to pre-existing intellectual property.
257. Deliverable 6 requires "code/architecture documentation (where applicable)." If a Proposer delivers capability via a commercially licensed platform rather than bespoke code, does TTUHSC interpret Deliverable 6 to require documentation sufficient for University operation and administration, rather than transfer of ownership in the underlying platform?	Yes. Where capability is delivered via a commercially licensed platform rather than bespoke code, Deliverable 6 is interpreted to require documentation sufficient for University operation and administration, rather than transfer of ownership in the underlying platform. It is not the intention of TTUHSC to make claim to pre-existing intellectual property. Please note Section 7 - General Terms and Conditions; if a Proposer takes exception to any Required Term, the Proposer should submit a list of the exceptions as part of its proposal.
258. Section 1.4 of Appendix A requires the Consultant to return "all information developed to date" upon completion or termination. Does this provision extend to a Proposer's pre-existing methodologies and platform components, or is it limited to University-provided materials and Agreement work product?	It is not the intention of TTUHSC to make claim to pre-existing intellectual property.

259. Will TTUHSC consider a limitation of Consultant's liability under Section 1.7 to a stated multiple of the Agreement value, exclusive of claims arising from willful misconduct or breach of the Business Associate Agreement?	Please note from Section 7 – GENERAL TERMS AND CONDITIONS. <i>If Proposer takes exception to any of the Required Terms, Proposer will submit a list of the exceptions as part of its proposal.</i>
260. Section 7 states that exceptions to the Required Terms may result in disqualification as non-responsive. Will TTUHSC confirm that the submission of exceptions is not automatically disqualifying, and that exceptions will be evaluated on their substance in accordance with Section 7?	It is not the intention of TTUHSC to disqualify any Proposer or proposal. However, TTUHSC reserves that right in the event contractual differences would result in negotiation deadlock, likely compromising the ability to meet RFP objectives.
261. Appendix A, Section 1.6 specifies general liability and automobile coverage limits. Section 1.68 of the Business Associate Agreement additionally requires insurance sufficient to support the Consultant's indemnification obligations. What minimum cyber liability and professional liability (E&O) limits does TTUHSC require for this engagement?	Please note Section 7 - General Terms and Conditions. If a Proposer takes exception to any of the Required Terms, the Proposer should submit a list of the exceptions as part of its proposal. Beyond the general and automobile liability limits in Section 1.6, TTUHSC has not specified separate cyber or professional liability (E&O) limits in the RFP; a Proposer may submit any exception or proposed limits under Section 7.
262. Will the Contractor be expected to create, receive, maintain, or transmit Protected Health Information in the performance of these Services, or is the Business Associate Agreement included as a precautionary measure? If PHI access is anticipated, in connection with which Requirements (A through G) does TTUHSC expect it to occur?	PHI access is not anticipated; the BAA is included so that it is in place if an approved use case requires PHI. If PHI access occurs, it would most likely relate to workflow automation/prototyping in clinical operational units (Requirements D and, to a lesser extent, E), subject to human-in-the-loop controls and clinical validation.
263. Regarding the TX-RAMP requirement in Section 5.2: (a) must certification be in place at the Submittal Deadline, or is certification prior to contract execution acceptable; and (b) does TX-RAMP apply where analytics or automation components are deployed on infrastructure within TTUHSC's own network rather than delivered as a hosted cloud service?	- Under Texas Government Code § 2054.0593 and Texas Department of Information Resources guidelines, TX-RAMP applies specifically to Cloud Service Providers offering hosted cloud computing services (SaaS, PaaS, IaaS). - If a proposal does not include the above, TX-RAMP likely would not apply. - If it applies, certification would be required prior to award. Note the DIR program includes - Provisional Status - Granted for up to 18 months while a full product assessment is underway.
264. Approximately how many TTUHSC employees are within scope for the Requirement C workforce upskilling program, and how is that population distributed across the Abilene, Amarillo, Dallas/Fort Worth, Lubbock, and Permian Basin campuses?	- Total number of employees: about 6,000. Abilene: ~100; Amarillo: ~700; Dallas: ~90; Lubbock: ~3,710; Permian Basin: ~600; Strategic Initiatives (Correctional Managed Care): ~800. - Functional domains (some groups overlap): Clinical: ~2,000; Academic: ~2,000; Research: ~1,300; Other (Admin, Operational, Supporting): ~2,000. Number of leaders: around 150-200. - The initial rollout will target about 3,000 individuals.
265. Which enterprise AI tools are currently provisioned, and does TTUHSC have administrative or API access to usage telemetry for those tools sufficient to support the adoption analytics described in Requirement E.1?	- Microsoft Copilot is currently the enterprise generative AI tool that has been deployed. Other GenAI tools are being evaluated. Examples of other tools provided enterprise-wide include Zoom AI Companion, Epic, Grammarly, etc. - Access to telemetry data will be provided to the Contractor if needed.
266. Requirement E.4 references "TTUHSC-supplied baseline metrics and assumptions." Do current-state baseline measurements exist today? If not, should Proposers include baseline establishment in the scope and pricing of Deliverable 1 or Deliverable 5?	- Baseline metrics have not been established. TTUHSC conducted some AI baseline surveys in 2025 and 2026, but the Contractor is expected to bring a method for measuring the baseline and, later, the ROI. - Current-state baseline measurements do not exist today; Proposers should include baseline establishment in scope (within Deliverable 1 or Deliverable 5, as proposed).
267. May a non-U.S. supplier participate if it can satisfy the solicitation's contractual, insurance, security, and data-handling requirements?	A non-U.S. supplier may participate if it can satisfy the solicitation's contractual, insurance, security, and data-handling requirements. The preference is that work be performed within the US, and TTUHSC institutional data must not be accessed, stored, or transmitted outside the United States.
268. Is remote delivery acceptable for the AI workflow automation/custom-development components, or is an on-site presence required for a material part of the engagement?	Remote delivery is acceptable for much of the AI workflow automation/custom-development work; some on-site presence is expected at defined milestones. TTUHSC expects some on-site presence but does not have strict requirements for delivery frequency or duration. A predominantly virtual/hybrid model is acceptable, with on-site presence concentrated at defined milestones such as executive alignment sessions and leadership

	workshops. The initial kickoff is preferred on all campuses (negotiable), and the leadership enablement meeting is preferred on-site in Lubbock, TX. Overall, a hybrid model is preferred. Travel is to be included in the fee.
269. Specific to the Workforce Upskilling scope, can you provide the approximate number of unique roles and total number of employees within the target audience? The fact sheet provides overall numbers; however, we would appreciate clarification on the approximate number of staff expected to be included in this organization-wide effort.	- Total number of employees: about 6,000. Abilene: ~100; Amarillo: ~700; Dallas: ~90; Lubbock: ~3,710; Permian Basin: ~600; Strategic Initiatives (Correctional Managed Care): ~800. - Functional domains (some groups overlap): Clinical: ~2,000; Academic: ~2,000; Research: ~1,300; Other (Admin, Operational, Supporting): ~2,000. Number of leaders: around 150-200. The number of unique roles and role-based tracks may be proposed by the Contractor based on the assessment; the initial rollout will be around 3,000 individuals.
270. Can you confirm the anticipated duration of this engagement? Based on the December 2027 end date referenced in the RFP, we understand the expected duration to be approximately 12 months.	- The following proposed Project Schedule may change based on RFP progress: - Kick-off meeting: February 2027; - Deliverable 1: April 2027; - Deliverable 2: April 2027; - Deliverable 3: September 2027; - Deliverable 4: September 2027; - Deliverable 5: December 2027; - Deliverable 6: February 2028. - TTUHSC is seeking completion of all deliverables and will work collaboratively in constructing a contract term that accommodates that position. - TTUHSC will work collaboratively in constructing a contract term that accommodates completion of all deliverables.
271. For the Data & Analytics reporting, it appears you are seeking a vendor/application approach. Would you anticipate being involved in the selection of the tool, or could the firm providing services deliver the required data and reporting using platforms already being utilized? We are seeking to confirm the expected approach given the references to enterprise usage and data privacy provisions.	Either route is acceptable, with no preference here. Power BI is available; the firm providing services may deliver the required data and reporting using platforms already in use, or propose a tool. TTUHSC would be involved in any tool selection.
272. Do you currently have an enterprise Learning Management System (LMS) across the enterprise that can be leveraged as training and upskilling is deployed? If not, would the selected partner be expected to provide a platform or solution for deploying and provisioning the training plan?	- Yes, TTUHSC has an LMS. The Vendor is expected to develop the training content and curriculum from scratch. - The role-based training may be designed for delivery through TTUHSC's existing LMS; the Proposer may propose supplementary platforms as optional items.
273. Can you confirm whether proposers are required to secure a VetHUB/HUB-certified subcontractor to be considered responsive, or whether completion of Appendix C is sufficient regardless of whether subcontractors are included in the proposed solution?	For clarity, The VetHUB subcontracting must be completed and return as a component of the RFP response. A self-performance designation is considered responsive.
274. Reference: Section 5.4.D.2, Solution Engineering and Prototyping; Deliverable 4 Section 5.4.D.2 requires the Contractor to build, test, and validate functional prototypes, including bespoke application development, API integrations, and custom model orchestration. Does TTUHSC expect these solutions at proof of concept maturity for TTUHSC to productionize internally, or does TTUHSC expect production ready applications deployed into the TTUHSC environment with Contractor support through the contract term? If production deployment is expected, approximately how many solutions does TTUHSC anticipate during the term, and which TTUHSC group assumes hosting, maintenance, and Tier 1 support after acceptance?	- TTUHSC is planning to have at least two workflows/use cases from each functional area (Academic, Clinical, Research, and Admin) evaluated by the Contractor, for a total of about 8 to 10 workflows. Solutions should be either pilot-ready or fully production-ready; the associated cost should not be included in the fixed fee but may be listed as an optional item for TTUHSC to consider. - Solutions should be pilot-ready or production-ready; TTUHSC anticipates about 8-10 solutions. TTUHSC plans to operate and maintain deliverables internally after the term, with hosting/maintenance/Tier 1 support handled internally; ongoing support may be proposed as an optional item.
275. Reference: Section 5.4, Overview and Objective How many individuals are within the intended scope of this engagement, broken out by faculty, staff, residents, and any other employee category? Are students	- Total number of employees: about 6,000. Abilene: ~100; Amarillo: ~700; Dallas: ~90; Lubbock: ~3,710; Permian Basin: ~600; Strategic Initiatives (Correctional Managed Care): ~800. - Functional domains (some groups overlap): Clinical: ~2,000; Academic:

included in any portion of the workforce upskilling scope?	~2,000; Research: ~1,300; Other (Admin, Operational, Supporting): ~2,000. Number of leaders: around 150-200. - The initial rollout will target about 3,000 individuals. - Students are not the primary focus of the workforce upskilling scope.
276. Reference: Section 5.4, Overview; Section 1.2, Description of TTUHSC Which organizational units are in scope for this engagement? Specifically, does the clinical scope include Texas Tech Physicians practice operations and personnel at affiliated hospitals and partner health systems, or is scope limited to TTUHSC employed personnel operating within TTUHSC owned systems?	Scope centers on TTUHSC employed personnel operating within TTUHSC systems. The clinical element is directed to administrative and operational workflows within clinical operational units; extension to affiliated hospitals or partner health systems is not the focus of the initial engagement and would be confirmed with the Contractor.
277. Reference: Section 5.4.B and 5.4.C; Deliverables 2 and 3 Can TTUHSC provide estimated participant counts and expected session volume for each of the following: executive and leadership workshops, the Change Champions Network, train the trainer cohorts, and general workforce training? For Deliverable 3, approximately how many role based learning tracks does TTUHSC expect, and for which functional domains?	- Total number of employees: about 6,000. Abilene: ~100; Amarillo: ~700; Dallas: ~90; Lubbock: ~3,710; Permian Basin: ~600; Strategic Initiatives (Correctional Managed Care): ~800. - Functional domains (some groups overlap): Clinical: ~2,000; Academic: ~2,000; Research: ~1,300; Other (Admin, Operational, Supporting): ~2,000. Number of leaders: around 150-200. Participant counts and session volume for executive/leadership workshops, the Change Champions Network, train-the-trainer cohorts, and general workforce training, and the number of role-based tracks, may be proposed by the Contractor based on the assessment. - The initial rollout will target about 3,000 individuals.
278. Reference: Section 5.4.C.2, Multi-Format Instruction Does TTUHSC have a preferred instructional delivery model, and should proposers assume delivery across all five campuses or a Lubbock anchored engagement with virtual delivery to the remaining campuses? Approximately how many onsite days and at which campuses should proposers assume for pricing purposes, given that Section 6.1 requires travel to be included within the fixed fee?	TTUHSC expects some on-site presence but does not have strict requirements for delivery frequency or duration. A predominantly virtual/hybrid model is acceptable, with on-site presence concentrated at defined milestones such as executive alignment sessions and leadership workshops. The initial kickoff is preferred on all campuses (negotiable), and the leadership enablement meeting is preferred on-site in Lubbock, TX. Overall, a hybrid model is preferred. Travel is to be included in the fee. A Lubbock-anchored engagement with virtual delivery to the remaining campuses is acceptable; the Proposer may state its on-site day assumptions for pricing.
279. Reference: Section 5.4.D.1, Workflow Discovery and Opportunity Mapping For fixed fee pricing, proposers must assume a bounded volume of work. Approximately how many departments or functional processes does TTUHSC expect to be evaluated during workflow discovery, and how many workflows does TTUHSC expect to be redesigned and prototyped under Deliverable 4?	TTUHSC anticipates about 8-10 workflows across the four functional areas for discovery, redesign, and prototyping; the Contractor may propose the bounded volume based on the current-state assessment.
280. Reference: Section 5.4, Background; Section 5.4.E.1 Which enterprise AI tools has TTUHSC provisioned, including specific products and license tiers, and how many licenses are currently assigned for each? Will TTUHSC provide the Contractor with administrative reporting or application programming interface access to usage telemetry for those tools, and has TTUHSC confirmed that the current license tiers permit the data export required to support Deliverable 5?	- Microsoft Copilot is currently the enterprise generative AI tool that has been deployed. Other GenAI tools are being evaluated. Examples of other tools provided enterprise-wide include Zoom AI Companion, Epic, Grammarly, etc. - Access to telemetry data will be provided to the Contractor if needed. Specific products, license tiers, and seat counts, and confirmation that license tiers permit the required data export, will be provided to the selected Contractor based on need.
281. Reference: Section 5.4.A.2, Readiness and Maturity Assessment Has TTUHSC completed any prior AI readiness assessment, maturity study, governance policy, or adoption baseline, and will those artifacts be made available to the awarded Contractor? Has TTUHSC previously engaged, or does TTUHSC currently engage, a contractor for any portion of the scope described in Section 5.4?	- TTUHSC has some governance structure already in place and seeks to align with both the NIST AI Risk Management Framework and the Texas DIR framework. TTUHSC has a responsible AI use policy (OP 52.21) and maintains an active AI tool inventory. - No formal AI readiness assessment or maturity study exists; some AI baseline surveys (2025 and 2026) and an active AI tool inventory do exist and will be shared with the selected Contractor. TTUHSC has not previously engaged a vendor for this scope.

282. Reference: Section 5.4.E.4, ROI Modeling and Verification Section 5.4.E.4 references TTUHSC supplied baseline metrics and assumptions. Do those baselines exist today in a usable form, which TTUHSC office is accountable for supplying them, and what turnaround should the Contractor assume for baseline data requests? If baselines do not yet exist, does TTUHSC expect the Contractor to establish them, and should that effort be priced within Deliverable 1 or Deliverable 5?	- Baseline metrics have not been established. TTUHSC conducted some AI baseline surveys in 2025 and 2026, but the Contractor is expected to bring a method for measuring the baseline and, later, the ROI. - Baselines do not exist in usable form today; the Contractor is expected to establish them, priced within Deliverable 1 or Deliverable 5 as proposed. Baseline data requests will be coordinated with the relevant TTUHSC office based on need.
283. Reference: Section 5.4.G, Engagement Structure and Management Will TTUHSC designate an executive sponsor and a dedicated project counterpart for the duration of the engagement? Does an AI governance committee or equivalent body exist today, and what level of TTUHSC staff time will be committed to workshops, interviews, data provision, and deliverable review?	- The Chief AI Transformation Officer is the executive sponsor. TTUHSC has an AI Steering Committee which is the oversight body of the effort. - TTUHSC executive sponsor, IT/security, and functional SMEs will be involved at levels appropriate to each deliverable. The Contractor is expected to deliver with collaborative TTUHSC participation.
284. Reference: Section 5.4.D.2, Solution Engineering and Prototyping; Section 5.4.F, Enterprise Security and Data Privacy Compliance What is the typical duration of TTUHSC information technology security review, architecture review, and change approval for a new integration or software component? Does TTUHSC expect the Contractor schedule to absorb that review time, and will TTUHSC consider schedule relief where deliverable acceptance depends on TTUHSC review cycles?	Typical durations for TTUHSC IT security, architecture, and change reviews will be provided to the selected Contractor. TTUHSC will work collaboratively on schedule where deliverable acceptance depends on TTUHSC review cycles.
285. Reference: Section 2.3, Key Events Schedule; Section 2.4, Anticipated Term; Agreement Section 1.12 Evaluation of proposals is scheduled through November 30, 2026, and the agreement expires August 31, 2027. Should proposers assume a performance period of approximately nine months, and must all six deliverables be complete and accepted on or before August 31, 2027? Does TTUHSC anticipate renewal terms, option years, or a follow on procurement for sustainment beyond that date?	- The following proposed Project Schedule may change based on RFP progress: - Kick-off meeting: February 2027; - Deliverable 1: April 2027; - Deliverable 2: April 2027; - Deliverable 3: September 2027; - Deliverable 4: September 2027; - Deliverable 5: December 2027; - Deliverable 6: February 2028. - TTUHSC is seeking completion of all deliverables and will work collaboratively in constructing a contract term that accommodates that position. - TTUHSC is seeking completion of all deliverables within the term and will work collaboratively on the term. Renewal terms, option years, or a follow-on procurement are not committed; any additional work would be handled per the Agreement and applicable procurement rules.
286. Reference: Section 5.4, Project Schedule The project schedule in Section 5.4 is presented with blank dates. Should proposers propose the kick off date and deliverable completion dates? Are there fixed constraints the proposed schedule must respect, such as academic calendar blackout periods, clinical operational blackouts, or a fiscal year end date by which deliverables must be invoiced and accepted?	- The following proposed Project Schedule may change based on RFP progress: - Kick-off meeting: February 2027; - Deliverable 1: April 2027; - Deliverable 2: April 2027; - Deliverable 3: September 2027; - Deliverable 4: September 2027; - Deliverable 5: December 2027; - Deliverable 6: February 2028. - TTUHSC is seeking completion of all deliverables and will work collaboratively in constructing a contract term that accommodates that position. - Proposers may propose the kickoff and deliverable dates; TTUHSC will identify any calendar constraints with the selected Contractor and will work collaboratively on the term.
287. Reference: Section 6.1, Pricing for Services Offered; Agreement Section 1.18	- The cost shall not exceed \$750,000. - TTUHSC will advise the selected Contractor of funding and any federal flow-down requirements at award.

Has TTUHSC established a budget range, funding ceiling, or not to exceed amount for this engagement? Is funding fully appropriated and allocated for the anticipated term, and is any portion funded with federal funds that would carry additional flow down requirements under Agreement Section 1.18?	
288. Reference: Section 1.3, Group Purchasing Authority Does TTUHSC anticipate that other Texas Tech University System components or other Texas institutions of higher education will elect to contract with the successful Proposer under Section 1.3? If so, should proposers reflect that potential volume in the proposed rate card?	Other Texas Tech University System components or eligible Texas institutions of higher education may elect to contract with the successful Proposer under the Group Purchasing Authority; any such use would be through a separate agreement or statement of work. Proposers may reflect that potential in the rate card at their discretion.
289. Reference: Section 5.4.E, Analytics, Adoption Tracking and Impact Measurement; Deliverable 5 Does TTUHSC intend for adoption analytics to be delivered within existing institutional reporting platforms and data infrastructure, or will TTUHSC accept a Contractor provided analytics solution? If a Contractor provided solution is acceptable, what does TTUHSC expect regarding continuity of that solution, data export, and license disposition after the agreement expires?	Either route is acceptable, with no preference here. Power BI is available. If a Contractor-provided solution is proposed, TTUHSC expects continuity, data export, and license disposition to favor internal operation after the term; TTUHSC plans to operate and maintain deliverables internally.
290. Reference: Section 5.4.C.5, Institutional Knowledge Repository; Deliverable 3 Should the searchable repository of validated use cases, prompts, and best practices reside within a TTUHSC owned platform, or will TTUHSC accept a Contractor provided repository? If TTUHSC owned, which platform should proposers assume?	The searchable repository may reside within a TTUHSC-owned platform (e.g., SharePoint/Teams within the Microsoft environment); a Contractor-provided repository may be proposed as an optional item. TTUHSC operates within a Microsoft enterprise environment.
291. Reference: Section 5.2, Minimum Requirements, Texas Risk and Authorization Management Program Section 5.2 states that the Proposer is compliant with the Texas Risk and Authorization Management Program (TX-RAMP) as may be required. Will TTUHSC clarify the conditions under which TX-RAMP applies to this scope of work, including whether a Contractor provided analytics platform, repository, or custom application is treated as a cloud computing service subject to certification? If certification applies, will TTUHSC confirm the required level, whether provisional status or FedRAMP and StateRAMP reciprocity is accepted, whether TTUHSC will sponsor certification, and the timing required relative to award and to the start of performance.	- Under Texas Government Code Sec. 2054.0593 and Texas Department of Information Resources guidelines, TX-RAMP applies specifically to Cloud Service Providers offering hosted cloud computing services (SaaS, PaaS, IaaS). Where the solution is delivered as a professional/managed service operating inside TTUHSC's approved enterprise environment, using TTUHSC's certified infrastructure and tooling, with no contractor-hosted cloud service and no institutional data leaving TTUHSC-controlled systems, TX-RAMP would likely not apply. Where a proposal includes a hosted cloud service, TX-RAMP would apply. - A Contractor-provided analytics platform, repository, or custom application delivered as a hosted cloud service would be subject to TX-RAMP; delivered within TTUHSC-owned tenancy and infrastructure, it would not independently trigger TX-RAMP. Where certification applies, the level follows the data classification (generally Level 1 for non-PHI, Level 2 for confidential/regulated data), a provisional/in-process status may be acceptable at submission with full certification prior to production, and FedRAMP reciprocity may be recognized consistent with DIR guidelines. TTUHSC does not commit to sponsoring certification.
292. Reference: Agreement Section 1.25, Incorporated Terms Agreement Section 1.25 incorporates both the Required Contract Terms and the Required Information Technology Terms. Do the Required Information Technology Terms apply to a services engagement in which no software is licensed or hosted for TTUHSC, or do they apply only where a software component or cloud service is delivered?	Please note Section 7 - General Terms and Conditions. If a Proposer takes exception to any of the Required Terms, the Proposer should submit a list of the exceptions as part of its proposal. The Required Information Technology Terms generally apply where a software component or cloud service is delivered or hosted for TTUHSC; a Proposer may submit any exception under Section 7 where no software is licensed or hosted.
293. Reference: Section 5.4.C, Workforce Upskilling; Section 5.4.E, Analytics	As a Texas state institution, TTUHSC requires electronic and information resources - including training content and any software component - to conform to applicable accessibility standards (Section 508 / WCAG and applicable Texas Administrative Code Chapters 206 and 213). A Voluntary Product

Will TTUHSC require a Voluntary Product Accessibility Template or Accessibility Conformance Report for training content and for any software component provided under this agreement, consistent with Texas Administrative Code Chapters 206 and 213? If so, is documentation required with the proposal or at award, and does TTUHSC have a required conformance standard and version?	Accessibility Template / Accessibility Conformance Report may be requested; documentation is generally required at or after award rather than with the proposal. Specifics will be confirmed with the selected Contractor.
294. Reference: Section 5.4.F.1, Data Handling and Sovereignty; Appendix A, Business Associate Agreement Does TTUHSC anticipate that Contractor personnel will create, receive, maintain, or transmit Protected Health Information under this engagement? Section 5.4.C.3 references sanitized institutional scenarios, while Appendix A includes a Business Associate Agreement. Will TTUHSC execute the Business Associate Agreement in all cases, or only where PHI access is required by an approved use case?	• PHI access is not anticipated; activities may rely on sanitized institutional scenarios (Section 5.4.C.3). The BAA would be executed where an approved use case requires PHI access, not in all cases.
295. Reference: Appendix A, Business Associate Agreement Section 1.53.11; Agreement Section 1.11 What screening and access requirements apply to Contractor personnel, including criminal background checks, HIPAA and compliance training, immunization or occupational health requirements, and campus badging? Beyond the prohibition on access outside the United States in Business Associate Agreement Section 1.53.11, are there additional citizenship, residency, or work location restrictions applicable to Contractor personnel and subprocessors?	• Vendor personnel screening and access requirements - such as criminal background checks, HIPAA/compliance training, occupational health requirements, and campus badging - will be coordinated with TTUHSC based on the systems accessed. Beyond the PHI restriction in BAA Section 1.53.11, the preference is US-based performance; any offshore personnel/subprocessors would require TTUHSC approval, and PHI must not be accessed outside the United States.
296. Reference: Appendix A, Agreement Sections 1.3 and 1.4, Works Made for Hire Agreement Section 1.3 deems all writings, reports, and materials produced under the agreement to be works made for hire owned exclusively by TTUHSC, and Section 1.4 requires return of all materials. Will TTUHSC confirm that this provision is intended to apply to deliverables created specifically for TTUHSC, and that a Contractor retains ownership of pre existing, independently developed, and commercially available intellectual property, including methodologies, curricula, software, and tooling, which the Contractor licenses to TTUHSC for its internal use? If TTUHSC is open to that clarification, does TTUHSC prefer proposed language within the proposal or an exception submitted under Section 7?	• It is not the intention of TTUHSC to make claim to pre-existing intellectual property. Please note Section 7 - General Terms and Conditions; if a Proposer takes exception to any Required Term, the Proposer should submit a list of the exceptions as part of its proposal. Proposed clarifying language may be submitted as an exception under Section 7.
297. Reference: Appendix A, Agreement Section 1.7; Business Associate Agreement Section 1.67 The indemnification obligations in Agreement Section 1.7 and Business Associate Agreement Section 1.67 are unlimited in amount. Will TTUHSC consider a mutually agreed limitation of liability tied to the value of the agreement, together with an exclusion of consequential and indirect damages, for matters other than the specific carve outs TTUHSC requires?	• It is not the intention of TTUHSC to make claim to pre-existing intellectual property. Please note Section 7 - General Terms and Conditions; if a Proposer takes exception to any Required Term, the Proposer should submit a list of the exceptions as part of its proposal. Proposed clarifying language may be submitted as an exception under Section 7.
298. Reference: Appendix A, Agreement Section 1.6, Insurance Agreement Section 1.6 specifies employer's liability, workers' compensation, and general and automobile liability at \$250,000 per person and \$500,000 per occurrence. Will TTUHSC confirm that these are the only coverages and limits required for this engagement,	• It is not the intention of TTUHSC to make claim to pre-existing intellectual property. Please note Section 7 - General Terms and Conditions; if a Proposer takes exception to any Required Term, the Proposer should submit a list of the exceptions as part of its proposal. Proposed clarifying language may be submitted as an exception under Section 7.

or identify any additional coverage TTUHSC will require so that proposers can price accurately?	
299. Reference: Section 7, General Terms and Conditions Section 7 states that exceptions to the Required Terms may result in disqualification. Will TTUHSC confirm that submitting exceptions for negotiation does not by itself render a proposal non responsive? Does TTUHSC have a preferred format for exceptions, such as a tabular list identifying the provision, the proposed change, and the rationale, or a redline of Appendix A?	Please note Section 7 - General Terms and Conditions. If a Proposer takes exception to any of the Required Terms, the Proposer should submit a list of the exceptions as part of its proposal. Submitting exceptions for negotiation does not by itself render a proposal non-responsive. TTUHSC does not mandate a specific format; a tabular list identifying the provision, the proposed change, and the rationale, or a redline of Appendix A, is acceptable.
300. Reference: Section 6.1 and Agreement Sections 1.9 and 1.10, Payment Agreement Section 1.9 provides payment for each deliverable upon completion. Several deliverables, including Deliverables 3 and 5, extend across multiple months. Will TTUHSC consider milestone based or monthly progress payments against an approved schedule of values for those deliverables? What constitutes completion, what acceptance criteria apply, and what review period should proposers assume between deliverable submission and TTUHSC acceptance?	- Deliverable acceptance is by the Chief AI Transformation Officer, the AI Steering Committee, and the President, and will depend on TTUHSC review cycles. - Payment is per deliverable upon completion and acceptance; for deliverables spanning multiple months (e.g., Deliverables 3 and 5), milestone-based partial invoicing may be discussed with the Contractor. Completion, acceptance criteria, and review periods will be agreed in the Agreement.
301. Reference: Section 3.7 and Appendix C, VetHUB Subcontracting Plan Section 3.7 requires each Proposer to complete and return the Subcontracting Plan. Where a Proposer intends to self perform all work described in Section 5.4, which sections of the Comptroller form should the Proposer complete to document self performance? Given TTUHSC's determination that subcontracting opportunities are probable under this RFP, does a self performing Proposer also need to submit good faith effort documentation to be considered responsive?	Where a Proposer intends to self-perform all work, the Proposer completes the self-performance justification in the Comptroller form in lieu of the good-faith-effort subcontractor solicitation and notice requirements; a self-performing VetHUB Subcontracting Plan is responsive.
302. Reference: Section 3.7, VetHUB Subcontracting Plan; Sections 4.1.2 and 4.3.2, Evaluation Criteria Which procurement category and participation goal percentage apply to this solicitation? Section 4.3.2 allocates one hundred percent of the evaluation weight among pricing, experience and reputation, and service specifications, while Section 4.1.2 lists the impact on TTUHSC's ability to comply with laws relating to historically underutilized businesses among the best value factors. Will TTUHSC clarify whether the Subcontracting Plan is evaluated on a pass or fail responsiveness basis only, or whether the level of proposed participation influences the best value determination?	The Subcontracting Plan is evaluated on a pass/fail responsiveness basis; the level of proposed participation is not a separately weighted scored factor under Section 4.3.2 (Service Specifications 55%, Experience and Reputation 15%, Pricing 30%), though it supports best-value considerations under Section 4.1.2. A self-performing plan is responsive.
303. Reference: Section 3.7, VetHUB Subcontracting Plan; NIGP Code 91878 The RFP refers to a VetHUB Subcontracting Plan and cites a Centralized Master Bidders List search of active VetHUB vendors under NIGP commodity code 91878. Will TTUHSC clarify whether proposed subcontractors must hold Texas Historically Underutilized Business certification, whether veteran ownership is specifically required, and whether federal certifications such as Service Disabled Veteran Owned Small Business satisfy the requirement? Will TTUHSC make available the vendor list generated by that search?	Proposed subcontractors would be Texas certified VetHUB vendors under NIGP code 91878; a self-performing plan is also responsive. The VetHUB directory is maintained by the Texas Comptroller (see https://www.fiscal.ttuhs.edu/purchasing/hub/findavendor.aspx). Federal certifications do not substitute for Texas HUB certification for HUB participation purposes.

304. Reference: Section 3.7; Title 34, Texas Administrative Code, Chapter 20, Subchapter D Does TTUHSC require good faith effort documentation under the Comptroller's Historically Underutilized Business rules, including written notification to trade associations and to minority, women, and veteran business associations in advance of the submittal deadline? If so, will TTUHSC identify the applicable method, the required notice period, and any TTUHSC preferred notification list or approved directory?	Good-faith-effort documentation applies where a Proposer intends to subcontract; a Proposer intending to self-perform completes the self-performance justification in lieu of good-faith-effort solicitation and notice. Where good-faith effort applies, the Comptroller's HUB rules (Title 34 TAC Chapter 20, Subchapter D) govern the method and notice; specifics will be confirmed with the selected Contractor.
305. Reference: Section 5.2, Minimum Requirements; Section 4.8, Award of Agreement Which Texas registrations and filings must be complete at the time of proposal submission, and which are required only prior to award or execution? Specifically, will TTUHSC address Centralized Master Bidders List registration, Texas Comptroller payee and Texas Identification Number setup, Certificate of Account Status for franchise tax, registration with the Texas Secretary of State to transact business as a foreign entity, and Texas Ethics Commission Form 1295. For an out of state entity, will TTUHSC confirm whether Secretary of State registration must be in place before award.	Texas registrations and filings (e.g., Centralized Master Bidders List registration, Comptroller payee/TIN setup, Certificate of Account Status, Secretary of State foreign-entity registration, and Form 1295) are generally required prior to award or execution rather than at submission; specifics will be confirmed by TTUHSC. For an out-of-state entity, Secretary of State registration is typically required before award/execution.
306. Reference: Section 4.8.4 and 4.8.5, Award of Agreement Does TTUHSC anticipate that the resulting agreement will require review and approval by the Texas Tech University System Board of Regents, and what contract value threshold triggers that review? What elapsed time should proposers assume between notice of award and contract execution or purchase order issuance?	TTUHSC will advise the selected Contractor whether Texas Tech University System Board of Regents review is required and of any applicable threshold at award. Proposers should not assume a fixed elapsed time between notice of award and execution; TTUHSC will coordinate timing.
307. Reference: Section 5.3, Additional Requirements Specific to this RFP Are there page limits, font, margin, or file format requirements for the proposal narrative? If no page limit applies, does TTUHSC have a preferred maximum length? Should the proposal follow the order of Section 5.3, and will TTUHSC accept appendices such as resumes, sample artifacts, and the proposed Scope of Work outside of any page limit?	Proposers should follow the order of Section 5.3. TTUHSC has not published specific page-limit, font, or margin requirements in this excerpt; please ensure the proposal is clear and discernable to the evaluating reader, and appendices such as resumes, sample artifacts, and the proposed Scope of Work may be included.
308. Reference: Section 4.3.2 and Section 6.1, Pricing How will TTUHSC score the thirty percent pricing factor? Will the lowest total not to exceed price receive full points with other proposals scored proportionally, or will TTUHSC apply another method? Will the level of effort schedule required by Section 6.1 be evaluated under the pricing factor or under service specifications?	Evaluation is based on the criteria in Section 4.3.2 (Service Specifications 55%, Experience and Reputation 15%, Pricing 30%). Costing for any solution offered is at the discretion of the Proposer. Cost breakdown within a deliverable line or a separate cost line is not a differentiator for TTUHSC reviewers. Please ensure costing is clear and discernable to the evaluating reader. Pricing is evaluated for reasonableness and value against the scope and level of effort. The level-of-effort schedule required by Section 6.1 supports the pricing review.
309. Section 4.8.1, Award of Agreement Does TTUHSC intend to make a single award for the full scope, or does TTUHSC anticipate multiple awards across capability areas? If multiple awards are possible, should proposers structure deliverable pricing so that individual deliverables can be awarded independently, and will TTUHSC evaluate partial proposals?	- It is TTUHSC's intention to issue a single award; however, in accordance with the terms of the RFP, TTUHSC reserves the right to award an agreement for all or any portion of the requirements, to award multiple agreements, or to reject any and all proposals if deemed to be in the best interests of TTUHSC. - A Proposer may bid on a subset of areas or deliverables and should clearly indicate which areas it is proposing; proposals are evaluated against the stated criteria.
310. Reference: Section 5.3, Item 1, Proposer's Experience and Reputation Should the three required references be drawn from higher education or healthcare organizations of	The intention is to request three separate reference clients. References are at the discretion of the Proposer and may be from any sector that compares favorably to the services requested within this RFP; a preference exists for higher education or healthcare organizations.

comparable scale and complexity, and will TTUHSC contact references before or after establishing the competitive range? For the project team, should proposers include full resumes, and does TTUHSC have minimum qualification or credential expectations for the designated Project Lead?	Full resumes may be included for the project team; TTUHSC has not published minimum credential thresholds for the Project Lead. References may be contacted during evaluation.
311. Reference: Section 4.5, Oral Presentations and Interviews If oral presentations are conducted, approximately when will they occur, will they be held in person in Lubbock or virtually, and will they be scored separately or used to adjust initial evaluation scores? Will TTUHSC provide an agenda or presentation topics in advance?	If conducted, oral presentations will most likely be virtual and scored separately, with an agenda provided to finalists in advance; the Contractor is expected to cover all deliverables and demonstrate selected deliverables. Timing would follow the evaluation period.
312. The RFP identifies the objective of moving TTUHSC from isolated, low-complexity AI utilization to durable, measurable, high-value adoption. Could TTUHSC identify the most significant organizational pain points or barriers currently limiting AI adoption and value realization, and which of these are considered the highest priority for this engagement?	Current utilization is isolated and low-complexity; barriers include limited enablement, ad hoc handling of use cases, and the absence of a formal baseline and governance maturity. Priorities are strategy and governance, change management, workforce upskilling, and adoption analytics and ROI; specific pain points will be assessed by the Contractor during the current-state assessment.
313. Beyond completion and acceptance of the six stated deliverables, what specific business outcomes or measures will TTUHSC use to determine whether the engagement has been successful at the end of the contract term?	Success measures include durable, measurable, high-value AI adoption, improved workforce capability, workflow efficiency, and measurable ROI; Baseline metrics have not been established. TTUHSC conducted some AI baseline surveys in 2025 and 2026, but the Contractor is expected to bring a method for measuring the baseline and, later, the ROI. The Contractor is expected to define the measurement framework.
314. Could TTUHSC provide an overview of the enterprise AI tools and platforms currently provisioned, including the principal platforms in use, major user populations, and whether usage/telemetry data is currently available to support the required adoption and proficiency measurement?	- Microsoft Copilot is currently the enterprise generative AI tool that has been deployed. Other GenAI tools are being evaluated. Examples of other tools provided enterprise-wide include Zoom AI Companion, Epic, Grammarly, etc. - Access to telemetry data will be provided to the Contractor if needed. Current utilization is isolated and low-complexity.
315. Has TTUHSC identified specific campuses, departments, functional areas, or workflows that should receive priority during the initial readiness assessment and workflow opportunity mapping, or should those priorities be established through the Contractor's assessment?	Priorities and specific campuses, departments, functional areas, or workflows for the initial assessment may be established through the Contractor's assessment; TTUHSC's priorities are strategy and governance, change management, workforce upskilling, and adoption analytics and ROI. Prototypes are expected across Academic, Clinical, Research, and Admin functional areas.
316. To ensure the Contractor builds upon rather than duplicates existing institutional work, will TTUHSC make available relevant prior AI assessments, technology inventories, workflow documentation, governance materials, use-case inventories, or related transformation initiatives?	Yes. TTUHSC will make available relevant inputs - including the active AI tool inventory, the responsible AI use policy (OP 52.21), 2025 and 2026 AI baseline surveys, and available governance materials - to the selected Contractor, so the Contractor builds upon rather than duplicates existing work.
317. Does TTUHSC have a preferred or required delivery model for this engagement—onsite, onshore remote, offshore, or hybrid—including any minimum onsite presence, campus visits, or restrictions regarding where Contractor personnel may perform the work?	TTUHSC expects some on-site presence but does not have strict requirements for delivery frequency or duration. A predominantly virtual/hybrid model is acceptable, with on-site presence concentrated at defined milestones such as executive alignment sessions and leadership workshops. The initial kickoff is preferred on all campuses (negotiable), and the leadership enablement meeting is preferred on-site in Lubbock, TX. Overall, a hybrid model is preferred. Travel is to be included in the fee. There is no mandated minimum on-site presence beyond milestone sessions; a hybrid model is preferred.
318. What level of participation should proposers assume from TTUHSC executive sponsors, IT/security personnel, functional subject-matter experts, and departmental leadership for assessments, workshops, workflow discovery, solution validation, training, and ROI measurement?	- The Chief AI Transformation Officer is the executive sponsor. TTUHSC has an AI Steering Committee which is the oversight body of the effort. - TTUHSC executive sponsor, IT/security personnel, functional SMEs, and departmental leadership will participate at levels appropriate to each deliverable. The Contractor is expected to deliver with collaborative TTUHSC participation rather than full co-staffing.
319. For the functional automation prototypes and custom solutions required under Deliverable 4, should proposers assume that selected prototypes are expected to progress to production deployment within this	TTUHSC is planning to have at least two workflows/use cases from each functional area (Academic, Clinical, Research, and Admin) evaluated by the Contractor, for a total of about 8 to 10 workflows. Solutions should be either pilot-ready or fully production-ready; the associated cost should not be included in the fixed fee but may be listed as an optional item for TTUHSC to

engagement, or is demonstration and validation of the prototypes the intended endpoint?	consider. Selected prototypes may progress to pilot-ready or production-ready status; demonstration and validation is the core endpoint, with production deployment treated as an optional item.
320. For use cases involving clinical, research, or other sensitive institutional information, what data environments will be available to the Contractor for assessment, development, testing, and validation—for example, production, de-identified, sanitized, or synthetic data?	PHI is not expected to be made available; de-identified, sanitized, synthetic, or test data will be available for assessment, development, testing, and validation. TTUHSC has test patient data that may be used, provided based on need.
321. What baseline data does TTUHSC currently have available regarding AI utilization, frequency of use, functional distribution, user proficiency, and departmental adoption, and will such data be made available to the selected Contractor?	- Baseline metrics have not been established. TTUHSC conducted some AI baseline surveys in 2025 and 2026, but the Contractor is expected to bring a method for measuring the baseline and, later, the ROI. - Access to telemetry data will be provided to the Contractor if needed. Available AI utilization data (e.g., from the active AI tool inventory and 2025/2026 baseline surveys) will be shared with the selected Contractor.
322. Does TTUHSC have an existing methodology or finance/operations-approved process for validating hours saved, financial savings, and operational velocity improvements, or should the selected Contractor establish the measurement and verification methodology collaboratively with TTUHSC?	- Baseline metrics have not been established. TTUHSC conducted some AI baseline surveys in 2025 and 2026, but the Contractor is expected to bring a method for measuring the baseline and, later, the ROI. - TTUHSC does not have an established finance/operations-approved validation methodology; the Contractor is expected to establish the measurement and verification methodology collaboratively with TTUHSC.
323. Beyond the security controls specified in the RFP, are there established TTUHSC enterprise architecture, cloud, identity, integration, API, data-platform, or technology standards that proposed AI solutions and integrations must conform to?	TTUHSC operates within a Microsoft enterprise environment. Proposed AI solutions and integrations should conform to TTUHSC's enterprise architecture, cloud, identity, integration, API, and data-platform standards; specifics will be provided to the selected Contractor and coordinated with TTUHSC IT.
324. Will TTUHSC define detailed acceptance criteria and KPIs for each of the six deliverables during project initiation, or should proposers propose the applicable acceptance criteria and measurement methods as part of their Project Plan?	- Deliverable acceptance is by the Chief AI Transformation Officer, the AI Steering Committee, and the President, and will depend on TTUHSC review cycles. - TTUHSC may establish acceptance criteria and KPIs at project initiation; proposers may also propose acceptance criteria and measurement methods in their Project Plan, to be agreed with the Contractor.
325. Does TTUHSC have a target kickoff date, overall completion date, or preferred sequencing/dependencies among the six deliverables that proposers should incorporate into their proposed work plan and staffing model?	- The following proposed Project Schedule may change based on RFP progress: - Kick-off meeting: February 2027; - Deliverable 1: April 2027; - Deliverable 2: April 2027; - Deliverable 3: September 2027; - Deliverable 4: September 2027; - Deliverable 5: December 2027; - Deliverable 6: February 2028. - TTUHSC is seeking completion of all deliverables and will work collaboratively in constructing a contract term that accommodates that position. - Proposers may incorporate their own kickoff/completion dates and sequencing; TTUHSC will work collaboratively on dependencies.
326. Has funding for this procurement been formally allocated, and if so, can TTUHSC provide an approved funding amount, anticipated budget range, contract ceiling, or other budget parameters that proposers may use to appropriately size the proposed level of effort and solution?	- The cost shall not exceed \$750,000. - Proposers may size the level of effort to the scope; costing is at the Proposer's discretion.
327. Could TTUHSC provide the approximate workforce population expected to participate in the required role-based training and the anticipated number of distinct functional or role-based learning tracks?	- Total number of employees: about 6,000. Abilene: ~100; Amarillo: ~700; Dallas: ~90; Lubbock: ~3,710; Permian Basin: ~600; Strategic Initiatives (Correctional Managed Care): ~800. - Functional domains (some groups overlap): Clinical: ~2,000; Academic: ~2,000; Research: ~1,300; Other (Admin, Operational, Supporting): ~2,000. Number of leaders: around 150-200. - The initial rollout will target about 3,000 individuals.

	The number of distinct role-based learning tracks may be proposed by the Contractor based on the readiness assessment.
328. For the required Change Champions Network, does TTUHSC have an existing network or organizational structure that the Contractor should leverage, or is the Contractor expected to design the network's membership, operating model, and engagement cadence?	TTUHSC has a President's Cabinet and utilizes a Council structure that can be leveraged as initial change champions (about 150-200 individuals). The number and structure of champions may be proposed by the Contractor based on the assessment.
329. For the required adoption and proficiency analytics, does TTUHSC expect the Contractor to aggregate telemetry across multiple existing AI platforms, and will the necessary APIs, administrative reporting capabilities, or usage datasets be available for that purpose?	Yes. The Contractor may be expected to aggregate telemetry across existing AI platforms; Access to telemetry data will be provided to the Contractor if needed. Necessary APIs, administrative reporting, or usage datasets will be provided based on need.
330. Given the RFP's emphasis on knowledge transfer and minimizing long-term reliance on external consultants, does TTUHSC intend to operate the resulting capabilities entirely in-house following transition, or would TTUHSC consider an optional ongoing managed-service/support model for selected capabilities	TTUHSC intends to operate the resulting capabilities internally following transition; an optional ongoing managed-service/support model for selected capabilities may be proposed as an optional item, with costs listed separately.
331. Who is the incumbent vendor currently providing similar services? Is the incumbent vendor allowed to participate in this RFP?	None.
332. What enterprise AI/LLM platforms and productivity assistants are currently deployed at TTUHSC?	Microsoft Copilot is currently the enterprise generative AI tool that has been deployed. Other GenAI tools are being evaluated. Examples of other tools provided enterprise-wide include Zoom AI Companion, Epic, Grammarly, etc.
333. What is TTUHSC's current cloud, data and AI technology stack (Azure/AWS/GCP/on-premises)?	TTUHSC operates within a Microsoft enterprise environment. Power BI is available. The current data/AI stack will be confirmed with the selected Contractor; the Proposer may state its assumptions.
334. Will TTUHSC provide sandbox/dev environments and API access for AI prototypes and integrations?	TTUHSC will not provide a dedicated sandbox, private tenant, or hosted environment for prototype development unless otherwise specified in the solicitation or subsequent contract documents. Proposers should assume responsibility for providing and managing any environments required to develop, host, demonstrate, and test proposed AI solutions. Any vendor-hosted environment used to store, process, or transmit TTUHSC data must comply with the security, privacy, and regulatory requirements defined in the RFP, including any applicable State of Texas and TTUHSC requirements.
335. How many workflows/use cases are expected to be prototyped under Deliverable 4?	TTUHSC anticipates about 8-10 workflows/use cases across the four functional areas; the Contractor may propose the number based on the current-state assessment.
336. Are prototypes expected to remain PoCs, or must selected solutions be production-deployed during this engagement?	- TTUHSC is planning to have at least two workflows/use cases from each functional area (Academic, Clinical, Research, and Admin) evaluated by the Contractor, for a total of about 8 to 10 workflows. Solutions should be either pilot-ready or fully production-ready; the associated cost should not be included in the fixed fee but may be listed as an optional item for TTUHSC to consider. - Selected solutions may be pilot-ready or production-ready; production deployment is treated as an optional item.
337. Will TTUHSC provide APIs/telemetry from its existing AI platforms for adoption and usage analytics?	Access to telemetry data will be provided to the Contractor if needed.
338. What is the approximate number of users, departments and campuses to be covered by AI adoption analytics and training?	- Total number of employees: about 6,000. Abilene: ~100; Amarillo: ~700; Dallas: ~90; Lubbock: ~3,710; Permian Basin: ~600; Strategic Initiatives (Correctional Managed Care): ~800. - Functional domains (some groups overlap): Clinical: ~2,000; Academic: ~2,000; Research: ~1,300; Other (Admin, Operational, Supporting): ~2,000. Number of leaders: around 150-200. - The initial rollout will target about 3,000 individuals.

339. What volume of users and concurrent transactions should custom/agent AI solutions be architected to support?	The Contractor may propose the target volume/concurrency for custom/agent AI solutions based on the use case; approximately 6,000 employees are in scope. Requirements will be refined with the Contractor. The initial rollout will target about 3,000 individuals.
340. Is TX-RAMP certification mandatory for every proposed software/platform component, or only for hosted cloud services handling TTUHSC data?	- Under Texas Government Code Sec. 2054.0593 and Texas Department of Information Resources guidelines, TX-RAMP applies specifically to Cloud Service Providers offering hosted cloud computing services (SaaS, PaaS, IaaS). Where the solution is delivered as a professional/managed service operating inside TTUHSC's approved enterprise environment, using TTUHSC's certified infrastructure and tooling, with no contractor-hosted cloud service and no institutional data leaving TTUHSC-controlled systems, TX-RAMP would likely not apply. Where a proposal includes a hosted cloud service, TX-RAMP would apply. - TX-RAMP applies to hosted cloud services handling TTUHSC data, not to every proposed software component.
341. What is the expected target number of AI use cases to be identified, prioritized, prototyped and/or deployed?	TTUHSC anticipates about 8-10 workflows/use cases across the four functional areas; the number identified, prioritized, prototyped, or deployed may be proposed by the Contractor based on the assessment.
342. Are the six deliverables sequential or expected to run in parallel?"	- The six deliverables may proceed as overlapping/concurrent workstreams; payment is per deliverable upon completion and acceptance. The following proposed Project Schedule may change based on RFP progress: - Kick-off meeting: February 2027; - Deliverable 1: April 2027; - Deliverable 2: April 2027; - Deliverable 3: September 2027; - Deliverable 4: September 2027; - Deliverable 5: December 2027; - Deliverable 6: February 2028. - TTUHSC is seeking completion of all deliverables and will work collaboratively in constructing a contract term that accommodates that position.
343. Does TTUHSC already have an AI governance framework?	TTUHSC has some governance structure already in place and seeks to align with both the NIST AI Risk Management Framework and the Texas DIR framework. TTUHSC has a responsible AI use policy (OP 52.21) and maintains an active AI tool inventory.
344. How many executives/managers are expected to participate?	There are around 150-200 leaders; the Contractor may propose the participant set (executives/managers) based on role and organizational level.
345. What communication channels are currently used for organizational change?	TTUHSC uses standard enterprise communication channels (e.g., Microsoft environment, email, and the President's Cabinet/Council structure) for organizational change; the Contractor may propose the communications approach.
346. "How many training hours/courses are expected? Is certification mandatory?"	The number of training hours/courses may be proposed by the Contractor based on the readiness assessment. Certification/badging is not mandated; the Proposer may recommend an approach, and TTUHSC's LMS is available.
347. Is TTUHSC expecting a dashboard/platform to be developed, or will existing BI tools be used?	Either route is acceptable, with no preference here. Power BI is available; existing BI tools may be used or a solution proposed.
348. What is TTUHSC's enterprise application landscape?	TTUHSC operates within a Microsoft enterprise environment. In-scope enterprise applications (e.g., ERP, EHR/Epic) will be prioritized with the Contractor based on the current-state assessment.
349. What level of post-implementation support, managed services and knowledge-transfer capability is expected after completion?	TTUHSC plans to operate and maintain deliverables internally after the term; post-implementation support, managed services, and knowledge transfer are expected to favor internal capability, with any ongoing support proposed as an optional item. Knowledge transfer is expected throughout the engagement.
350. AI Strategy, Governance & Transformation Planning (Deliverable 1: Strategy & Planning) a. Who are the key executives who would participate in the executive alignment sessions in terms of their roles?	The Chief AI Transformation Officer is the executive sponsor. TTUHSC has an AI Steering Committee which is the oversight body of the effort. The core alignment group will be identified at kickoff and includes the Chief AI Transformation Officer, AI Steering Committee members, and academic/clinical leadership. No formal prior AI readiness/maturity assessment, data architecture review, or use-case inventory exists; some AI baseline surveys (2025 and 2026) and an active AI tool inventory can be shared, and a fresh assessment is still required.

b. Has TTUHSC already conducted (or engaged a vendor for) any AI readiness/maturity assessment, data architecture review, or use-case inventory prior to this RFP? If so, can that material be shared with proposers, and is a fresh assessment still required?	
351. Leadership Activation & Change Management (Deliverable 2: Leadership Activation) a. How many executives would be expected to participate in workshop/briefing sessions? b. Have you identified a program lead or leads for AI enablement who will coordinate this work internally with the support of the vendor?	There are around 150-200 leaders; the Contractor may propose the participant set. The Chief AI Transformation Officer is the executive sponsor. TTUHSC has an AI Steering Committee which is the oversight body of the effort. The Chief AI Transformation Officer coordinates the effort internally with the Contractor's support.
352. Workforce Upskilling, Training & Capability Building (Deliverable 3: Workforce Upskilling) a. Approximately how many staff are in each of the target roles for upskilling? b. How are staff geographically distributed? c. What existing platforms and learning tools do staff and students have access to?	- Total number of employees: about 6,000. Abilene: ~100; Amarillo: ~700; Dallas: ~90; Lubbock: ~3,710; Permian Basin: ~600; Strategic Initiatives (Correctional Managed Care): ~800. - Functional domains (some groups overlap): Clinical: ~2,000; Academic: ~2,000; Research: ~1,300; Other (Admin, Operational, Supporting): ~2,000. Number of leaders: around 150-200. - The initial rollout will target about 3,000 individuals. - Yes, TTUHSC has an LMS. Staff and students have access to the existing TTUHSC LMS and Microsoft environment.
353. Workflow Automation, Custom Solutions & Agentic Strategy (Deliverable 4: Workflow & Automation) a. Which AI platforms, LLMs and embedded productivity assistants are already in production, and which are slated? b. How many priority use cases does TTUHSC intend to pursue for workflow automation and custom solutions?	- Microsoft Copilot is currently the enterprise generative AI tool that has been deployed. Other GenAI tools are being evaluated. Examples of other tools provided enterprise-wide include Zoom AI Companion, Epic, Grammarly, etc. - TTUHSC intends about 8-10 priority use cases across the four functional areas for workflow automation and custom solutions; the Contractor may propose the number based on the assessment.
354. Analytics, Adoption Tracking & Impact Measurement (Deliverable 5: Analytics & ROI) a. Does TTUHSC want a hosted platform, a managed service, or an internal capability build-out for analytics and ROI tracking? b. Are there existing BI tools (e.g., Power BI) already licensed that should be leveraged rather than introducing a new platform?	Either a hosted platform, a managed service, or an internal capability build-out is acceptable, with no preference. Power BI is already available and may be leveraged rather than introducing a new platform. TTUHSC plans to operate and maintain deliverables internally after the term.
355. Enterprise Security & Data Privacy Compliance a. Will the Contractor or its analytics platform need to obtain a TX-RAMP certification, and at what level?	- Under Texas Government Code Sec. 2054.0593 and Texas Department of Information Resources guidelines, TX-RAMP applies specifically to Cloud Service Providers offering hosted cloud computing services (SaaS, PaaS, IaaS). Where the solution is delivered as a professional/managed service operating inside TTUHSC's approved enterprise environment, using TTUHSC's certified infrastructure and tooling, with no contractor-hosted cloud service and no institutional data leaving TTUHSC-controlled systems, TX-RAMP would likely not apply. Where a proposal includes a hosted cloud service, TX-RAMP would apply. - Where TX-RAMP applies to a hosted analytics component, the level is generally Level 1 for non-PHI operational data and Level 2 for confidential/regulated data. A solution delivered inside TTUHSC's tenant would generally fall outside TX-RAMP scope.
356. Engagement Structure and Management a. What is TTUHSC's anticipated total budget, and what is the proposed ceiling for each deliverable?	- The cost shall not exceed \$750,000. - TTUHSC will work collaboratively on the term and would consider a recommendation to extend the timeline if the agreed deliverable schedule warrants. Priorities are strategy and governance, change management, workforce upskilling, and adoption analytics and ROI; the Contractor is

b. Would TTUHSC be open to a recommendation, based on the scope of work, to extend the project timeline beyond August 31, 2027? c. Which of the seven capability families (A-G) are highest-priority? Are there some that are more aspirational?	expected to address all capability families.
357. Section 5.4 references enterprise AI tools already provisioned, including large language models and embedded AI productivity assistants. Can TTUHSC identify which tools are in place? Additionally, can TTUHSC provide the approximate employee headcount and number of operational units in scope across the academic, administrative, clinical, and research categories? This information is needed to develop a defensible level of effort schedule under Section 6.1.	- Microsoft Copilot is currently the enterprise generative AI tool that has been deployed. Other GenAI tools are being evaluated. Examples of other tools provided enterprise-wide include Zoom AI Companion, Epic, Grammarly, etc. - Total number of employees: about 6,000. Abilene: ~100; Amarillo: ~700; Dallas: ~90; Lubbock: ~3,710; Permian Basin: ~600; Strategic Initiatives (Correctional Managed Care): ~800. - Functional domains (some groups overlap): Clinical: ~2,000; Academic: ~2,000; Research: ~1,300; Other (Admin, Operational, Supporting): ~2,000. Number of leaders: around 150-200. - The initial rollout will target about 3,000 individuals.
358. The Project Schedule in Section 5.4 lists a kick-off meeting and six deliverable completion dates as blanks. Does TTUHSC have target dates in mind, or should the proposer propose the schedule within the term ending August 31, 2027?	- The following proposed Project Schedule may change based on RFP progress: - Kick-off meeting: February 2027; - Deliverable 1: April 2027; - Deliverable 2: April 2027; - Deliverable 3: September 2027; - Deliverable 4: September 2027; - Deliverable 5: December 2027; - Deliverable 6: February 2028. - TTUHSC is seeking completion of all deliverables and will work collaboratively in constructing a contract term that accommodates that position. - Proposers may propose the schedule within the term.
359. Is there an anticipated budget range or funding ceiling for the initial term?	The cost shall not exceed \$750,000.
360. Requirement E contemplates delivery through a software platform, managed analytics services, or integrated reporting tools, and Requirement C.5 contemplates a searchable knowledge repository. Does TTUHSC consider these components to be cloud computing services requiring TX-RAMP certification at the time of award, or may a proposer pursue certification post-award? Alternatively, would TTUHSC accept these components delivered within TTUHSC-owned tenancy and infrastructure, which we understand would not independently trigger TX-RAMP.	- Under Texas Government Code Sec. 2054.0593 and Texas Department of Information Resources guidelines, TX-RAMP applies specifically to Cloud Service Providers offering hosted cloud computing services (SaaS, PaaS, IaaS). Where the solution is delivered as a professional/managed service operating inside TTUHSC's approved enterprise environment, using TTUHSC's certified infrastructure and tooling, with no contractor-hosted cloud service and no institutional data leaving TTUHSC-controlled systems, TX-RAMP would likely not apply. Where a proposal includes a hosted cloud service, TX-RAMP would apply. - A Deliverable 5 component or knowledge repository delivered within TTUHSC-owned tenancy and infrastructure would not independently trigger TX-RAMP. Where a hosted component applies, certification may be pursued post-award, with full certification prior to production deployment.
361. Section 5.4.F contemplates HIPAA compliance and the RFP includes a Business Associate Agreement. If an engagement is scoped so that the Contractor does not create, receive, maintain, or transmit protected health information, would TTUHSC still require execution of the BAA?	The Business Associate Agreement would be executed where the approved scope of work requires access to PHI; it is included so that it is in place if PHI access is required. Where the Contractor does not create, receive, maintain, or transmit PHI, TTUHSC would not require execution of the BAA for that scope; PHI is not expected to be made available.
362. Section 3.7 requires a subcontracting plan and identifies NIGP commodity code 91878. Can TTUHSC confirm the specific form to be submitted and the applicable HUB subcontracting goal for this procurement? Where a proposer intends to subcontract a defined portion of the scope, please confirm whether Good Faith Effort documentation is required, and identify any advance notice period a proposer must observe prior to the Submittal Deadline.	A self-performing VetHUB Subcontracting Plan is responsive; where a Proposer intends to subcontract a defined portion, good-faith-effort documentation and any advance notice under the Comptroller's HUB rules apply. The applicable form is the Comptroller's HUB Subcontracting Plan referenced in Section 3.7/Appendix C; no specific participation percentage is mandated for this engagement.

363. Appendix A, Section 1.3 provides that all materials produced under the Agreement are works made for hire owned by TTUHSC, and that Consultant shall not assert any claim thereto. Will TTUHSC consider a background intellectual property provision under which a proposer's pre-existing proprietary methodologies, frameworks, and diagnostic instruments, and a technology partner's pre-existing platform and code, remain owned by their respective owners and are licensed to TTUHSC for its use of the deliverables, while all newly created deliverables and TTUHSC-specific work product transfer to TTUHSC as contemplated by Section 1.3?	It is not the intention of TTUHSC to make claim to pre-existing intellectual property. Please note Section 7 - General Terms and Conditions; if a Proposer takes exception to any Required Term, the Proposer should submit a list of the exceptions as part of its proposal. Newly created deliverables and TTUHSC-specific work product transfer to TTUHSC as contemplated by Section 1.3; pre-existing/background IP may be addressed as an exception under Section 7.
364. Approximately how many TTUHSC employees/users are expected to be in scope for the enterprise AI adoption and enablement initiative?	- Total number of employees: about 6,000. Abilene: ~100; Amarillo: ~700; Dallas: ~90; Lubbock: ~3,710; Permian Basin: ~600; Strategic Initiatives (Correctional Managed Care): ~800. - Functional domains (some groups overlap): Clinical: ~2,000; Academic: ~2,000; Research: ~1,300; Other (Admin, Operational, Supporting): ~2,000. Number of leaders: around 150-200. - The initial rollout will target about 3,000 individuals.
365. Approximately how many academic, administrative, clinical, and research departments or functional areas are expected to participate in the initial readiness assessment and workflow discovery activities?	- The scope spans academic, administrative, clinical, and research units across the five campuses; the number of units participating in the initial assessment may be prioritized with the Contractor based on the current-state assessment. - Total number of employees: about 6,000. Abilene: ~100; Amarillo: ~700; Dallas: ~90; Lubbock: ~3,710; Permian Basin: ~600; Strategic Initiatives (Correctional Managed Care): ~800. - Functional domains (some groups overlap): Clinical: ~2,000; Academic: ~2,000; Research: ~1,300; Other (Admin, Operational, Supporting): ~2,000. Number of leaders: around 150-200. - The initial rollout will target about 3,000 individuals.
366. Does TTUHSC have an anticipated number of workflows/use cases that the Contractor should assess, prioritize, and document?	TTUHSC anticipates about 8-10 workflows/use cases across the four functional areas; the Contractor may propose the number based on the current-state assessment.
367. Does TTUHSC have an anticipated number of functional prototypes or custom AI solutions expected under Deliverable 4?	TTUHSC is planning to have at least two workflows/use cases from each functional area (Academic, Clinical, Research, and Admin) evaluated by the Contractor, for a total of about 8 to 10 workflows. Solutions should be either pilot-ready or fully production-ready; the associated cost should not be included in the fixed fee but may be listed as an optional item for TTUHSC to consider.
368. Are the prototypes under Deliverable 4 expected to remain proof-of-concept solutions, or should the Contractor plan for production deployment of selected solutions?	- TTUHSC is planning to have at least two workflows/use cases from each functional area (Academic, Clinical, Research, and Admin) evaluated by the Contractor, for a total of about 8 to 10 workflows. Solutions should be either pilot-ready or fully production-ready; the associated cost should not be included in the fixed fee but may be listed as an optional item for TTUHSC to consider. - Selected solutions may be pilot-ready or production-ready; production deployment is treated as an optional item.
369. What enterprise AI platforms, LLMs, productivity assistants, or related AI technologies are currently licensed or deployed by TTUHSC?	Microsoft Copilot is currently the enterprise generative AI tool that has been deployed. Other GenAI tools are being evaluated. Examples of other tools provided enterprise-wide include Zoom AI Companion, Epic, Grammarly, etc.
370. Approximately how many employees are expected to participate in the workforce upskilling program, and does TTUHSC have expectations regarding the number of courses, workshops, learning cohorts, or training hours?	- Total number of employees: about 6,000. Abilene: ~100; Amarillo: ~700; Dallas: ~90; Lubbock: ~3,710; Permian Basin: ~600; Strategic Initiatives (Correctional Managed Care): ~800. - Functional domains (some groups overlap): Clinical: ~2,000; Academic: ~2,000; Research: ~1,300; Other (Admin, Operational, Supporting): ~2,000. Number of leaders: around 150-200. - The initial rollout will target about 3,000 individuals.

	The number of courses, workshops, cohorts, and training hours may be proposed by the Contractor based on the readiness assessment.
371. For the Leadership Activation and Change Management requirements, does TTUHSC have an anticipated number of executive workshops, departments, change champions, or other engagement activities?	The number of executive workshops, departments, and change champions may be proposed by the Contractor based on the assessment. The President's Cabinet and Council structure (about 150-200 individuals) can serve as initial champions; there are around 150-200 leaders.
372. Does TTUHSC currently have AI usage/adoption telemetry available from its enterprise AI platforms that can be used for the adoption and proficiency analytics requirements?	Access to telemetry data will be provided to the Contractor if needed.
373. For the Analytics and ROI Reporting deliverable, does TTUHSC expect the Contractor to provide a new software platform, or may the Contractor integrate reporting into existing TTUHSC analytics/BI platforms?	Either route is acceptable, with no preference here. Power BI is available; the Contractor may integrate reporting into existing TTUHSC analytics/BI platforms or propose a solution.
374. To what extent does TTUHSC anticipate that the engagement, particularly workflow automation and prototype development, will involve PHI or other regulated clinical data?	PHI or regulated clinical data involvement is expected to be limited; activities may rely on sanitized/de-identified/test data. Where any PHI is involved, the BAA would apply and PHI must remain within TTUHSC-controlled systems.
375. Can the experience, qualifications, and client references of proposed subcontractors or sub-consultants be considered in meeting the Experience and Reputation requirements, including the requirement for at least three references?	Yes. The experience, qualifications, and references of proposed subcontractors or sub-consultants may be considered in meeting the Experience and Reputation requirements, including the three-reference requirement.
376. Can commercial-sector client references demonstrating comparable enterprise AI strategy, governance, adoption, automation, training, or analytics experience satisfy the reference requirement?	The intention is to request three separate reference clients. References are at the discretion of the Proposer and may be from any sector that compares favorably to the services requested within this RFP; a preference exists for higher education or healthcare organizations. Commercial-sector references demonstrating comparable enterprise AI strategy, governance, adoption, automation, training, or analytics experience are acceptable.
377. Is previous healthcare and/or higher-education experience required or specifically preferred, or will comparable enterprise AI transformation experience from other regulated industries be evaluated equally?	Higher education or healthcare experience is preferred but not strictly required; comparable enterprise AI transformation experience from other regulated industries will be evaluated favorably against the stated criteria.
378. If healthcare or higher-education experience is considered particularly important, which portions of the scope does TTUHSC expect that experience to support most directly?	Where healthcare or higher-education experience is relevant, it most directly supports the clinical/academic scope, workforce upskilling, governance, and change management; comparable experience from other regulated industries is also evaluated.
379. May proposers respond to selected workstreams/deliverables, or does TTUHSC expect each proposer to provide a comprehensive response covering all requirements in Sections 5.4 A through G?	- It is TTUHSC's intention to issue a single award; however, in accordance with the terms of the RFP, TTUHSC reserves the right to award an agreement for all or any portion of the requirements, to award multiple agreements, or to reject any and all proposals if deemed to be in the best interests of TTUHSC. - A Proposer may respond to selected workstreams/deliverables or provide a comprehensive response; proposals are evaluated against the stated criteria. A comprehensive response covering all requirements is welcomed.
380. What is the anticipated project start date, and does TTUHSC have target completion dates or desired durations for each of the six deliverables?	- The following proposed Project Schedule may change based on RFP progress: - Kick-off meeting: February 2027; - Deliverable 1: April 2027; - Deliverable 2: April 2027; - Deliverable 3: September 2027; - Deliverable 4: September 2027; - Deliverable 5: December 2027; - Deliverable 6: February 2028. - TTUHSC is seeking completion of all deliverables and will work collaboratively in constructing a contract term that accommodates that position.
381. What enterprise AI tools and supporting technology platforms are currently deployed within TTUHSC?	Microsoft Copilot is currently the enterprise generative AI tool that has been deployed. Other GenAI tools are being evaluated. Examples of other tools provided enterprise-wide include Zoom AI Companion, Epic, Grammarly, etc.
382. Is TX-RAMP authorization required for advisory-only services, or only when a respondent proposes hosted software or SaaS components?	Under Texas Government Code Sec. 2054.0593 and Texas Department of Information Resources guidelines, TX-RAMP applies specifically to Cloud Service Providers offering hosted cloud computing services (SaaS, PaaS, IaaS).

	Where the solution is delivered as a professional/managed service operating inside TTUHSC's approved enterprise environment, using TTUHSC's certified infrastructure and tooling, with no contractor-hosted cloud service and no institutional data leaving TTUHSC-controlled systems, TX-RAMP would likely not apply. Where a proposal includes a hosted cloud service, TX-RAMP would apply. Advisory-only services with no vendor-hosted software/SaaS component would fall outside TX-RAMP scope.
383. Who will serve as the executive sponsor or sponsors for the initiative, and what governance body or individual will review and approve our deliverables?	- The Chief AI Transformation Officer is the executive sponsor. TTUHSC has an AI Steering Committee which is the oversight body of the effort. - The Contractor will coordinate with the Chief AI Transformation Officer, with oversight and deliverable review by the AI Steering Committee (and, for acceptance, the President).
384. Are there any AI related policies developed, so can you let us know what AI-related policies and procedures are already created?	- TTUHSC has some governance structure already in place and seeks to align with both the NIST AI Risk Management Framework and the Texas DIR framework. TTUHSC has a responsible AI use policy (OP 52.21) and maintains an active AI tool inventory. - TTUHSC has a responsible AI use policy (OP 52.21) and an active AI tool inventory; the Contractor should build upon these.
385. If budget or schedule constraints require prioritization, which workstreams are most important to TTUHSC: strategy and governance, change management, workforce upskilling, workflow automation and development, or adoption analytics and ROI measurement?	Priorities are strategy and governance, change management, workforce upskilling, and adoption analytics and ROI. The Contractor is expected to address all capability families; sequencing may be proposed.
386. Can TTUHSC provide the anticipated budget range or funding allocation for the engagement?	The cost shall not exceed \$750,000.
387. Should respondents' price complete end-to-end engagement, or can we price by phase?	Costing for any solution offered is at the discretion of the Proposer. Cost breakdown within a deliverable line or a separate cost line is not a differentiator for TTUHSC reviewers. Please ensure costing is clear and discernable to the evaluating reader. Pricing by phase is acceptable provided the total and any deliverable-level costs are clear and discernable.
388. Should respondents assume remote, hybrid, or regular onsite delivery, and which campuses are likely to require onsite activities? If hybrid what percentage should be expected on site and will expenses be billed in addition to the budget?	TTUHSC expects some on-site presence but does not have strict requirements for delivery frequency or duration. A predominantly virtual/hybrid model is acceptable, with on-site presence concentrated at defined milestones such as executive alignment sessions and leadership workshops. The initial kickoff is preferred on all campuses (negotiable), and the leadership enablement meeting is preferred on-site in Lubbock, TX. Overall, a hybrid model is preferred. Travel is to be included in the fee. The Proposer may state the on-site percentage assumed; travel and expenses are to be included in the fixed fee, not billed in addition.
389. Can TTUHSC provide an approximate number of employees / end-users (or a range by campus / functional area) who will be in scope for workforce upskilling, change champions, and adoption analytics?	- Total number of employees: about 6,000. Abilene: ~100; Amarillo: ~700; Dallas: ~90; Lubbock: ~3,710; Permian Basin: ~600; Strategic Initiatives (Correctional Managed Care): ~800. - Functional domains (some groups overlap): Clinical: ~2,000; Academic: ~2,000; Research: ~1,300; Other (Admin, Operational, Supporting): ~2,000. Number of leaders: around 150-200. - The initial rollout will target about 3,000 individuals.
390. Has TTUHSC already selected or provisioned specific enterprise LLM platforms and productivity assistants (e.g., Microsoft Copilot, ChatGPT Enterprise, Claude, etc.)? If so, can you share which platforms are currently approved and in use?	- Microsoft Copilot is currently the enterprise generative AI tool that has been deployed. Other GenAI tools are being evaluated. Examples of other tools provided enterprise-wide include Zoom AI Companion, Epic, Grammarly, etc. - The Proposer may tailor its approach to the deployed Microsoft Copilot environment; other tools are being evaluated.
391. For Deliverable 4 (Workflow Automation, Custom Solutions & Agentic Strategy), does TTUHSC expect the Contractor to perform hands-on custom development and prototyping, or primarily to design,	The Contractor is expected to perform hands-on prototyping and, where warranted, bespoke development, API integrations, and custom model orchestration, as well as design, prioritize, govern, and oversee. TTUHSC anticipates about 8-10 workflows across the four functional areas.

prioritize, govern, and oversee internal or 3rd party development?	
392. Will any portion of the work require on-site presence at one or more campuses, or is a fully remote / virtual delivery model acceptable for all workshops, training, and leadership sessions?	• TTUHSC expects some on-site presence but does not have strict requirements for delivery frequency or duration. A predominantly virtual/hybrid model is acceptable, with on-site presence concentrated at defined milestones such as executive alignment sessions and leadership workshops. The initial kickoff is preferred on all campuses (negotiable), and the leadership enablement meeting is preferred on-site in Lubbock, TX. Overall, a hybrid model is preferred. Travel is to be included in the fee. A fully remote model is not preferred; some on-site presence is expected at milestones.
393. Is there a preferred or required alignment with specific Texas frameworks beyond general DIR / TX-RAMP / FERPA / HIPAA requirements (e.g., Texas Responsible AI Governance Act / HB 149, SB 1964, or internal TTUHSC AI policies already in draft)?	• TTUHSC has some governance structure already in place and seeks to align with both the NIST AI Risk Management Framework and the Texas DIR framework. TTUHSC has a responsible AI use policy (OP 52.21) and maintains an active AI tool inventory. • The Contractor should align with the NIST AI RMF, Texas DIR, FERPA, and HIPAA, and build upon TTUHSC's OP 52.21. TTUHSC expects the Contractor to account for applicable Texas AI-related requirements; specific alignment will be confirmed with the selected Contractor.
394. For the Traceability Matrix and ROI modeling requirements, will TTUHSC provide baseline operational metrics (hours, cycle times, cost data) for the highest-priority use cases, or should the Contractor include a discovery effort to establish those baselines?	• Baseline metrics have not been established. TTUHSC conducted some AI baseline surveys in 2025 and 2026, but the Contractor is expected to bring a method for measuring the baseline and, later, the ROI. • TTUHSC does not have established baseline operational metrics for the priority use cases; the Contractor should include a discovery effort to establish those baselines.
395. Does TTUHSC anticipate any follow-on or optional years beyond the August 31, 2027 term for continued enablement or managed services?	• TTUHSC's current intent is completion of the six deliverables within the awarded term; follow-on or optional years for continued enablement or managed services are not committed but may be proposed as optional items.
396. What are the top 3-5 business outcomes TTUHSC expects to achieve through this engagement in the first 12 months?	• TTUHSC seeks durable, measurable, high-value AI adoption; priorities are strategy and governance, change management, workforce upskilling, and adoption analytics and ROI. Specific 12-month outcomes will be confirmed during executive alignment; Baseline metrics have not been established. TTUHSC conducted some AI baseline surveys in 2025 and 2026, but the Contractor is expected to bring a method for measuring the baseline and, later, the ROI.
397. Can TTUHSC provide indicative volumes for employees/users to be enabled, organizational functions/departments in scope, workflows to be assessed, and AI use cases expected during the engagement?	• Total number of employees: about 6,000. Abilene: ~100; Amarillo: ~700; Dallas: ~90; Lubbock: ~3,710; Permian Basin: ~600; Strategic Initiatives (Correctional Managed Care): ~800. • Functional domains (some groups overlap): Clinical: ~2,000; Academic: ~2,000; Research: ~1,300; Other (Admin, Operational, Supporting): ~2,000. Number of leaders: around 150-200. • The initial rollout will target about 3,000 individuals. • TTUHSC is planning to have at least two workflows/use cases from each functional area (Academic, Clinical, Research, and Admin) evaluated by the Contractor, for a total of about 8 to 10 workflows. Solutions should be either pilot-ready or fully production-ready; the associated cost should not be included in the fixed fee but may be listed as an optional item for TTUHSC to consider.
398. Are the six deliverables expected to be executed sequentially or concurrently?	• The six deliverables may be executed sequentially or concurrently, as proposed; payment is per deliverable upon completion and acceptance. The following proposed Project Schedule may change based on RFP progress: ○ Kick-off meeting: February 2027; ○ Deliverable 1: April 2027; ○ Deliverable 2: April 2027; ○ Deliverable 3: September 2027; ○ Deliverable 4: September 2027; ○ Deliverable 5: December 2027; ○ Deliverable 6: February 2028. • TTUHSC is seeking completion of all deliverables and will work

	collaboratively in constructing a contract term that accommodates that position.
399. What quantitative or qualitative targets will TTUHSC use to measure success across AI adoption, workforce capability, workflow efficiency, cost/time savings and ROI?	- Baseline metrics have not been established. TTUHSC conducted some AI baseline surveys in 2025 and 2026, but the Contractor is expected to bring a method for measuring the baseline and, later, the ROI. - Targets across AI adoption, workforce capability, workflow efficiency, cost/time savings, and ROI will be defined collaboratively; the Contractor is expected to define the measurement framework.
400. What AI platforms, tools and technologies are currently approved or deployed across TTUHSC?	Microsoft Copilot is currently the enterprise generative AI tool that has been deployed. Other GenAI tools are being evaluated. Examples of other tools provided enterprise-wide include Zoom AI Companion, Epic, Grammarly, etc.
401. TTUHSC has provisioned enterprise AI tools, we would like to understand whether TTUHSC currently have an AI Center of Excellence, AI governance framework, or responsible-AI policies in place?	- TTUHSC has some governance structure already in place and seeks to align with both the NIST AI Risk Management Framework and the Texas DIR framework. TTUHSC has a responsible AI use policy (OP 52.21) and maintains an active AI tool inventory. - TTUHSC has an AI Steering Committee that serves as the oversight body; a formal AI Center of Excellence has not been established, and the Contractor may recommend enhancements to the governance structure.
402. What enterprise applications and platforms are expected to be integrated with the AI solutions developed under the engagement?	TTUHSC operates within a Microsoft enterprise environment. Enterprise applications and platforms expected to be integrated will be prioritized with the Contractor based on the current-state assessment; access and documentation will be provided based on need.
403. How many AI/agent AI use cases does TTUHSC expect to be identified and prioritized during the engagement?	TTUHSC anticipates about 8-10 AI/agent use cases across the four functional areas; the Contractor may propose the number based on the assessment.
404. How many functional prototypes or proofs of concept are expected to be developed under Deliverable 4?	TTUHSC is planning to have at least two workflows/use cases from each functional area (Academic, Clinical, Research, and Admin) evaluated by the Contractor, for a total of about 8 to 10 workflows. Solutions should be either pilot-ready or fully production-ready; the associated cost should not be included in the fixed fee but may be listed as an optional item for TTUHSC to consider.
405. For the AI workflow and agent AI prototypes, is production implementation expected within this contract, or is the scope limited to discovery, design and prototype development?	- TTUHSC is planning to have at least two workflows/use cases from each functional area (Academic, Clinical, Research, and Admin) evaluated by the Contractor, for a total of about 8 to 10 workflows. Solutions should be either pilot-ready or fully production-ready; the associated cost should not be included in the fixed fee but may be listed as an optional item for TTUHSC to consider. - The scope centers on discovery, design, and prototype development; selected solutions may be pilot-ready or production-ready, with production implementation treated as an optional item.
406. Does TTUHSC expect clinical AI use cases to be included in the initial engagement, or will the initial portfolio focus primarily on administrative, academic, research and operational workflows?	The clinical scope may extend to clinical decision support, diagnostic, and patient-facing applications; the initial portfolio is expected to emphasize administrative, academic, research, and operational workflows, with clinical applications subject to human-in-the-loop controls and clinical validation before any production deployment.
407. What categories of PHI, PII, student data or research data are expected to be accessed by the contractor?	PHI is not expected to be accessed; activities may rely on sanitized, de-identified, or synthetic data. Where any PHI, PII, student data, or research data is involved, applicable protections (including the BAA for PHI) would apply, provided based on need.
408. Can TTUHSC provide de-identified or synthetic data for development, testing and prototyping activities where direct access to PHI is not required?	Yes. TTUHSC can provide de-identified, sanitized, or test data for development, testing, and prototyping where direct PHI access is not required; TTUHSC has test patient data that may be used.
409. Can personnel located outside the United States support solution development, testing or engineering activities where they have no access to PHI or other regulated data?	Personnel located outside the United States may support solution development, testing, or engineering activities that involve no access to PHI or other regulated data, subject to TTUHSC approval; TTUHSC institutional data must remain within the United States. The preference is US-based performance.
410. Does TTUHSC require all personnel with access to PHI to be physically located in the United States?	Yes. Consistent with BAA Section 1.53.11, PHI must not be accessed, stored, or transmitted outside the United States; personnel with PHI access are expected to be US-based. PHI is not expected to be made available.

411. Does TTUHSC require all PHI and other regulated data to be hosted and processed within the United States?	Yes. PHI and regulated data must be hosted and processed within the United States and kept within TTUHSC-controlled systems. This restriction applies to PHI and all TTUHSC institutional data.
412. Is TX-RAMP compliance/certification required for the prime contractor, specific technology platforms proposed by the contractor, or both?	- Under Texas Government Code Sec. 2054.0593 and Texas Department of Information Resources guidelines, TX-RAMP applies specifically to Cloud Service Providers offering hosted cloud computing services (SaaS, PaaS, IaaS). Where the solution is delivered as a professional/managed service operating inside TTUHSC's approved enterprise environment, using TTUHSC's certified infrastructure and tooling, with no contractor-hosted cloud service and no institutional data leaving TTUHSC-controlled systems, TX-RAMP would likely not apply. Where a proposal includes a hosted cloud service, TX-RAMP would apply. - TX-RAMP applies to proposed hosted cloud technology platforms handling TTUHSC data, not to the prime contractor as such where no hosted cloud service is provided.
413. At what stage must TX-RAMP compliance be demonstrated - proposal submission, contract execution, or production deployment?	- Under Texas Government Code Sec. 2054.0593 and Texas Department of Information Resources guidelines, TX-RAMP applies specifically to Cloud Service Providers offering hosted cloud computing services (SaaS, PaaS, IaaS). Where the solution is delivered as a professional/managed service operating inside TTUHSC's approved enterprise environment, using TTUHSC's certified infrastructure and tooling, with no contractor-hosted cloud service and no institutional data leaving TTUHSC-controlled systems, TX-RAMP would likely not apply. Where a proposal includes a hosted cloud service, TX-RAMP would apply. - Where TX-RAMP applies to a hosted component, a provisional/in-process designation may be acceptable at proposal submission or contract execution, with full certification required prior to production deployment. It is not a blanket prerequisite for submission.
414. What cybersecurity certifications, attestations or security frameworks (e.g., SOC 2, ISO 27001, HITRUST) must the selected contractor already possess at the time of proposal submission?	No specific cybersecurity certifications (e.g., SOC 2, ISO 27001, HITRUST) are required to be held at the time of proposal submission for responsiveness; such certifications are most relevant where a vendor hosts or processes covered institutional data. Any solution must meet the RFP's security and data-privacy requirements.
415. Can TTUHSC confirm the required limits for professional liability, cyber liability and/or HIPAA-related insurance applicable to this engagement, beyond the general liability limits stated in the RFP?	Please note Section 7 - General Terms and Conditions. If a Proposer takes exception to any of the Required Terms, the Proposer should submit a list of the exceptions as part of its proposal. Beyond the general liability limits stated in the RFP, TTUHSC has not specified separate professional, cyber, or HIPAA-related insurance limits; a Proposer may submit any exception or proposed limits under Section 7.
416. Are there any contractual limitations on liability or indemnification that TTUHSC is able to offer to the selected contractor?	Please note Section 7 - General Terms and Conditions. If a Proposer takes exception to any of the Required Terms, the Proposer should submit a list of the exceptions as part of its proposal. Any limitation of liability or indemnification would be addressed through the exception process under Section 7.
417. Would TTUHSC consider a mutual limitation of liability capped at total contract value, with exclusion of consequential and indirect damages, in Appendix A Section 1.7?	Please note Section 7 - General Terms and Conditions. If a Proposer takes exception to any of the Required Terms, the Proposer should submit a list of the exceptions as part of its proposal. A mutual limitation of liability capped at total contract value, with exclusion of consequential and indirect damages, may be submitted as an exception to Section 1.7 under Section 7 for TTUHSC's consideration.
418. Can TTUHSC clarify how ownership of pre-existing contractor IP, frameworks, accelerators, methodologies and reusable software will be treated where these are incorporated into deliverables?	It is not the intention of TTUHSC to make claim to pre-existing intellectual property. Please note Section 7 - General Terms and Conditions; if a Proposer takes exception to any Required Term, the Proposer should submit a list of the exceptions as part of its proposal.
419. Would TTUHSC consider granting the University a perpetual, royalty-free license to deliverables, while Proposer retains ownership of pre-existing and generally reusable methodologies, tools and components?	A perpetual, royalty-free license to deliverables while the Proposer retains ownership of pre-existing and generally reusable methodologies, tools, and components may be discussed. It is not the intention of TTUHSC to make claim to pre-existing intellectual property. Please note Section 7 - General Terms and Conditions; if a Proposer takes exception to any Required Term, the Proposer should submit a list of the exceptions as part of its proposal.
420. Approximately how many employees/users will participate in workforce enablement and training activities?	Total number of employees: about 6,000. Abilene: ~100; Amarillo: ~700; Dallas: ~90; Lubbock: ~3,710; Permian Basin: ~600; Strategic Initiatives (Correctional Managed Care): ~800.

	- Functional domains (some groups overlap): Clinical: ~2,000; Academic: ~2,000; Research: ~1,300; Other (Admin, Operational, Supporting): ~2,000. Number of leaders: around 150-200. - The initial rollout will target about 3,000 individuals.
421. How many role-based learning tracks are expected, and which functions/roles should be covered?	- The number and structure of role-based learning tracks may be proposed by the Contractor based on the assessment, covering functions such as procurement, finance, clinical administration, and academic operations (illustrative, not exhaustive). - Total number of employees: about 6,000. Abilene: ~100; Amarillo: ~700; Dallas: ~90; Lubbock: ~3,710; Permian Basin: ~600; Strategic Initiatives (Correctional Managed Care): ~800. - Functional domains (some groups overlap): Clinical: ~2,000; Academic: ~2,000; Research: ~1,300; Other (Admin, Operational, Supporting): ~2,000. Number of leaders: around 150-200. - The initial rollout will target about 3,000 individuals.
422. What proportion of training delivery is expected to be on-site versus virtual, and at which of the five campuses?	TTUHSC expects some on-site presence but does not have strict requirements for delivery frequency or duration. A predominantly virtual/hybrid model is acceptable, with on-site presence concentrated at defined milestones such as executive alignment sessions and leadership workshops. The initial kickoff is preferred on all campuses (negotiable), and the leadership enablement meeting is preferred on-site in Lubbock, TX. Overall, a hybrid model is preferred. Travel is to be included in the fee. The Proposer may state its on-site training assumptions across the five campuses.
423. What level of organizational change management is expected from the selected vendor, including communications, change champions and train-the-trainer activities?	The Contractor is expected to support organizational change management, including communications, change champions, and train-the-trainer activities. TTUHSC has a President's Cabinet and utilizes a Council structure that can be leveraged as initial change champions (about 150-200 individuals). The number and structure of champions may be proposed by the Contractor based on the assessment.
424. How many leadership participants (VPs, Deans, Department Heads, People Managers) are anticipated for the Deliverable 2 workshops, and across which campuses?	There are around 150-200 leaders; the Contractor may propose the participant set (VPs, Deans, Department Heads, People Managers) based on role and organizational level, across the five campuses. Leadership enablement is preferred on-site in Lubbock.
425. Does TTUHSC expect the vendor to develop the training content and curriculum from scratch, or will existing TTUHSC learning content/resources be provided?	The Vendor is expected to develop the training content and curriculum from scratch. TTUHSC will help identify target roles and provide sanitized use-case data to support the applied learning component, based on need. TTUHSC has an LMS.
426. Is the expectation that the vendor will establish a sustainable internal AI enablement capability that TTUHSC can operate after the engagement ends?	Yes. The expectation is to establish a sustainable internal AI enablement capability that TTUHSC can operate after the engagement ends; TTUHSC plans to operate and maintain deliverables internally, and the Contractor should design for internal handover.
427. What existing data sources and systems will be available to measure AI usage, workforce capability, productivity and financial outcomes?	Access to telemetry data will be provided to the Contractor if needed. Available data sources and systems to measure AI usage, workforce capability, productivity, and financial outcomes will be provided based on need; the LMS is available for training-completion data.
428. Does TTUHSC already have established baselines for productivity, cost, utilization and workforce skills against which AI ROI should be measured?	- Baseline metrics have not been established. TTUHSC conducted some AI baseline surveys in 2025 and 2026, but the Contractor is expected to bring a method for measuring the baseline and, later, the ROI. - Established baselines for productivity, cost, utilization, and workforce skills do not exist today; the Contractor is expected to help establish them.
429. For the three required client references, can TTUHSC confirm whether references may collectively demonstrate the required capabilities across AI strategy, enterprise adoption, workforce enablement and AI implementation?	The intention is to request three separate reference clients. References are at the discretion of the Proposer and may be from any sector that compares favorably to the services requested within this RFP; a preference exists for higher education or healthcare organizations. References may collectively demonstrate the required capabilities across AI strategy, enterprise adoption, workforce enablement, and AI implementation; a single reference need not match the full breadth.

430. Can experience delivered through an approved subcontractor or strategic partner be considered as part of the overall technical response and experience assessment?	Yes. Experience delivered through an approved subcontractor or strategic partner may be considered as part of the overall technical response and experience assessment.
431. How will the qualifications and experience of proposed key personnel be evaluated as part of the technical scoring?	Evaluation is based on the criteria in Section 4.3.2 (Service Specifications 55%, Experience and Reputation 15%, Pricing 30%). The qualifications and experience of proposed key personnel are considered within the Service Specifications and Experience and Reputation criteria; TTUHSC has not published sub-weights.
432. Are there specific categories of work that TTUHSC expects to be subcontracted to Texas HUB/VetHUB businesses?	No specific categories of work are mandated for VetHUB subcontracting; a self-performing plan is responsive. Where subcontracting occurs, Proposers may propose the categories (e.g., specialized deliverables) consistent with NIGP 91878.
433. Can HUB/VetHUB subcontractors provide services such as change management, workforce training, healthcare advisory or project support under the HSP?	Yes. VetHUB subcontractors may provide services such as change management, workforce training, healthcare advisory, or project support under the subcontracting plan, consistent with the RFP scope.
434. Can the experience and qualifications of proposed HUB/VetHUB subcontractors be considered in the evaluation of the overall proposal?	Yes. The experience and qualifications of proposed VetHUB subcontractors may be considered in the evaluation of the overall proposal, consistent with the Experience and Reputation criteria.
435. Is there an estimated budget range or anticipated annual spend for this engagement?	The cost shall not exceed \$750, 000.
436. Can deliverables be invoiced against defined milestones, or only upon final acceptance of each deliverable?	- Payment is per deliverable upon completion and acceptance. For deliverables spanning multiple months, milestone-based partial invoicing may be discussed with the Contractor. - Deliverable acceptance is by the Chief AI Transformation Officer, the AI Steering Committee, and the President, and will depend on TTUHSC review cycles.
437. How will scope changes be handled where actual volumes of users, workflows, use cases or prototypes exceed the assumptions included in the proposal?	- Costing for any solution offered is at the discretion of the Proposer. Cost breakdown within a deliverable line or a separate cost line is not a differentiator for TTUHSC reviewers. Please ensure costing is clear and discernable to the evaluating reader. Any modifications to price would be handled through a change-order process. - In-scope adjustments versus billable changes will be agreed with TTUHSC and handled through the change-order process.
438. Given evaluation runs through November 30, 2026 and the agreement expires August 31, 2027, does TTUHSC anticipate all six deliverables completing within that term, or is renewal/extension contemplated?	- TTUHSC is seeking completion of all deliverables within the term and will work collaboratively in constructing a contract term that accommodates that position. - The following proposed Project Schedule may change based on RFP progress: - Kick-off meeting: February 2027; - Deliverable 1: April 2027; - Deliverable 2: April 2027; - Deliverable 3: September 2027; - Deliverable 4: September 2027; - Deliverable 5: December 2027; - Deliverable 6: February 2028. - TTUHSC is seeking completion of all deliverables and will work collaboratively in constructing a contract term that accommodates that position.
439. Does TTUHSC anticipate additional implementation, managed services or follow-on phases after completion of the initial six deliverables?	TTUHSC's current intent is completion of the six deliverables within the awarded term. TTUHSC has not committed to follow-on phases; any additional work would be handled per the Agreement and applicable procurement rules.
440. Can TTUHSC clarify which Texas public higher-education institutions are eligible to utilize the resulting contract, and whether they may procure the full range of services under the agreement?	Under the Group Purchasing Authority referenced in the RFP, other eligible Texas public institutions of higher education may utilize the resulting contract. Any such use would be subject to a separate agreement or statement of work between the Contractor and that institution.
441. If other eligible institutions utilize the contract, will additional statements of work require separate competition, or can institutions directly issue work under the awarded contract?	Utilization by other eligible institutions would be effected through a separate agreement or statement of work with that institution, consistent with applicable procurement requirements.

442. Does TTUHSC intend to award a single contract for the full scope, or does it anticipate multiple awards for portions of the requirements under Section 4.8.1 and we can submit one of the portion addressing any of the deliverable	- It is TTUHSC's intention to issue a single award; however, in accordance with the terms of the RFP, TTUHSC reserves the right to award an agreement for all or any portion of the requirements, to award multiple agreements, or to reject any and all proposals if deemed to be in the best interests of TTUHSC. - A Proposer may submit on any portion of the requirements.
443. Are there incumbent vendors currently providing any portion of these services to TTUHSC?	- There is no incumbent vendor engaged to provide these consulting services. - Microsoft Copilot is currently the enterprise generative AI tool that has been deployed. Other GenAI tools are being evaluated. Examples of other tools provided enterprise-wide include Zoom AI Companion, Epic, Grammarly, etc.
444. Which cloud provider(s) does TTUHSC currently use (Azure/AWS/GCP), and is the Deliverable 5 analytics solution expected to be hosted there or in a vendor-managed environment?	TTUHSC operates within a Microsoft enterprise environment. Either a solution built inside TTUHSC's environment or a vendor-managed environment is acceptable, with no preference. Power BI is available for Deliverable 5.
445. Are dev, test/staging, and production environments already provisioned, or will Proposer need to help establish them?	TTUHSC will not provide a dedicated sandbox, private tenant, or hosted environment for prototype development unless otherwise specified in the solicitation or subsequent contract documents. Proposers should assume responsibility for providing and managing any environments required to develop, host, demonstrate, and test proposed AI solutions. Any vendor-hosted environment used to store, process, or transmit TTUHSC data must comply with the security, privacy, and regulatory requirements defined in the RFP, including any applicable State of Texas and TTUHSC requirements.
446. What is TTUHSC's current network/VPN or private-connectivity setup for third-party vendor access?	Network/VPN and third-party access details will be provided to the selected Contractor and coordinated with TTUHSC IT at kickoff. Vendor access requirements will be addressed at onboarding.
447. Is there an existing data lake, warehouse, or lakehouse platform (e.g., Snowflake, Databricks, Synapse) that Deliverable 5 analytics should build on, or is this greenfield?	TTUHSC operates within a Microsoft enterprise environment. Power BI is available. The specific data platform will be discussed with the selected Contractor; either building on existing tooling or a proposed approach is acceptable, with no preference.
448. What is the expected data volume/velocity (transactions, records, users) the analytics platform must handle at steady state?	Approximately 6,000 employees are in scope. The initial rollout will target about 3,000 individuals. Specific volume/velocity for the analytics solution will be refined with the Contractor; the Proposer may state its assumptions.
449. Are there existing CI/CD pipelines and DevOps tooling in place, or will Proposer need to set these up as part of delivery?	TTUHSC has not specified a required CI/CD or DevOps toolchain for this solicitation. Proposers should describe their recommended development, deployment, source control, release management, testing, and DevOps approach as part of their proposed solution
450. Which LLM providers/models are currently approved (Azure OpenAI, AWS Bedrock, Anthropic, Google, open-source/self-hosted)? Is Proposer free to propose its own stack?	- Microsoft Copilot is currently the enterprise generative AI tool that has been deployed. Other GenAI tools are being evaluated. Examples of other tools provided enterprise-wide include Zoom AI Companion, Epic, Grammarly, etc. - The Proposer is free to propose its own stack, provided the solution meets the RFP requirements. Costing is at the Proposer's discretion.
451. Is there an existing enterprise LLM gateway, prompt-management layer, or AI governance tooling already in place?	- TTUHSC has some governance structure already in place and seeks to align with both the NIST AI Risk Management Framework and the Texas DIR framework. TTUHSC has a responsible AI use policy (OP 52.21) and maintains an active AI tool inventory. - A dedicated enterprise LLM gateway/prompt-management layer is expected to be recommended and, where appropriate, developed by the Contractor.
452. Does TTUHSC have a preference or requirement for open-source/self-hosted models over commercial APIs, for cost or data-sovereignty reasons?	TTUHSC does not have a preference; the Proposer may recommend the approach that best meets the requirements. Any solution must comply with the security and data-privacy requirements, including that institutional data not be used to train, fine-tune, or improve vendor, public, or third-party models.
453. What are the current usage limits, rate limits, or contractual caps on the existing LLM tooling that Proposer's solutions would need to operate within?	- Microsoft Copilot is currently the enterprise generative AI tool that has been deployed. Other GenAI tools are being evaluated. Examples of other tools provided enterprise-wide include Zoom AI Companion, Epic, Grammarly, etc. - Access to telemetry data will be provided to the Contractor if needed. Applicable usage/limit details will be provided to the selected Contractor as needed.
454. What agent orchestration framework, if any, does TTUHSC expect (e.g., a specific framework, or open to contractor's recommendation)?	TTUHSC does not mandate a specific framework. The preference is for the Contractor to design and recommend the agentic AI architecture, governance framework, controls, and selected prototype use cases.

455. Are there existing responsible-AI or model-risk evaluation processes (bias testing, hallucination monitoring, red-teaming) that new prototypes must pass before deployment?	- TTUHSC has some governance structure already in place and seeks to align with both the NIST AI Risk Management Framework and the Texas DIR framework. TTUHSC has a responsible AI use policy (OP 52.21) and maintains an active AI tool inventory. - Development and formalization of responsible-AI evaluation processes (e.g., bias testing, hallucination monitoring, red-teaming) is within scope for the Contractor to establish or further develop.
456. Which core enterprise systems are in scope for integration - EHR (Epic/Cerner), ERP, HRIS (Workday), LMS (Canvas/Blackboard), ITSM/ticketing?	- In-scope systems will be prioritized with the Contractor based on the current-state assessment. - Microsoft Copilot is currently the enterprise generative AI tool that has been deployed. Other GenAI tools are being evaluated. Examples of other tools provided enterprise-wide include Zoom AI Companion, Epic, Grammarly, etc.
457. Are APIs available and documented for these systems, or would contractor need to build custom connectors/RPA-style integration?	This will be determined during discovery with the Contractor. Access to and documentation for in-scope systems will be provided based on need.
458. Is there an existing integration/iPaaS layer (MuleSoft, Boomi, Azure Logic Apps) that new automations should route through?	TTUHSC operates within a Microsoft enterprise environment. Any existing integration layer will be confirmed with the selected Contractor; the Proposer may state its assumptions.
459. What authentication/authorization standard applies for service-to-service integration (OAuth2 client credentials, API keys, mTLS)?	SSO via SAML 2.0/OAuth2 is required per Section 5.4.F.3, within TTUHSC's Microsoft enterprise environment. Specific service-to-service authentication standards will be provided to the selected Contractor at kickoff.
460. Are there rate limits, throttling, or change-freeze windows on core systems (especially EHR) that automation workflows must respect?	Any such constraints, particularly for clinical systems, will be identified with the Contractor during discovery and must be respected; TTUHSC will coordinate access.
461. Is there a sandbox or non-production instance of key systems (especially clinical/EHR systems) available for prototype development and testing?	- TTUHSC will not provide a dedicated sandbox, private tenant, or hosted environment for prototype development unless otherwise specified in the solicitation or subsequent contract documents. Proposers should assume responsibility for providing and managing any environments required to develop, host, demonstrate, and test proposed AI solutions. Any vendor-hosted environment used to store, process, or transmit TTUHSC data must comply with the security, privacy, and regulatory requirements defined in the RFP, including any applicable State of Texas and TTUHSC requirements. - Access to non-production instances, if needed, will be discussed based on need.
462. What level of human-in-the-loop (HITL) control is required for agentic workflows - approval gates, audit logs, kill-switches?	The preference is for the Contractor to develop the human-in-the-loop framework, including approval gates, audit logging, and controls, as part of the agentic AI architecture and governance. Data-mutating and higher-risk actions are expected to require human approval.
463. Is there a requirement for agent action logging/traceability sufficient for compliance/audit purposes (every agent decision explainable and reproducible)?	Yes. Agent action logging and traceability sufficient for compliance/audit purposes is expected and is within scope for the Contractor to design as part of the governance framework.
464. What latency/performance expectations exist for automated workflows (real-time vs. batch/async acceptable)?	At the Proposer's discretion to propose based on the use case; both real-time and batch/async approaches may be appropriate. Requirements will be refined with the Contractor.
465. Are there existing RPA tools already deployed (UiPath, Power Automate) that new agentic solutions should coexist with or replace?	TTUHSC operates within a Microsoft enterprise environment. New solutions should coexist with existing tooling where appropriate; the Proposer may state its assumptions.
466. What existing telemetry/usage data is already being captured from current AI tool deployments (logs, API call data, user activity)?	Access to telemetry data will be provided to the Contractor if needed.
467. Is there an existing BI/reporting tool (Power BI, Tableau, Looker) that the adoption/ROI dashboard should be built in or integrate with, or is a standalone platform expected?	Either route is acceptable, with no preference here. Power BI is available.
468. What data retention policy applies to usage/telemetry data, and does this differ for PHI-adjacent vs. non-PHI data?	TTUHSC's data retention policies will be provided to the selected Contractor. PHI is not expected to be made available; if any PHI-adjacent data is involved, additional handling requirements (including the BAA) would apply. The US-only restriction applies to PHI only.

469. Is real-time/near-real-time dashboarding required, or is periodic (weekly/monthly) reporting sufficient?	At the Proposer's discretion to propose; periodic (e.g., weekly/monthly) reporting is acceptable and near-real-time is not required unless proposed. No preference.
470. Is Section 508/ADA digital accessibility compliance required for training content, dashboards, and prototype UIs?	Yes. As a Texas state institution, TTUHSC requires electronic and information resources - including training content, dashboards, and prototype UIs - to conform to applicable accessibility standards (Section 508 / WCAG and applicable Texas Administrative Code accessibility requirements).
471. What specific encryption standards are mandated beyond 'TLS 1.3 / AES-256' already stated - e.g., key management, HSM requirements?	Beyond TLS 1.3 / AES-256, standard TTUHSC enterprise security controls apply. Specific key-management/HSM requirements will be provided to the selected Contractor and coordinated with TTUHSC IT security.
472. Is single sign-on (SSO) via TTUHSC's existing identity provider (e.g., Azure AD/Entra ID, Okta) mandatory for any new tools/dashboards deployed?	Yes. SSO via TTUHSC's enterprise identity provider (Microsoft environment) using SAML 2.0/OAuth2 is required for applicable new tools and dashboards. Specific IdP configuration will be provided at kickoff.
473. What penetration testing or vulnerability scanning requirements apply before go-live, and who bears the cost - contractor or TTUHSC's own security team?	The selected Contractor will be expected to adhere to all applicable TTUHSC security requirements, including vulnerability management and security testing requirements appropriate to the proposed solution and associated risk level. TTUHSC reserves the right to conduct, commission, review, or validate independent security assessments of proposed solutions as part of its security and compliance review processes. Any allocation of responsibilities and costs for security assessments, penetration testing, vulnerability scanning, remediation activities, or independent validation efforts will be finalized during contract negotiations and project planning.
474. Are there specific logging/SIEM integration requirements (e.g., must feed into TTUHSC's existing security monitoring)?	Where applicable, security logs and telemetry are expected to integrate with TTUHSC's existing security monitoring; specifics will be provided to the selected Contractor.
475. What UAT process and technical acceptance criteria will apply to prototypes and the analytics platform before sign-off?	- Deliverable acceptance is by the Chief AI Transformation Officer, the AI Steering Committee, and the President, and will depend on TTUHSC review cycles. - Formal acceptance criteria and a work plan are required per Section 5.3.2; specific UAT/technical acceptance criteria will be agreed with the Contractor.
476. Is a formal performance/load testing requirement expected before production deployment of any solution?	At the Proposer's discretion to propose based on the solution; requirements will be confirmed with the Contractor prior to any production deployment.
477. What format is source code, prompts, and technical documentation expected to be delivered in - TTUHSC's own repository (GitHub/Azure DevOps), or contractor's choice with export at the end?	- It is not the intention of TTUHSC to make claim to pre-existing intellectual property. Please note Section 7 - General Terms and Conditions; if a Proposer takes exception to any Required Term, the Proposer should submit a list of the exceptions as part of its proposal. - Source code, prompts, and documentation should be delivered in an editable, exportable format and, where applicable, within TTUHSC's environment. Specific repository details will be provided at kickoff.
478. What is the expected support/warranty period after go-live for any deployed technical solution, and does it fall inside or outside the fixed fee?	Deployed solutions should be pilot-ready or fully production-ready; associated support costs should not be included in the fixed fee but may be listed as an optional item for TTUHSC to consider. The support/warranty period may be proposed by the Proposer.
479. Who owns break-fix and ongoing maintenance support after the contract term ends on August 31, 2027?	TTUHSC plans to operate and maintain deliverables internally after the contract term. Ongoing maintenance/support is at TTUHSC's discretion and may be proposed as an optional item.
480. What is TTUHSC's expected cadence and format for technical design reviews or architecture sign-offs during the engagement?	Cadence and format for design reviews and architecture sign-offs will be agreed with the Contractor; acceptance is tied to TTUHSC review cycles and the AI Steering Committee.
481. Is there a preferred or mandated project/engineering tooling stack (Jira, Azure DevOps, Confluence) that contractor must use for this engagement?	TTUHSC operates within a Microsoft enterprise environment. No specific project tooling is mandated; the tooling approach is at the Proposer's discretion, coordinated with TTUHSC. Any required tooling details will be provided at kickoff.
482. Are TTUHSC technical staff (engineers, DBAs, security team) expected to be embedded/co-staffed on the project, or is contractor expected to deliver independently with periodic check-ins?	TTUHSC executive sponsor, IT/security, and functional SMEs will be involved at levels appropriate to each deliverable. The Contractor is expected to deliver with collaborative TTUHSC participation rather than full co-staffing.
483. Is there a preference for local vendors?	No.

484. What is the annual budget allocated for this RFP?	The cost shall not exceed \$750,000.
485. Work will be onsite or remote?	Both
486. Can vendor provide entire services from offshore location (outside US geography)	No.
487. Who are previous incumbents on this project?	None.
488. What is the total budget for this contract?	The cost shall not exceed \$750,000.
489. Is this a single-vendor or multi-vendor award?	It is TTUHSC's intention to issue a single award; however, in accordance with the terms of the RFP, TTUHSC reserves the right to award an agreement for all or any portion of the requirements, to award multiple agreements, or to reject any and all proposals if deemed to be in the best interests of TTUHSC.
490. Appendix C / Section 3.2: If a Prime Contractor provides the majority of professional services directly and utilizes a certified Texas HUB subcontractor for specialized deliverables, does TTUHSC prefer specific NIGP codes for the HUB portion, or is meeting the HUB utilization expectations under NIGP 91878 sufficient?	Meeting the VetHUB utilization expectations under NIGP 91878 is sufficient; TTUHSC does not require specific additional NIGP codes for the HUB portion. A self-performing VetHUB Subcontracting Plan is responsive.
491. Appendix C: Will TTUHSC accept joint-venture or teaming arrangements where a certified Texas HUB/VetHUB partner acts as the Prime Contractor supported by a non-HUB technical delivery subcontractor?	Yes. Joint-venture or teaming arrangements are acceptable, including a certified Texas VetHUB prime supported by a non-HUB technical delivery subcontractor. Any delegation would be documented in the award agreement.
492. Section 5.4 - Deliverable 3: How many total campuses, clinical sites, and estimated workforce members (faculty, staff, clinical personnel) are in-scope for the workforce upskilling rollout?	- Total number of employees: about 6,000. - Abilene: ~100; Amarillo: ~700; Dallas: ~90; Lubbock: ~3,710; Permian Basin: ~600; Strategic Initiatives (Correctional Managed Care): ~800. - Functional domains (some groups overlap): Clinical: ~2,000; Academic: ~2,000; Research: ~1,300; Other (Admin, Operational, Supporting): ~2,000. - Number of leaders: around 150-200. - The initial rollout will target about 3,000 individuals.
493. Section 5.4 - Deliverable 2: For leadership activation and change management, does TTUHSC anticipate these workshops to be delivered primarily on-site across campuses, or via a hybrid/remote model?	TTUHSC expects some on-site presence but does not have strict requirements for delivery frequency or duration. A predominantly virtual/hybrid model is acceptable, with on-site presence concentrated at defined milestones such as executive alignment sessions and leadership workshops. The initial kickoff is preferred on all campuses (negotiable), and the leadership enablement meeting is preferred on-site in Lubbock, TX. Overall, a hybrid model is preferred.
494. Section 5.4 - Deliverable 4: Does TTUHSC currently maintain pre-approved foundation model licenses or cloud infrastructure (e.g., Azure OpenAI, AWS Bedrock, Google Vertex AI), or should the vendor include platform orchestration licensing in its proposal?	- Microsoft Copilot is currently the enterprise generative AI tool that has been deployed. Other GenAI tools are being evaluated. Examples of other tools provided enterprise-wide include Zoom AI Companion, Epic, Grammarly, etc. - Any platform orchestration licensing the Proposer deems necessary is at the Proposer's discretion to include.
495. Section 5.4 - Technical Requirements: Regarding TX-RAMP certification, is TX-RAMP Level 1 or Level 2 required if a vendor-provided orchestration platform handles non-PHI operational data?	Under Texas Government Code Sec. 2054.0593 and Texas Department of Information Resources guidelines, TX-RAMP applies specifically to Cloud Service Providers offering hosted cloud computing services (SaaS, PaaS, IaaS). Where the solution is delivered as a professional/managed service operating inside TTUHSC's approved enterprise environment, using TTUHSC's certified infrastructure and tooling, with no contractor-hosted cloud service and no institutional data leaving TTUHSC-controlled systems, TX-RAMP would likely not apply. Where a proposal includes a hosted cloud service, TX-RAMP would apply.

	Where TX-RAMP applies, the level is determined by the data classification handled - generally Level 1 for non-PHI operational data, and Level 2 for confidential/regulated data. Advisory, on-premises, or managed-service delivery inside TTUHSC's environment would generally fall outside TX-RAMP scope.
496. Section 5.4 - Deliverable 5: Does TTUHSC have an existing analytics dashboard standard (e.g., Power BI, Tableau) for tracking AI usage and ROI metrics, or should vendors propose a standalone analytics module?	Either route is acceptable, with no preference here. Power BI is available.
497. Section 5.5 / Pricing: Can TTUHSC clarify whether the deliverable milestone payments (Deliverables 1–6) are expected to execute sequentially or as overlapping concurrent workstreams through August 31, 2027?	- Deliverables may proceed as overlapping/concurrent workstreams; payment is per deliverable upon completion and acceptance. - The following proposed Project Schedule may change based on RFP progress: - Kick-off meeting: February 2027; - Deliverable 1: April 2027; - Deliverable 2: April 2027; - Deliverable 3: September 2027; - Deliverable 4: September 2027; - Deliverable 5: December 2027; - Deliverable 6: February 2028. - TTUHSC is seeking completion of all deliverables and will work collaboratively in constructing a contract term that accommodates that position.
498. Can TTUHSC confirm which categories of work (e.g., non-clinical governance frameworks, general training curricula) may use offshore delivery resources, versus which must remain U.S. only due to PHI restrictions and should this be defined upfront or requested case-by-case after award?	- The preference is to have everything located inside the US. Offshore participation may be permitted for work that does not involve institutional data, but this requires further discussion with the Contractor; if PHI is involved, PHI must not be stored offshore. - The categories eligible for offshore delivery, if any, will be discussed with the Contractor and may be handled at award rather than fixed upfront.
499. Is there a preferred format for presenting the required references, and is there a defined limit on how far back "recent" extends?	- The intention is to request three separate reference clients. References are at the discretion of the Proposer and may be from any sector that compares favorably to the services requested within this RFP; a preference exists for higher education or healthcare organizations. - There is no prescribed format and no specific look-back limit for 'recent'; please ensure references are clear and discernable to the evaluating reader.
500. Would TTUHSC accept multiple references that each address different components of the scope (governance, training, change management, automation, analytics), or is a single reference expected to match the full breadth of the engagement?	- The intention is to request three separate reference clients. References are at the discretion of the Proposer and may be from any sector that compares favorably to the services requested within this RFP; a preference exists for higher education or healthcare organizations. - Multiple references that together address different components of the scope are acceptable; a single reference need not match the full breadth of the engagement.
501. Under what circumstances would TX-RAMP certification be required — only if Proposer offers a cloud-hosted platform, or more broadly for any cloud tools used during delivery?	Under Texas Government Code Sec. 2054.0593 and Texas Department of Information Resources guidelines, TX-RAMP applies specifically to Cloud Service Providers offering hosted cloud computing services (SaaS, PaaS, IaaS). Where the solution is delivered as a professional/managed service operating inside TTUHSC's approved enterprise environment, using TTUHSC's certified infrastructure and tooling, with no contractor-hosted cloud service and no institutional data leaving TTUHSC-controlled systems, TX-RAMP would likely not apply. Where a proposal includes a hosted cloud service, TX-RAMP would apply.
502. The RFP requires at least three references with names, contact information, and descriptions of similar services. Will TTUHSC accept references from projects involving comparable enterprise AI strategy, AI implementation, workflow automation, analytics, or workforce enablement, even if the client was not a higher-education institution?	The intention is to request three separate reference clients. References are at the discretion of the Proposer and may be from any sector that compares favorably to the services requested within this RFP; a preference exists for higher education or healthcare organizations.
503. Has TTUHSC established an estimated budget, funding range, or not-to-exceed amount for this engagement that can be shared with prospective proposers?	The cost shall not exceed \$750,000.

504. Does TTUHSC permit offshore personnel to perform remote portions of the work, and if so, what restrictions apply to their access to TTUHSC systems and data?	The preference is to have everything located inside the US. Offshore participation may be permitted for work that does not involve institutional data, but this requires further discussion with the Contractor; if PHI is involved, PHI must not be stored offshore.
505. What specific enterprise AI tools, LLMs, embedded AI assistants, platforms, and existing AI capabilities has TTUHSC already deployed, and which platforms are expected to be supported under this engagement?	- Microsoft Copilot is currently the enterprise generative AI tool that has been deployed. Other GenAI tools are being evaluated. Examples of other tools provided enterprise-wide include Zoom AI Companion, Epic, Grammarly, etc. - Access to telemetry data will be provided to the Contractor if needed.
506. Pre-Existing Intellectual Property: Section 1.3 of the Consultant Services Agreement designates all writings, reports, and materials as "works made for hire" with exclusive ownership vesting in TTUHSC. Will TTUHSC consider a modification to exclude the Consultant's pre-existing intellectual property, proprietary methodologies, frameworks, and tools from the works-made-for-hire designation, with a perpetual, non-exclusive, royalty-free license granted to TTUHSC for such pre-existing IP as incorporated into the deliverables?	It is not the intention of TTUHSC to make claim to pre-existing intellectual property. Please note Section 7 - General Terms and Conditions; if a Proposer takes exception to any Required Term, the Proposer should submit a list of the exceptions as part of its proposal.
507. TX-RAMP Compliance: Section 5.2 requires TX-RAMP compliance "as may be required." Please confirm (a) whether TX-RAMP Level 1 or Level 2 certification is required for this engagement, and (b) whether a compliance timeline is acceptable at the time of proposal submission for Proposers that have not yet completed TX-RAMP authorization.	- Under Texas Government Code Sec. 2054.0593 and Texas Department of Information Resources guidelines, TX-RAMP applies specifically to Cloud Service Providers offering hosted cloud computing services (SaaS, PaaS, IaaS). Where the solution is delivered as a professional/managed service operating inside TTUHSC's approved enterprise environment, using TTUHSC's certified infrastructure and tooling, with no contractor-hosted cloud service and no institutional data leaving TTUHSC-controlled systems, TX-RAMP would likely not apply. Where a proposal includes a hosted cloud service, TX-RAMP would apply. - Where TX-RAMP applies, a compliance timeline may be discussed; TTUHSC does not require completed TX-RAMP authorization at proposal submission for components that are not hosted cloud services.
508. Data Sovereignty Scope: Section 1.53.11 of the Business Associate Agreement prohibits accessing, storing, or transmitting PHI outside the United States. Please confirm whether this restriction applies solely to data storage and transmission, or whether it also restricts the physical location of Consultant personnel providing services under the Agreement (e.g., U.S.-based employees working remotely while temporarily traveling abroad).	This restriction applies to all TTUHSC institutional data.
509. What change management methodology or framework do you currently use (e.g., Prosci/ADKAR, Kotter, or an internal model), if any?	TTUHSC does not mandate a specific change-management methodology; the Proposer may propose its approach (e.g., Prosci/ADKAR, Kotter, or an internal model).
510. Do you currently have dedicated, full-time internal OCM resources, or is change management handled as a part-time responsibility by project managers and HR?	This capability is being built; the Contractor is expected to support change management. TTUHSC has a President's Cabinet and utilizes a Council structure that can be leveraged as initial change champions.
511. What is the size, skill level, and current workload bandwidth of your internal OCM team if you have one?	TTUHSC does not have a dedicated full-time OCM team for this initiative; details will be shared with the selected Contractor. The President's Cabinet and Council structure can be leveraged.
512. Where do you see your biggest internal capability gaps for managing a complex change like Enterprise AI (e.g., leadership alignment, resistance management, strategy)?	Priorities are strategy and governance, change management, workforce upskilling, and adoption analytics and ROI measurement. Specific internal capability gaps will be assessed by the Contractor during the current-state assessment.
513. Do you have a dedicated internal L&D or training team, and what learning management systems (LMS) or platforms do you currently use?	- Yes, TTUHSC has an LMS. - The Vendor is expected to develop the training content and curriculum from scratch.
514. Does your training team have experience creating role-based curriculum for complex software or AI tools, or do they primarily deliver day-to-day employee training?	The Vendor needs to develop the training content and curriculum from scratch; internal training capacity will be assessed during discovery.

515. What capacity does your internal training team have to co-create, record, or facilitate AI training materials alongside an external vendor?	To be assessed with the Contractor. The Vendor is expected to develop content from scratch and may propose a train-the-trainer approach.
516. Do you have any success metrics (including business KPIs, adoption, ROI) defined?	- Baseline metrics have not been established. TTUHSC conducted some AI baseline surveys in 2025 and 2026, but the Contractor is expected to bring a method for measuring the baseline and, later, the ROI. - Priorities include business KPIs, adoption, and ROI; the Contractor is expected to define the measurement framework.
517. Have the business and technology sponsors been identified?	- The Chief AI Transformation Officer is the executive sponsor. TTUHSC has an AI Steering Committee which is the oversight body of the effort. - Business and technology sponsorship is provided through the Chief AI Transformation Officer and the AI Steering Committee.
518. The RFP states that TTUHSC has already "provisioned enterprise AI tools, including Large Language Models (LLMs) and embedded AI productivity assistants", Could you specify which exact enterprise AI platforms, LLM endpoints, or productivity assistants are currently provisioned (e.g., Microsoft Copilot/Azure OpenAI, AWS Bedrock, Google Gemini, OpenAI Enterprise)?	Microsoft Copilot is currently the enterprise generative AI tool that has been deployed. Other GenAI tools are being evaluated. Examples of other tools provided enterprise-wide include Zoom AI Companion, Epic, Grammarly, etc.
519. For Prioritization of Systems for Integration - Are there specific core transactional systems (such as the EHR/EMR for clinical administration, Banner for student/academic operations, or Banner Finance/HR) that are prioritized for custom AI API integrations and model orchestration, or should the proposed prototypes focus on standalone, department-specific AI applications? For bespoke application development and API integrations, what are the primary legacy systems (e.g., Banner for ERP, Epic/Cerner for EHR) the AI prototypes must connect to, and do robust, documented API gateways already exist for these platforms?	In-scope systems will be prioritized with the Contractor based on the current-state assessment. Prototypes are expected across Academic, Clinical, Research, and Admin functional areas (about 8-10 workflows). Documentation and API availability will be confirmed during discovery.
520. Does TTUHSC expect the contractor to provision and host the sandbox/development environments for use-case prototyping during the engagement, or will TTUHSC provide the contractor with isolated development tenants within its own enterprise cloud infrastructure (e.g., AWS, Azure, GCP)?	TTUHSC will not provide a dedicated sandbox, private tenant, or hosted environment for prototype development unless otherwise specified in the solicitation or subsequent contract documents. Proposers should assume responsibility for providing and managing any environments required to develop, host, demonstrate, and test proposed AI solutions. Any vendor-hosted environment used to store, process, or transmit TTUHSC data must comply with the security, privacy, and regulatory requirements defined in the RFP, including any applicable State of Texas and TTUHSC requirements.
521. Does TTUHSC currently utilize any specific agent orchestration frameworks (e.g., LangChain, AutoGen, Semantic Kernel), or does the institution expect the contractor to design and recommend a brand-new technical architecture for deploying and governing agentic AI?	TTUHSC does not mandate a framework. The preference is for the Contractor to design and recommend the agentic AI architecture and governance.
522. Does TTUHSC have an existing operational group or IT governance board designated to manage human-in-the-loop approvals, or is the contractor expected to design the human validation workflows and audit-logging policies entirely from scratch?	- The Chief AI Transformation Officer is the executive sponsor. TTUHSC has an AI Steering Committee which is the oversight body of the effort. - The Contractor is expected to design the human-in-the-loop validation workflows and audit-logging policies; the AI Steering Committee provides oversight.
523. To support "Adoption & Engagement Analytics", does TTUHSC's IT department have direct API access to user activity logs, prompt histories, and system telemetry from your provisioned AI vendors, or will the contractor need to build custom ingestion connectors to aggregate this data?	- Access to telemetry data will be provided to the Contractor if needed. - Where direct access is unavailable, the Contractor should assume it may need to build ingestion connectors.
524. For the Analytics & ROI Reporting Dashboard/Service - Does TTUHSC prefer that this dashboard be built natively within the institution's existing BI platforms? If yes, can TTUHSC provide details about the platform?	Either route is acceptable, with no preference here. Power BI is available.

525. The RFP lists compliance with the Texas Risk and Authorization Management Program (TX-RAMP) as a minimum requirement - If the contractor proposes a software platform or SaaS component to support adoption analytics or custom workflow applications, what specific TX-RAMP certification level (Level 1, Level 2, or provisional status) is required for the platform at the time of proposal submission versus at the time of project kickoff?	- Under Texas Government Code Sec. 2054.0593 and Texas Department of Information Resources guidelines, TX-RAMP applies specifically to Cloud Service Providers offering hosted cloud computing services (SaaS, PaaS, IaaS). Where the solution is delivered as a professional/managed service operating inside TTUHSC's approved enterprise environment, using TTUHSC's certified infrastructure and tooling, with no contractor-hosted cloud service and no institutional data leaving TTUHSC-controlled systems, TX-RAMP would likely not apply. Where a proposal includes a hosted cloud service, TX-RAMP would apply. - Where TX-RAMP applies to a proposed hosted component, a provisional/in-process designation may be acceptable at proposal submission, with full certification prior to production deployment.
526. What is TTUHSC's primary enterprise identity provider (IdP) for Single Sign-On (SSO) integration (e.g., Entra ID/Active Directory, Okta, Ping Identity) to support the required SAML 2.0 / OAuth2 authentication and Role-Based Access Controls (RBAC)?	TTUHSC operates within a Microsoft enterprise environment. SSO is via TTUHSC's enterprise identity provider using SAML 2.0/OAuth2. Specific IdP configuration will be provided to the selected Contractor at kickoff.
527. To ensure strict adherence to HIPAA and FERPA, will TTUHSC provide de-identified/synthetic datasets and dedicated HIPAA-compliant testing environments for validating Deliverable 4 custom prototypes?	- TTUHSC will not provide a dedicated sandbox, private tenant, or hosted environment for prototype development unless otherwise specified in the solicitation or subsequent contract documents. Proposers should assume responsibility for providing and managing any environments required to develop, host, demonstrate, and test proposed AI solutions. Any vendor-hosted environment used to store, process, or transmit TTUHSC data must comply with the security, privacy, and regulatory requirements defined in the RFP, including any applicable State of Texas and TTUHSC requirements. - PHI is not expected to be made available; TTUHSC has test patient data that may be used. Data will be provided based on need.
528. Are there any Geographic Data Residency Constraints?	The US-only restriction applies to all TTUHSC institutional data; the general preference is that data and work remain within the US.
529. What AI governance policies, standards, decision rights, or approval processes does TTUHSC already have in place? Which areas would TTUHSC expect the Contractor to build or further develop?	- TTUHSC has some governance structure already in place and seeks to align with both the NIST AI Risk Management Framework and the Texas DIR framework. TTUHSC has a responsible AI use policy (OP 52.21) and maintains an active AI tool inventory. - TTUHSC expects the Contractor to further develop the governance framework, including areas not yet formalized.
530. Does TTUHSC already have an AI strategy, prioritized list of AI use cases, or criteria for deciding which AI opportunities to pursue? If so, can TTUHSC share what has been developed to date?	No formal maturity assessment exists. TTUHSC conducted some AI baseline surveys in 2025 and 2026 and maintains an active AI tool inventory and a responsible AI use policy (OP 52.21). The Contractor is expected to help develop the strategy and prioritized use cases.
531. Approximately how many employees are expected to participate in AI training and coaching? Are there specific groups or roles that will need different levels or types of support?	- Total number of employees: about 6,000. - Abilene: ~100; Amarillo: ~700; Dallas: ~90; Lubbock: ~3,710; Permian Basin: ~600; Strategic Initiatives (Correctional Managed Care): ~800. - Functional domains (some groups overlap): Clinical: ~2,000; Academic: ~2,000; Research: ~1,300; Other (Admin, Operational, Supporting): ~2,000. - Number of leaders: around 150-200. - The initial rollout will target about 3,000 individuals.
532. What AI training, coaching, office hours, communities of practice, champions programs, or other enablement activities are currently available to employees? Who provides them today and how are they delivered?	Current enablement is limited and isolated; the Chief AI Transformation Officer coordinates the effort. The Contractor is expected to develop training, coaching, communities of practice, and champions programs. The President's Cabinet and Council structure can serve as initial champions.
533. How are AI use cases, employee questions, training needs, and requests for additional AI support handled today? Which teams or roles currently own these activities, and does TTUHSC expect the Contractor to help define a future-state ownership model?	These are currently handled in an ad hoc manner. Yes - TTUHSC expects the Contractor to help define a future-state ownership model. The Chief AI Transformation Officer and AI Steering Committee provide oversight.

534. How are access controls and permissions currently managed for querying these target systems?	TTUHSC operates within a Microsoft enterprise environment. Access controls are managed within TTUHSC's enterprise environment; specifics will be provided to the selected Contractor. PHI access is not expected.
535. Given HIPAA, FERPA, and TX-RAMP mandates, will TTUHSC provide pre-sanitized datasets, or must the contractor architect isolated sandbox environments for solution prototyping?	- TTUHSC will not provide a dedicated sandbox, private tenant, or hosted environment for prototype development unless otherwise specified in the solicitation or subsequent contract documents. Proposers should assume responsibility for providing and managing any environments required to develop, host, demonstrate, and test proposed AI solutions. Any vendor-hosted environment used to store, process, or transmit TTUHSC data must comply with the security, privacy, and regulatory requirements defined in the RFP, including any applicable State of Texas and TTUHSC requirements. - The Contractor may need to architect isolated environments for prototyping; TTUHSC has test patient data that may be used.
536. What is the target headcount for role-based upskilling across clinical, faculty, and administrative staff, and will training modules be hosted on TTUHSC's existing LMS?	- Total number of employees: about 6,000. - Abilene: ~100; Amarillo: ~700; Dallas: ~90; Lubbock: ~3,710; Permian Basin: ~600; Strategic Initiatives (Correctional Managed Care): ~800. - Functional domains (some groups overlap): Clinical: ~2,000; Academic: ~2,000; Research: ~1,300; Other (Admin, Operational, Supporting): ~2,000. - Number of leaders: around 150-200. - The initial rollout will target about 3,000 individuals. - Yes, TTUHSC has an LMS.
537. How many custom agentic AI workflows and bespoke application prototypes (Deliverable 4) does TTUHSC expect to engineer and deploy into production?	TTUHSC is planning to have at least two workflows/use cases from each functional area (Academic, Clinical, Research, and Admin) evaluated by the Contractor, for a total of about 8 to 10 workflows. Solutions should be either pilot-ready or fully production-ready; the associated cost should not be included in the fixed fee but may be listed as an optional item for TTUHSC to consider.
538. What existing institutional bodies (e.g., IT Governance, IRB) currently evaluate AI initiatives, and will the contractor establish and charter a dedicated Enterprise AI Governance Board?	- The Chief AI Transformation Officer is the executive sponsor. TTUHSC has an AI Steering Committee which is the oversight body of the effort. - TTUHSC has some governance structure already in place and seeks to align with both the NIST AI Risk Management Framework and the Texas DIR framework. TTUHSC has a responsible AI use policy (OP 52.21) and maintains an active AI tool inventory. - The Contractor may recommend chartering a dedicated Enterprise AI governance structure, building on the existing AI Steering Committee.
539. Are any clinical or patient-facing AI workflows in scope subject to FDA Software as a Medical Device (SaMD) regulations, or is the scope strictly administrative and operational?	The clinical scope may extend to clinical decision support, diagnostic, and patient-facing applications. Any solution must comply with applicable regulatory requirements; TTUHSC does not anticipate the initial deliverables producing regulated Software as a Medical Device, and clinical validation/oversight would apply before any production clinical deployment.
540. Is there an active peer champion network across regional campuses (Lubbock, Amarillo, Permian Basin, Abilene, Dallas/Fort Worth) to leverage for grassroots adoption?	TTUHSC has a President's Cabinet and Council structure that can be leveraged as the initial champions network across campuses; a dedicated network is expected to be developed by the Contractor.
541. Which specific foundation models and enterprise cloud platforms (e.g., Azure OpenAI, AWS Bedrock, Microsoft Copilot) are currently provisioned in TTUHSC's tenant?	Microsoft Copilot is currently the enterprise generative AI tool that has been deployed. Other GenAI tools are being evaluated. Examples of other tools provided enterprise-wide include Zoom AI Companion, Epic, Grammarly, etc.
542. For Deliverable 5, does TTUHSC prefer native integrations with existing BI platforms (e.g., Power BI, Tableau) or a vendor-managed SaaS telemetry platform?	Either route is acceptable, with no preference here. Power BI is available.
543. Section 1.3 defines deliverables as "works made for hire"; does TTUHSC carve out pre-existing vendor IP, proprietary frameworks, and reusable prompt libraries?	It is not the intention of TTUHSC to make claim to pre-existing intellectual property. Please note Section 7 - General Terms and Conditions; if a Proposer takes exception to any Required Term, the Proposer should submit a list of the exceptions as part of its proposal.

544. What percentage of consultant key personnel time is expected on-site across TTUHSC campuses versus remote execution?	TTUHSC expects some on-site presence but does not have strict requirements for delivery frequency or duration. A predominantly virtual/hybrid model is acceptable, with on-site presence concentrated at defined milestones such as executive alignment sessions and leadership workshops. The initial kickoff is preferred on all campuses (negotiable), and the leadership enablement meeting is preferred on-site in Lubbock, TX. Overall, a hybrid model is preferred.
545. Does TTUHSC anticipate using the Section 6 hourly rate card primarily for milestone scope changes or for ongoing staff augmentation roles?	The Section 6 hourly rate card is primarily for milestone/scope changes handled through a change-order process, not for ongoing staff augmentation.
546. What specific target percentage or participation requirement applies to the VetHUB Subcontracting Plan (Appendix C) for this engagement?	A self-performing VetHUB Subcontracting Plan indicating Proposer self-performance is responsive. VetHUB goals and the directory are maintained by the Texas Comptroller; see https://www.fiscal.ttuhsu.edu/purchasing/hub/findavendor.aspx. No specific participation percentage is mandated for this engagement.
547. For the executable Transformation Roadmap, what is TTUHSC's expected time horizon (e.g., 12, 18, or 36 months), and how will subsequent funding for the identified resource requirements be unlocked?	The roadmap should be executable within the awarded term while addressing a practical multi-year horizon. The Proposer may propose the horizon; TTUHSC will work collaboratively on sequencing and any subsequent funding for identified resource requirements.
548. How does TTUHSC currently quantify "risk tolerance" in operational versus clinical/academic contexts, and are there specific regulatory red lines (e.g., patient-facing AI) we should immediately exclude from the roadmap?	Risk tolerance will be assessed with TTUHSC during the current-state assessment. Patient-facing and clinical decision-support applications are in scope but subject to human-in-the-loop controls and clinical validation before any production deployment.
549. Which specific C-suite executives and academic leaders will comprise the core alignment group, and is there an existing consensus on the primary drivers for AI adoption (e.g., cost reduction, clinical throughput, research velocity)?	- The Chief AI Transformation Officer is the executive sponsor. TTUHSC has an AI Steering Committee which is the oversight body of the effort. - The core alignment group will be identified at kickoff and includes the Chief AI Transformation Officer, AI Steering Committee members, and academic/clinical leadership. Primary drivers will be confirmed during executive alignment.
550. To scope the data architecture assessment, is TTUHSC's data currently centralized in an enterprise data lake/warehouse, or are we assessing highly siloed departmental systems?	TTUHSC operates within a Microsoft enterprise environment. Power BI is available. The current state of data centralization will be assessed during discovery; the Proposer may state its assumptions.
551. Does IT currently have visibility into "shadow AI" usage across the enterprise, or will this assessment require enterprise-wide surveying to establish a baseline of current unmanaged AI tools?	TTUHSC maintains an active AI tool inventory. Establishing a fuller baseline of unmanaged AI usage is expected to be part of the Contractor's readiness assessment.
552. Are there existing cloud security and data classification frameworks that the AI policies must inherit from, or are we developing these data privacy and security definitions from scratch?	TTUHSC has enterprise security and data-classification practices and a responsible AI use policy (OP 52.21); AI policies should inherit from these where applicable, with the Contractor further developing them.
553. Will the AI Governance Framework be established as a net-new entity, or is the expectation to integrate AI gateways and algorithmic accountability into an existing IT Governance or Institutional Review Board (IRB) structure?	The expectation is to integrate AI governance and algorithmic accountability into TTUHSC's existing governance structures (e.g., the AI Steering Committee), building on OP 52.21, rather than create a wholly separate entity - though the Contractor may recommend enhancements.
554. Does TTUHSC expect the governance framework to include continuous auditing mechanisms for model drift and bias, or is the focus strictly on initial use-case approval and provisioning?	Yes. The governance framework is expected to include continuous auditing mechanisms (e.g., for model drift and bias), not only initial use-case approval.
555. For the findings-to-recommendations Traceability Matrix, does TTUHSC require this to be integrated into an existing enterprise architecture or portfolio management tool (e.g., ServiceNow), or is a standalone consulting artifact acceptable?	A standalone consulting artifact is acceptable; integration into an existing enterprise tool is not required. Format is at the Proposer's discretion.
556. How does TTUHSC currently define and measure "operational need" are there hard baseline metrics (e.g., hours logged, error rates) readily available, or will the contractor need to establish these baselines as part of the readiness assessment?	Baseline metrics have not been established. TTUHSC conducted some AI baseline surveys in 2025 and 2026, but the Contractor is expected to bring a method for measuring the baseline and, later, the ROI.
557. What is the estimated total learner population across TTUHSC, and what is the breakdown by functional cohort (e.g., Clinical Staff, Academic/Faculty, Research, Finance/Procurement, HR/Administration)?	- Total number of employees: about 6,000. - Abilene: ~100; Amarillo: ~700; Dallas: ~90; Lubbock: ~3,710; Permian Basin: ~600; Strategic Initiatives (Correctional Managed Care): ~800.

	- Functional domains (some groups overlap): Clinical: ~2,000; Academic: ~2,000; Research: ~1,300; Other (Admin, Operational, Supporting): ~2,000. - Number of leaders: around 150-200. - The initial rollout will target about 3,000 individuals.
558. What is the current baseline level of AI literacy across the general workforce, and will pre-assessments be required to route employees into basic vs. advanced learning pathways?	Baseline AI literacy has not been formally established; some AI baseline surveys were conducted in 2025 and 2026. Pre-assessments to route learners may be proposed by the Contractor.
559. Are there specific high-priority roles or departments targeted for immediate upskilling in Phase 1, or is the upskilling program expected to launch simultaneously enterprise-wide?	Prioritization may be recommended by the Contractor based on the readiness assessment. TTUHSC's priorities are strategy and governance, change management, workforce upskilling, and adoption analytics and ROI.
560. Will self-paced and virtual training modules be hosted directly on TTUHSC's existing Learning Management System (e.g., Canvas, Cornerstone), or is the contractor expected to provide an external Learning Experience Platform (LXP)?	- Yes, TTUHSC has an LMS. - Training may be hosted on TTUHSC's existing LMS; the Proposer may propose supplementary platforms as optional items.
561. What is the expected ratio between live/instructor-led sessions (virtual or on-site across campuses) versus asynchronous/self-paced digital learning modules?	At the Proposer's discretion to propose; a hybrid model is preferred, with on-site presence concentrated at milestones.
562. Who will be the internal Subject Matter Experts (SMEs) responsible for reviewing and approving the "sanitized institutional scenarios" to ensure compliance with HIPAA/FERPA before curriculum deployment?	TTUHSC functional SMEs and the Chief AI Transformation Officer / AI Steering Committee will review and approve sanitized scenarios for HIPAA/FERPA compliance; specific SMEs will be identified at kickoff.
563. Which specific AI tools and models are currently provisioned for general staff use versus specialized developer/analyst teams, so we can align prompt engineering and system instruction curricula?	Microsoft Copilot is currently the enterprise generative AI tool that has been deployed. Other GenAI tools are being evaluated. Examples of other tools provided enterprise-wide include Zoom AI Companion, Epic, Grammarly, etc.
564. Does TTUHSC intend to host the searchable AI Use-Case & Prompt Repository on internal infrastructure (e.g., SharePoint, Microsoft Teams, custom internal portal), or does TTUHSC expect a contractor-hosted/SaaS?	TTUHSC operates within a Microsoft enterprise environment. The repository may leverage existing TTUHSC systems (e.g., SharePoint/Teams); a contractor-hosted/SaaS option may be proposed as an optional item. No preference.
565. After contract end (August 31, 2027), who within TTUHSC will manage, filter, and audit ongoing submissions to the use-case and prompt repository?	TTUHSC will manage, filter, and audit the repository internally after the contract term, under the Chief AI Transformation Officer / AI Steering Committee. The Contractor should design for internal handover.
566. Does TTUHSC require formal digital badging/certification (e.g., via Credly or LMS certificates) upon completion of specific learning tracks?	Digital badging/certification (e.g., LMS certificates) may be proposed; it is not mandated. The Proposer may recommend an approach.
567. Will these training pathways be mandatory for specific employee classes, or will participation be incentive-driven/voluntary?	This will be determined with TTUHSC; a mix of mandatory role-based pathways and incentive-driven participation may be appropriate. The Proposer may recommend an approach.
568. Given the inclusion of HIPAA and FERPA data, does TTUHSC mandate that all proposed SaaS platforms, managed analytics services, and AI APIs possess a TX-RAMP Level 2 Certification (for confidential/regulated data) prior to contract execution, or is a Provisional Certification acceptable during the deployment phase?	- Under Texas Government Code Sec. 2054.0593 and Texas Department of Information Resources guidelines, TX-RAMP applies specifically to Cloud Service Providers offering hosted cloud computing services (SaaS, PaaS, IaaS). Where the solution is delivered as a professional/managed service operating inside TTUHSC's approved enterprise environment, using TTUHSC's certified infrastructure and tooling, with no contractor-hosted cloud service and no institutional data leaving TTUHSC-controlled systems, TX-RAMP would likely not apply. Where a proposal includes a hosted cloud service, TX-RAMP would apply. - Where TX-RAMP applies to a hosted component handling confidential/regulated data, a provisional certification may be acceptable during deployment, with full certification prior to production.
569. If the contractor engineers custom AI workflows or agentic applications deployed directly into TTUHSC's existing Azure/AWS tenant, will those bespoke applications be subject to a separate internal TTU Information Technology security review, or do they inherit the tenant's existing TX-RAMP status?	Bespoke applications deployed into TTUHSC's tenant would be subject to TTUHSC IT security review; they do not automatically inherit any tenant TX-RAMP status. This will be coordinated with TTUHSC IT security.

570. Does TTUHSC's interpretation of data sovereignty strictly require that all data processing, storage, and AI inference occur within data centers physically located in state, in the US or a specific cloud environment?	This restriction applies to all TTUHSC institutional data.
571. Requirement F.2 prohibits using institutional data to fine-tune vendor models. Will TTUHSC require vendors to provide legally binding Zero Data Retention (ZDR) agreements from underlying foundational model providers (e.g., OpenAI, Anthropic) proving that prompt inputs and generation outputs are not logged for abuse monitoring?	Institutional data shall not be used to train, fine-tune, or improve vendor, public, or third-party models. TTUHSC may require evidence that enterprise-tier model terms exclude training/retention on customer data; zero-retention/data-processing terms may be required and can be discussed.
572. For highly sensitive clinical or financial use cases, is TTUHSC open to deploying open-source models (e.g., Llama 3) locally on on-premise infrastructure, or is the strategy strictly focused on secure cloud-based APIs?	TTUHSC does not have a preference; the Proposer may propose open-source/on-premises models or secure cloud APIs, provided the solution meets the security and data-privacy requirements.
573. To meet the SSO and Role-Based Access Control (RBAC) requirements, which specific Identity Provider (IdP) does TTUHSC currently utilize (e.g., Microsoft Entra ID / Azure AD, Okta), and will the contractor be granted B2B tenant access to configure application registrations and user groups?	TTUHSC operates within a Microsoft enterprise environment. SSO via SAML 2.0/OAuth2 is required. Any tenant access for the Contractor will be provisioned by TTUHSC IT based on need and coordinated at kickoff.
574. For the Agentic AI Architecture (noted in Section D), how does TTUHSC envision enforcing RBAC at the data-layer level? For example, will AI agents inherit the specific file-level access rights of the authenticated user when querying institutional SharePoint or OneDrive repositories?	RBAC is expected to be enforced consistent with TTUHSC's enterprise identity and access model, with agents respecting the access rights of the authenticated user. The Contractor should design to this principle; specifics coordinated with TTUHSC IT.
575. Will TTUHSC require the contractor to feed AI application security logs, access logs, and anomaly detection telemetry directly into the university's existing SIEM (Security Information and Event Management) platform (e.g., Splunk, Sentinel)?	Where applicable, security/access logs and anomaly telemetry are expected to integrate with TTUHSC's existing security monitoring; specifics provided to the selected Contractor.
576. Given recent Texas legislative directives surrounding AI transparency and automated decision-making, does TTUHSC require the contractor to establish an algorithmic registry or document system intent and safety measures for future Attorney General audits?	- TTUHSC has some governance structure already in place and seeks to align with both the NIST AI Risk Management Framework and the Texas DIR framework. TTUHSC has a responsible AI use policy (OP 52.21) and maintains an active AI tool inventory. - Consistent with Texas requirements and TTUHSC governance, the Contractor is expected to help document system intent and safety measures (e.g., an algorithmic registry) to support transparency and any audits.
577. Will the contractor be provided access to existing process mining telemetry (e.g., via tools like Celonis) and standard operating procedures, or will opportunity mapping rely entirely on manual stakeholder interviews and workshops?	Opportunity mapping will rely on a combination of available telemetry and stakeholder interviews/workshops; TTUHSC will provide access to available data based on need. A dedicated process-mining tool is not assumed.
578. Has TTUHSC pre-defined the minimum expected return (e.g., hours saved, cost avoidance, error reduction) for a workflow to qualify for the prototyping phase, or will the contractor design the ROI qualification matrix?	- Baseline metrics have not been established. TTUHSC conducted some AI baseline surveys in 2025 and 2026, but the Contractor is expected to bring a method for measuring the baseline and, later, the ROI. - TTUHSC has not pre-defined a minimum return threshold; the Contractor is expected to design the ROI qualification approach.
579. What is TTUHSC's preferred enterprise development stack and CI/CD pipeline infrastructure for deploying custom model orchestration, and will the contractor be responsible for provisioning these development environments?	TTUHSC operates within a Microsoft enterprise environment. TTUHSC will not provide a dedicated sandbox, private tenant, or hosted environment for prototype development unless otherwise specified in the solicitation or subsequent contract documents. Proposers should assume responsibility for providing and managing any environments required to develop, host, demonstrate, and test proposed AI solutions. Any vendor-hosted environment used to store, process, or transmit TTUHSC data must comply with the security, privacy, and regulatory requirements defined in the RFP, including any applicable State of Texas and TTUHSC requirements. The development stack and CI/CD approach are at the Proposer's discretion, coordinated with TTUHSC. The Proposer may state its environment assumptions.
580. Does TTUHSC expect the architecture to leverage managed cloud-native agent services (e.g., Azure AI Studio, AWS Bedrock Agents), or is there an appetite for open-source orchestration frameworks (e.g.,	TTUHSC does not have a preference; the Proposer may propose managed cloud-native agent services or open-source orchestration, provided requirements are met.

LangChain, Semantic Kernel, AutoGen) deployed in containerized environments?	
581. Since agentic AI capabilities (multi-step autonomous workflows) can rapidly consume token limits, will the contractor be responsible for designing the cloud financial operations (FinOps) model to cap and monitor token consumption?	Yes. The Contractor is expected to address cost monitoring and controls (e.g., token consumption caps and monitoring) as part of the agentic AI architecture and governance.
582. How does TTUHSC currently define the risk boundaries that mandate HITL intervention? For example, will all data-mutating actions (e.g., updating a patient record, approving a purchase order) require a human approval gateway before execution?	The preference is for the Contractor to define risk boundaries as part of the governance framework. Data-mutating and higher-risk actions (e.g., updating a patient record, approving a purchase order) are expected to require a human approval gateway.
583. To govern agentic tools operating in production environments, does TTUHSC require an immutable audit ledger of every API call and decision node the agent executes to satisfy internal AI Governance Committee and state transparency audits?	Yes. An auditable, tamper-evident record of agent API calls and decision nodes sufficient for governance and state transparency audits is expected, to be designed by the Contractor.
584. Given TTUHSC's deployment of institutional AI tools, will the contractor be granted native API or global reader access to admin centers (e.g., Microsoft 365 Copilot dashboard, ChatGPT Edu admin console) to directly extract active utilization and feature usage data?	- Access to telemetry data will be provided to the Contractor if needed. - Access to admin/telemetry data (e.g., Microsoft 365 admin data) will be provided to the Contractor based on need.
585. To accurately monitor employee skill progression from basic usage to complex integrations, does TTUHSC expect the analytics solution to integrate with your Learning Management System (LMS) to cross-reference training completions with actual platform utilization?	- Yes, TTUHSC has an LMS. - Integration with the LMS to cross-reference training completions with utilization may be proposed.
586. To visualize these metrics, does TTUHSC require the Analytics & ROI Reporting Dashboard (Deliverable 5) to be built natively within your existing enterprise Business Intelligence stack (e.g., Tableau, Power BI), or is a vendor-managed SaaS telemetry platform acceptable?	Either route is acceptable, with no preference here. Power BI is available.
587. For identifying lagging departments and targeting coaching requirements, should the intervention system actively trigger operational workflows (e.g., auto-enrolling a lagging user in a refresher course, generating an IT helpdesk ticket) or simply flag the anomaly on a management dashboard?	At the Proposer's discretion to propose; both flagging on a dashboard and triggering operational workflows (e.g., auto-enrollment, ticket generation) may be appropriate. Human-in-the-loop controls apply to any automated action.
588. Section 5.2 states Proposer must be "in compliant with TX-RAMP as may be required." Please clarify: is TX-RAMP certification a mandatory prerequisite for proposal submission, or does it apply conditionally, only to proposed components that constitute a hosted/cloud computing service? If the latter, please confirm whether an advisory/training/on-prem engagement with no vendor-hosted SaaS component is exempt from this requirement.	- Under Texas Government Code Sec. 2054.0593 and Texas Department of Information Resources guidelines, TX-RAMP applies specifically to Cloud Service Providers offering hosted cloud computing services (SaaS, PaaS, IaaS). Where the solution is delivered as a professional/managed service operating inside TTUHSC's approved enterprise environment, using TTUHSC's certified infrastructure and tooling, with no contractor-hosted cloud service and no institutional data leaving TTUHSC-controlled systems, TX-RAMP would likely not apply. Where a proposal includes a hosted cloud service, TX-RAMP would apply. - TX-RAMP is not a blanket prerequisite for submission; it applies conditionally to any proposed hosted/cloud computing component. An advisory/training/on-premises engagement with no vendor-hosted SaaS component would be outside TX-RAMP scope.
589. If TX-RAMP applies only to specific components, is a provisional TX-RAMP designation (in-process certification) acceptable at proposal submission, with full certification required prior to production deployment of any hosted analytics or automation tool (ref. Deliverable 5, Section 5.4.E)?	Under Texas Government Code Sec. 2054.0593 and Texas Department of Information Resources guidelines, TX-RAMP applies specifically to Cloud Service Providers offering hosted cloud computing services (SaaS, PaaS, IaaS). Where the solution is delivered as a professional/managed service operating inside TTUHSC's approved enterprise environment, using TTUHSC's certified infrastructure and tooling, with no contractor-hosted cloud service and no institutional data leaving TTUHSC-controlled systems, TX-RAMP would likely not apply. Where a proposal includes a hosted cloud service, TX-RAMP would apply.

	Where TX-RAMP applies, a provisional/in-process designation may be acceptable at submission, with full certification required prior to production deployment of any hosted component.
590. Section 5.4.D.3 requires a framework for "deploying, monitoring, and controlling agentic AI capabilities." Does TTUHSC have an existing agentic orchestration platform or LLM provider already under enterprise agreement (e.g., Microsoft Copilot Studio, Azure AI Foundry, AWS Bedrock, or a specific LLM vendor), or is Contractor expected to recommend and stand up this layer from scratch?	- Microsoft Copilot is currently the enterprise generative AI tool that has been deployed. Other GenAI tools are being evaluated. Examples of other tools provided enterprise-wide include Zoom AI Companion, Epic, Grammarly, etc. - The preference is for the Contractor to recommend and stand up the agentic AI architecture; TTUHSC operates a Microsoft enterprise environment.
591. Section 5.4.F.2 states institutional data "shall not be used to train, fine-tune, or improve vendor proprietary models, public models, or third-party datasets." Does this restriction extend to inference-only API calls to third-party foundation models, or only to training/fine-tuning activity?	The restriction is on using institutional data to train, fine-tune, or improve models. Inference-only API calls are permissible provided the provider's terms exclude training and retention on customer data and no institutional data is used to improve models.
592. Will TTUHSC require Contractor to execute data processing addenda or zero-retention agreements with any third-party model provider used in the solution architecture, and does TTUHSC have an approved list of permissible LLM vendors?	TTUHSC may require data-processing or zero-retention terms with third-party model providers. There is no published approved-vendor list; proposed providers will be reviewed. Enterprise tooling currently includes Microsoft Copilot.
593. Section 5.4.A.5 requires a "findings-to-recommendations traceability matrix or equivalent artifact." Is there a required format, template, or rubric TTUHSC will use to evaluate this artifact, or is format entirely at Proposer's discretion?	Format is at the Proposer's discretion; a standalone artifact is acceptable. Please ensure it is clear and discernable to the evaluating reader.
594. Section 5.3.2 requires deliverables to include formal acceptance criteria and a work plan, but does not specify sign-off authority at each phase. Who is the designated approver for each of the six deliverables (ref. Section 5.4 deliverables table), and is there a formal change-control process if a deliverable is rejected or requires rework?	- Deliverable acceptance is by the Chief AI Transformation Officer, the AI Steering Committee, and the President, and will depend on TTUHSC review cycles. - A change-control process will apply if a deliverable is rejected or requires rework; this will be documented in the Agreement.
595. Section 5.4.C requires role-based training curricula across "procurement, finance, clinical administration, academic operations" (illustrative, not exhaustive). Can TTUHSC provide the total addressable headcount by campus/department to be trained, to enable accurate level-of-effort estimation for the fixed-fee pricing required under Section 6.1?	- Total number of employees: about 6,000. The initial rollout will be around 3,000 individuals. - Abilene: ~100; Amarillo: ~700; Dallas: ~90; Lubbock: ~3,710; Permian Basin: ~600; Strategic Initiatives (Correctional Managed Care): ~800. - Functional domains (some groups overlap): Clinical: ~2,000; Academic: ~2,000; Research: ~1,300; Other (Admin, Operational, Supporting): ~2,000. - Number of leaders: around 150-200. - The initial rollout will target about 3,000 individuals.
596. Section 5.4.B.2 requires a "Change Champions Network... across administrative and academic departments." What is the target number of champions/departments, and is this Contractor-selected or TTUHSC-nominated?	The President's Cabinet and Council structure can serve as the initial champions, about 150-200 individuals. The number and structure of champions may be proposed by the Contractor based on the assessment.
597. Appendix A 1.3 designates "all writings, reports, or other materials produced by Consultant... relating to the services" as work-for-hire owned exclusively by University. Please confirm this is intended to cover only deliverables specific to TTUHSC, and does not extend to Contractor's pre-existing proprietary methodologies, training frameworks, software libraries, or reusable IP incorporated into those deliverables.	It is not the intention of TTUHSC to make claim to pre-existing intellectual property. Please note Section 7 - General Terms and Conditions; if a Proposer takes exception to any Required Term, the Proposer should submit a list of the exceptions as part of its proposal.
598. What specifically constitutes an in-scope adjustment versus a billable change order under the hourly rate card (Section 6.1.2), e.g., would scope changes arising from TX-RAMP remediation, additional departments added to the Change Champions Network, or expanded LLM integration work be treated as change orders?	- Costing for any solution offered is at the discretion of the Proposer. Cost breakdown within a deliverable line or a separate cost line is not a differentiator for TTUHSC reviewers. Please ensure costing is clear and discernable to the evaluating reader. Any modifications to price would be handled through a change-order process. - Scope changes - for example, TX-RAMP remediation, additional departments

	in the Change Champions Network, or expanded integration work - would be handled through the change-order process. Specific thresholds will be agreed in the Agreement.
599. The Background section references "enterprise AI tools, including LLMs and embedded AI productivity assistants" already provisioned, without naming them. Can TTUHSC disclose the specific tools/platforms currently in production (e.g., Microsoft Copilot, specific LLM vendor contracts) so Proposer can scope integration versus net-new build accurately under Section 5.4.D?	Microsoft Copilot is currently the enterprise generative AI tool that has been deployed. Other GenAI tools are being evaluated. Examples of other tools provided enterprise-wide include Zoom AI Companion, Epic, Grammarly, etc.
600. Section 5.4.F.3 requires SSO via SAML 2.0/OAuth2. Does TTUHSC use a single IdP across all five campuses (Abilene, Amarillo, DFW, Lubbock, Permian Basin), or are there campus-specific identity domains Contractor must federate against?	TTUHSC operates within a Microsoft enterprise environment. SSO via SAML 2.0/OAuth2 is required across the enterprise. Any campus-specific federation details will be provided at kickoff.
601. Will any proposed solution be deployed within TTUHSC's Azure/AWS/GCP tenant, in a Contractor-owned cloud environment, or does TTUHSC require on-premises deployment for any component touching PHI?	Deployment within TTUHSC's environment or a vendor-managed environment is acceptable, with no preference. Components touching PHI must keep PHI within TTUHSC-controlled systems; PHI is not expected to be made available. On-premises deployment is not mandated but may be proposed.
602. For any AI output touching clinical documentation or decision support, does TTUHSC require clinical validation/oversight by a physician informatics committee before production deployment, separate from the general HITL procedures described in Section 5.4.D.4?	Yes. For AI output touching clinical documentation or decision support, clinical validation/oversight is expected before production deployment, in addition to the general HITL procedures. Clinical scope may extend to decision support, diagnostic, and patient-facing applications.
603. Will Contractor be provided a non-production/sandbox environment with de-identified or synthetic data for prototyping?	- TTUHSC will not provide a dedicated sandbox, private tenant, or hosted environment for prototype development unless otherwise specified in the solicitation or subsequent contract documents. Proposers should assume responsibility for providing and managing any environments required to develop, host, demonstrate, and test proposed AI solutions. Any vendor-hosted environment used to store, process, or transmit TTUHSC data must comply with the security, privacy, and regulatory requirements defined in the RFP, including any applicable State of Texas and TTUHSC requirements. - TTUHSC has test patient data that may be used.
604. Does TTUHSC permit Contractor to utilize nearshore or offshore personnel/subcontractors for portions of the engagement that do not involve access to PHI or FERPA-protected data (e.g., training curriculum development, sanitized workflow analysis)? If so, is a categorical written authorization process available, or would authorization need to be requested and approved on a role-by-role/task-by-task basis?	- The preference is to have everything located inside the US. Offshore participation may be permitted for work that does not involve institutional data, but this requires further discussion with the Contractor; if PHI is involved, PHI must not be stored offshore. - Authorization can be discussed with the Contractor; the preference is US-based, and PHI must not be stored offshore. - Any offshore personnel/subcontractors would need to be approved by TTUHSC.
605. Is there a budget range or not-to-exceed ceiling for this engagement? Will TTUHSC disclose an anticipated budget or funding source?	The cost shall not exceed \$750,000.
606. ROI baseline data and acceptance criteria. Do those baselines currently exist, and who owns producing them? Is milestone payment or deliverable acceptance contingent on achieving specific ROI thresholds, or only on delivering the measurement framework itself?	- Baseline metrics have not been established. TTUHSC conducted some AI baseline surveys in 2025 and 2026, but the Contractor is expected to bring a method for measuring the baseline and, later, the ROI. - Milestone payment and acceptance are based on delivering the measurement framework and the deliverables, not on achieving specific ROI thresholds. - Deliverable acceptance is by the Chief AI Transformation Officer, the AI Steering Committee, and the President, and will depend on TTUHSC review cycles.
607. Project schedule. Evaluation runs through November 30, 2026, and the agreement expires August 31, 2027. Please confirm the anticipated kick-off date and whether all deliverables must be completed inside that	- The following proposed Project Schedule may change based on RFP progress: - Kick-off meeting: February 2027; - Deliverable 1: April 2027; - Deliverable 2: April 2027;

window. Are renewal terms or extensions beyond August 31, 2027 contemplated? A nine-month runway for all deliverables will be extremely tight, especially if kick-off is not conducted soon after the award date.	○ Deliverable 3: September 2027; ○ Deliverable 4: September 2027; ○ Deliverable 5: December 2027; ○ Deliverable 6: February 2028. • TTUHSC is seeking completion of all deliverables and will work collaboratively in constructing a contract term that accommodates that position.
608. Which AI tools are already deployed, and what telemetry access comes with them? The RFP references LLMs and embedded AI productivity assistants without naming them. Please identify the specific platforms, seat counts, and current utilization data, and confirm whether the Contractor will receive admin access to tenant-level usage telemetry.	• Microsoft Copilot is currently the enterprise generative AI tool that has been deployed. Other GenAI tools are being evaluated. Examples of other tools provided enterprise-wide include Zoom AI Companion, Epic, Grammarly, etc. • Access to telemetry data will be provided to the Contractor if needed. • Specific seat counts and utilization data will be provided to the selected Contractor based on need.
609. Scope and scale. How many employees, by campus and by category (faculty, clinical staff, administrative, research), are in scope for training, and how many are expected to complete role-based curricula? How many on-site days does TTUHSC expect across the five campuses versus virtual delivery? In addition to training, how many employees are in scope for the rest of the project who may be needed for interviews, focus groups, and other engagements? Travel has to be included in the fee, so this is the single biggest sizing variable.	• Total number of employees: about 6,000. • Abilene: ~100; Amarillo: ~700; Dallas: ~90; Lubbock: ~3,710; Permian Basin: ~600; Strategic Initiatives (Correctional Managed Care): ~800. • Functional domains (some groups overlap): Clinical: ~2,000; Academic: ~2,000; Research: ~1,300; Other (Admin, Operational, Supporting): ~2,000. • Number of leaders: around 150-200. • The initial rollout will target about 3,000 individuals. • TTUHSC expects some on-site presence but does not have strict requirements for delivery frequency or duration. A predominantly virtual/hybrid model is acceptable, with on-site presence concentrated at defined milestones such as executive alignment sessions and leadership workshops. The initial kickoff is preferred on all campuses (negotiable), and the leadership enablement meeting is preferred on-site in Lubbock, TX. Overall, a hybrid model is preferred. • In addition to training, broader stakeholders across the functional areas may participate in interviews, focus groups, and workshops; the Proposer may state its assumptions. Travel is to be included in the fee.
610. Engagement expectations. Are engagements expected to be in-person, virtual, or hybrid? If hybrid, is there an expected breakdown for how this would look?	• TTUHSC expects some on-site presence but does not have strict requirements for delivery frequency or duration. A predominantly virtual/hybrid model is acceptable, with on-site presence concentrated at defined milestones such as executive alignment sessions and leadership workshops. The initial kickoff is preferred on all campuses (negotiable), and the leadership enablement meeting is preferred on-site in Lubbock, TX. Overall, a hybrid model is preferred.
611. Local business preferences. Is preference given to businesses based in the state of Texas?	• Evaluation is based on the criteria in Section 4.3.2 (Service Specifications 55%, Experience and Reputation 15%, Pricing 30%). TTUHSC does not apply a separate geographic or local-business price preference; Texas VetHUB participation is addressed under Section 3.7.
612. Section 5.4 references a policy landscape component within the current state assessment. Could TTUHSC clarify whether this refers to review of TTUHSC's own existing internal AI related policies, external state and federal regulatory requirements, or both?	• Both. The current-state assessment should review TTUHSC's own internal AI-related policies (e.g., OP 52.21) as well as applicable external state and federal regulatory requirements.
613. TTUHSC has indicated that it has provisioned enterprise AI tools, including large language models and embedded productivity assistants. Can TTUHSC provide additional detail on the specific platforms, license tiers, and approximate seat counts currently deployed, along with any existing utilization data?	• Microsoft Copilot is currently the enterprise generative AI tool that has been deployed. Other GenAI tools are being evaluated. Examples of other tools provided enterprise-wide include Zoom AI Companion, Epic, Grammarly, etc. • Access to telemetry data will be provided to the Contractor if needed. • Specific license tiers, seat counts, and utilization data will be provided to the selected Contractor based on need.
614. Are the prototypes and custom solutions developed under Deliverable 4 expected to remain proof of concept, or are some expected to graduate into live production systems requiring the full agentic	• TTUHSC is planning to have at least two workflows/use cases from each functional area (Academic, Clinical, Research, and Admin) evaluated by the Contractor, for a total of about 8 to 10 workflows. Solutions should be either pilot-ready or fully production-ready; the associated cost should not be included in the fixed fee but may be listed as an optional item for TTUHSC to

governance and human in the loop oversight described elsewhere in this deliverable?	consider.
615. There is a possibility that discovery surfaces opportunities touching sensitive systems such as HR or payroll. In our experience, access provisioning for such systems can be lengthy. Is there flexibility to adjust timeline or scope if discovery surfaces opportunities in these domains requiring additional security review?	Yes. TTUHSC will work collaboratively on timeline or scope if discovery surfaces opportunities in sensitive domains (e.g., HR or payroll) requiring additional security review or access provisioning.
616. Section 5.2 requires compliance with TX RAMP as may be required. Please confirm whether TX RAMP certification, and at what level, is mandatory at proposal submission for a hosted analytics platform under Deliverable 5, and whether a solution that avoids introducing any new cloud service, for example analytics delivered inside TTUHSC's existing tenant and BI stack, would fall outside TX RAMP scope.	- Under Texas Government Code Sec. 2054.0593 and Texas Department of Information Resources guidelines, TX-RAMP applies specifically to Cloud Service Providers offering hosted cloud computing services (SaaS, PaaS, IaaS). Where the solution is delivered as a professional/managed service operating inside TTUHSC's approved enterprise environment, using TTUHSC's certified infrastructure and tooling, with no contractor-hosted cloud service and no institutional data leaving TTUHSC-controlled systems, TX-RAMP would likely not apply. Where a proposal includes a hosted cloud service, TX-RAMP would apply. - A Deliverable 5 solution delivered inside TTUHSC's existing tenant and BI stack, introducing no new cloud service, would fall outside TX-RAMP scope. Power BI is available.
617. Section 2.3 shows evaluation running through November 30, 2026, while Section 2.4 fixes the term end at August 31, 2027. Does TTUHSC intend all six deliverables to be completed within that eight to nine month window, is there any option or mechanism to renew or extend beyond that date, and given the breadth of all six deliverables, would TTUHSC consider a phased proposal delivering a prioritized subset within the current term with remaining scope deferred or optioned into a follow on period?	- The following proposed Project Schedule may change based on RFP progress: - Kick-off meeting: February 2027; - Deliverable 1: April 2027; - Deliverable 2: April 2027; - Deliverable 3: September 2027; - Deliverable 4: September 2027; - Deliverable 5: December 2027; - Deliverable 6: February 2028. - TTUHSC is seeking completion of all deliverables and will work collaboratively in constructing a contract term that accommodates that position. - A phased approach delivering a prioritized subset within the term, with remaining scope deferred or optioned into a follow-on period, may be proposed. TTUHSC will work collaboratively on the term.
618. Will vendor personnel be required to use TTUHSC issued devices or credentials, undergo background checks, HIPAA training, or badging to access TTUHSC systems, or can work be performed on vendor owned equipment with remote access? What is the typical lead time for any required credentialing?	Vendor personnel access requirements - such as devices/credentials, background checks, HIPAA training, and badging - will be coordinated with TTUHSC based on the systems accessed. Much of the work may be performed on vendor-owned equipment via remote access. Credentialing lead times will be provided at onboarding.
619. Section 6.1 specifies a not to exceed fixed fee per deliverable, while the RFP also requests a detailed rate card broken out by role. Could TTUHSC clarify whether they are expecting a fixed fee proposal, a time and materials proposal, or whether both are acceptable, and if fixed fee, how the rate card factors into evaluation?	- Costing for any solution offered is at the discretion of the Proposer. Cost breakdown within a deliverable line or a separate cost line is not a differentiator for TTUHSC reviewers. Please ensure costing is clear and discernable to the evaluating reader. Any modifications to price would be handled through a change-order process. - A not-to-exceed fixed fee per deliverable is expected per Section 6.1, with a rate card for change-order and scope-change purposes. Please ensure it is clear and discernable to the evaluating reader.
620. Section 1.9 provides payment per deliverable upon completion, while Section 1.13 permits termination for convenience on 30 days' notice with payment only for services rendered to date of notice. For deliverables spanning several months, notably Deliverable 3, will TTUHSC accept milestone based partial invoicing, or monthly invoicing against the not to exceed amount?	Payment is per deliverable upon completion and acceptance. For deliverables spanning several months (e.g., Deliverable 3), milestone-based partial invoicing may be discussed with the Contractor.
621. Does "train the trainer" mean the contractor delivers written playbooks and materials for TTUHSC staff to use independently, or does the contractor need to facilitate live train the trainer sessions with TTUHSC's internal trainers?	The Vendor is expected to develop training content and curriculum from scratch and may propose either written playbooks and materials for independent TTUHSC use or facilitated live train-the-trainer sessions; both may be appropriate.

622. Section 5.4.F.2 prohibits institutional data being used to train, fine tune, or improve vendor, public, or third party models. Please confirm this obligation is satisfied by the contractor procuring and configuring enterprise tier model APIs whose terms already exclude training on customer data, with those terms evidenced to TTUHSC.	Yes - procuring and configuring enterprise-tier model APIs whose terms already exclude training on customer data, with those terms evidenced to TTUHSC, would satisfy this obligation.
623. Does TTUHSC have a preferred sequencing or prioritization among the six deliverables, and are there any external deadlines, such as grant reporting, accreditation reviews, or board commitments, tied to specific deliverables that proposers should be aware of when planning the schedule?	- Priorities are strategy and governance, change management, workforce upskilling, and adoption analytics and ROI. - The following proposed Project Schedule may change based on RFP progress: - Kick-off meeting: February 2027; - Deliverable 1: April 2027; - Deliverable 2: April 2027; - Deliverable 3: September 2027; - Deliverable 4: September 2027; - Deliverable 5: December 2027; - Deliverable 6: February 2028. - TTUHSC is seeking completion of all deliverables and will work collaboratively in constructing a contract term that accommodates that position. - TTUHSC is not aware of external deadlines tied to specific deliverables that proposers must plan around; this will be confirmed at kickoff.
624. What proportion of delivery does TTUHSC expect to be on site versus remote, and across how many of the five campuses, to accurately build a travel budget?	- TTUHSC expects some on-site presence but does not have strict requirements for delivery frequency or duration. A predominantly virtual/hybrid model is acceptable, with on-site presence concentrated at defined milestones such as executive alignment sessions and leadership workshops. The initial kickoff is preferred on all campuses (negotiable), and the leadership enablement meeting is preferred on-site in Lubbock, TX. Overall, a hybrid model is preferred. - Travel is to be included in the fee; the Proposer may state its on-site assumptions across the five campuses.
625. Does TTUHSC plan to operate and maintain the analytics and ROI dashboard internally after the contract term, or is there an expectation of a managed service?	TTUHSC plans to operate and maintain the analytics and ROI dashboard internally after the term; a managed service is not required but may be proposed as an optional item.
626. Does TTUHSC expect a hard cutoff of vendor involvement at contract end on August 31, 2027, or some period of continued availability, such as a warranty period or on call support?	TTUHSC does not require ongoing involvement after the term; a warranty period or on-call support may be proposed as an optional item, with costs listed separately.
627. Section 4.3.2 assigns 55 percent of the evaluation to Service Specifications and 15 percent to Experience and Reputation. Will TTUHSC apply sub-criteria or sub-weights within either category, for example by deliverable or across approach, team, and schedule?	TTUHSC has not published sub-weights within the Section 4.3.2 categories. Evaluation is against the stated criteria; the Contractor is expected to address all deliverables, approach, team, and schedule.
628. How will the 30 percent pricing weight be scored, for example lowest total cost normalized against competing proposals or a best value assessment against the level of effort schedule? Are travel and expenses included in the price score?	- Costing for any solution offered is at the discretion of the Proposer. Cost breakdown within a deliverable line or a separate cost line is not a differentiator for TTUHSC reviewers. Please ensure costing is clear and discernable to the evaluating reader. Any modifications to price would be handled through a change-order process. - Pricing is evaluated for reasonableness and value against the scope and level of effort. Travel and expenses are to be included in the fee.
629. Has TTUHSC previously engaged a vendor for AI strategy, governance, or enablement work? If so, are prior assessments, roadmaps, or policy drafts available to the successful proposer as a starting baseline?	TTUHSC has not previously engaged a vendor for this AI strategy, governance, and enablement scope. Some AI baseline surveys (2025 and 2026), an active AI tool inventory, and a responsible AI use policy (OP 52.21) exist and can inform the work.
630. Does TTUHSC have existing analytics, BI, or LMS platforms, for example Power BI, Tableau, Cornerstone, SumTotal, or Workday Learning, that the contractor is expected to use or integrate with, rather than introducing a new tool?	- Either route is acceptable, with no preference here. Power BI is available. - Yes, TTUHSC has an LMS.

631. Appendix A Section 1.7 and Appendix B Section 1.1.9 impose uncapped indemnification, while Section 1.6 requires general liability limits of only \$250,000 per person and \$500,000 per occurrence. Will TTUHSC consider an aggregate limitation of liability tied to fees paid under the agreement?	Please note Section 7 - General Terms and Conditions. If a Proposer takes exception to any of the Required Terms, the Proposer should submit a list of the exceptions as part of its proposal.
632. Please confirm the acceptance criteria and review period for each deliverable, who approves, within what timeframe, and what happens if TTUHSC does not respond.	- Deliverable acceptance is by the Chief AI Transformation Officer, the AI Steering Committee, and the President, and will depend on TTUHSC review cycles. - Formal acceptance criteria and a work plan are required per Section 5.3.2; review periods and the process where TTUHSC does not respond will be agreed in the Agreement.
633. Section 1.33 prohibits publicizing the agreement or using TTUHSC's name without prior written approval. Does this prevent the contractor from citing TTUHSC as a reference in future procurements, and would TTUHSC consider a limited consent for reference use?	- Please note Section 7 - General Terms and Conditions. If a Proposer takes exception to any of the Required Terms, the Proposer should submit a list of the exceptions as part of its proposal. - Use of TTUHSC's name requires prior written approval; a limited consent for reference use may be discussed and would be documented in the Agreement.
634. Section 5.4.A.2 references operational pain points and cultural adoption barriers. Can TTUHSC share any prior internal assessment, survey, or leadership input already collected on these, or identify specific pain points already known to leadership?	TTUHSC can share available inputs (e.g., 2025 and 2026 AI baseline surveys and leadership input) with the selected Contractor. A formal prior assessment of operational pain points and cultural barriers does not exist and is expected to be developed.
635. Will it be at the contractor's discretion to determine the appropriate number of departments included in workflow discovery and the number of prototypes developed under Deliverable 4, based on findings from the current state assessment?	Yes. The Contractor may propose the number of departments in workflow discovery and the number of prototypes, informed by the current-state assessment; TTUHSC anticipates about 8-10 workflows across the four functional areas.
636. Does TTUHSC envision leadership education as an ongoing cadence rather than a single one time session, tailored where appropriate by school or leadership level given the diversity of campuses covered?	Yes. Leadership education is envisioned as an ongoing cadence, tailored where appropriate by school or leadership level; the Proposer may propose the structure.
637. Will the Contractor propose the appropriate number of leaders in scope for Leadership Activation based on role and organizational level, rather than TTUHSC providing a fixed count in advance?	Yes. The Contractor may propose the number of leaders in scope based on role and organizational level. For reference, there are around 150-200 leaders.
638. Will the Contractor propose the appropriate number and structure of role based training tracks under Workforce Upskilling based on findings from the assessment phase?	Yes. The Contractor may propose the number and structure of role-based training tracks based on the assessment.
639. Will TTUHSC identify target roles and provide sanitized use case data to support the applied learning component of Workforce Upskilling?	Yes. TTUHSC will help identify target roles and provide sanitized use-case data to support the applied learning component, based on need. The Vendor develops the curriculum from scratch.
640. Does TTUHSC contemplate awarding this engagement in whole to a single firm, or would TTUHSC consider a partial award on a subset of the functional areas or deliverables (e.g., awarding Areas A, B, E, F, and G to one firm and Areas C and/or D to another)? If partial award is permissible, how should a proposer indicate which areas they are bidding on, and how will that be evaluated against the full scope?	- It is TTUHSC's intention to issue a single award; however, in accordance with the terms of the RFP, TTUHSC reserves the right to award an agreement for all or any portion of the requirements, to award multiple agreements, or to reject any and all proposals if deemed to be in the best interests of TTUHSC. - A Proposer may bid on a subset of areas or deliverables and should clearly indicate which areas it is proposing; proposals are evaluated against the stated criteria.
641. Section 1.27 of the Agreement states that subcontracting requires TTUHSC's prior written approval. If a proposer intends to deliver certain functional areas (e.g., Area C — Workforce Upskilling, or Area D — Workflow Automation) through a named partner or subcontractor, should the proposal identify the partner at the time of submission? Will the inclusion of subcontractors be viewed favorably or neutrally in the evaluation?	If certain areas will be delivered through a named partner or subcontractor, the proposal should identify the partner at submission. Subcontracting requires TTUHSC's prior written approval and is viewed neutrally; any delegation would be documented in the award agreement.
642. Does TTUHSC currently have an enterprise Learning Management System (LMS) or learning platform in place (e.g., the ACME LMS referenced in the AI Acceptable Use Policy)? If so, should the role-based training curricula (Deliverable 3) be designed for	- Yes, TTUHSC has an LMS. - The role-based training curricula may be designed for delivery through TTUHSC's existing LMS; the Vendor develops the curriculum from scratch.

delivery through that existing system, or does TTUHSC expect the proposer to provide a separate platform?	The 'ACME LMS' reference in the policy is illustrative.
643. What is the anticipated number of training participants or target audience size for the role-based learning tracks (Area C)? Are there specific functional domains (procurement, finance, clinical administration, academic operations) that should be prioritized, or should the proposer recommend a prioritization based on the readiness assessment?	- Total number of employees: about 6,000. - Abilene: ~100; Amarillo: ~700; Dallas: ~90; Lubbock: ~3,710; Permian Basin: ~600; Strategic Initiatives (Correctional Managed Care): ~800. - Functional domains (some groups overlap): Clinical: ~2,000; Academic: ~2,000; Research: ~1,300; Other (Admin, Operational, Supporting): ~2,000. - Number of leaders: around 150-200. - The initial rollout will target about 3,000 individuals. - The Proposer may recommend prioritization among the functional domains based on the readiness assessment.
644. Regarding the institutional knowledge repository (Area C.5), must this be a proprietary platform built or provided by the proposer, or can it leverage existing TTUHSC systems (e.g., SharePoint, intranet, or an existing knowledge base)? What are TTUHSC's preferred integration requirements?	TTUHSC operates within a Microsoft enterprise environment. The repository may leverage existing TTUHSC systems (e.g., SharePoint or intranet); a proposer-provided platform is not required. Integration preferences will be confirmed at kickoff.
645. The Project Schedule in Section 5.6 leaves the completion dates for all six deliverables blank. Should the proposer propose its own timeline for each deliverable within the overall contract term (execution through August 31, 2027)? Are there any interim milestones or sequencing dependencies TTUHSC expects (e.g., must Deliverable 1 be completed before Deliverable 3 begins)?	- The following proposed Project Schedule may change based on RFP progress: - Kick-off meeting: February 2027; - Deliverable 1: April 2027; - Deliverable 2: April 2027; - Deliverable 3: September 2027; - Deliverable 4: September 2027; - Deliverable 5: December 2027; - Deliverable 6: February 2028. - TTUHSC is seeking completion of all deliverables and will work collaboratively in constructing a contract term that accommodates that position. - Proposers may propose their own timeline within the term; TTUHSC will work collaboratively on sequencing and dependencies.
646. The RFP references TX-RAMP compliance "as may be required." Is TX-RAMP certification mandatory for this engagement, or is it conditional on the scope of system access and data handling? If a proposer is not currently TX-RAMP certified but will not have direct access to TTUHSC systems or regulated data, would that be acceptable?	- Under Texas Government Code Sec. 2054.0593 and Texas Department of Information Resources guidelines, TX-RAMP applies specifically to Cloud Service Providers offering hosted cloud computing services (SaaS, PaaS, IaaS). Where the solution is delivered as a professional/managed service operating inside TTUHSC's approved enterprise environment, using TTUHSC's certified infrastructure and tooling, with no contractor-hosted cloud service and no institutional data leaving TTUHSC-controlled systems, TX-RAMP would likely not apply. Where a proposal includes a hosted cloud service, TX-RAMP would apply. - If a Proposer will not have direct access to TTUHSC systems or regulated data and introduces no hosted cloud service, TX-RAMP would not apply.
647. What is the anticipated total contract value range for this engagement? Will Board of Regents approval be required, and if so, at what threshold? This information will help proposers determine whether Ethics Form 1295 (Disclosure of Interested Parties) will be required.	- The cost shall not exceed \$750,000. - Proposers should comply with applicable requirements, including Form 1295 (Disclosure of Interested Parties) where required by law. TTUHSC will advise the selected Contractor of any Board of Regents approval requirements at award.
648. The RFP states that oral presentations or interviews may be conducted at TTUHSC's discretion. If anticipated, what format is expected (in-person, virtual, or hybrid), and what is the approximate timeframe relative to the evaluation period (September 21 – November 30, 2026)?	If conducted, oral presentations will most likely be virtual and scored separately, with an agenda provided to finalists in advance; the Contractor is expected to cover all deliverables and demonstrate selected deliverables. Timing would follow the evaluation period.
649. The RFP references that TTUHSC has already provisioned enterprise AI tools, including LLMs and embedded AI productivity assistants. Can TTUHSC identify which specific tools or platforms have been	Microsoft Copilot is currently the enterprise generative AI tool that has been deployed. Other GenAI tools are being evaluated. Examples of other tools provided enterprise-wide include Zoom AI Companion, Epic, Grammarly, etc.

provisioned (e.g., Microsoft Copilot, OpenAI, Google Gemini)? This will help proposers tailor training curricula and workflow automation proposals to the existing technology stack.	
650. The RFP references an AI Governance and Risk Committee established by the President's Cabinet. Can TTUHSC share the committee's current composition, charter, and any existing governance decisions or approved use cases? This will help proposers understand the starting point for the governance framework development (Area A.4).	- The Chief AI Transformation Officer is the executive sponsor. TTUHSC has an AI Steering Committee which is the oversight body of the effort. - TTUHSC has some governance structure already in place and seeks to align with both the NIST AI Risk Management Framework and the Texas DIR framework. TTUHSC has a responsible AI use policy (OP 52.21) and maintains an active AI tool inventory. - Details of the AI Governance and Risk Committee's composition and charter will be shared with the selected Contractor; the Contractor should build on the existing structure.
651. TTUHSC has an existing AI Acceptable Use Policy (OP 52.21) and the El Paso campus has a separate GenAI policy (OP 56.08). Should the proposer's governance framework (Area A.4) build upon and integrate with these existing policies, or does TTUHSC expect a comprehensive replacement? Are there known gaps in the current policies that the proposer should address?	Build upon and integrate with the existing policies (TTUHSC's OP 52.21, not El Paso's policy) rather than replace them; the Contractor should identify and address gaps. TTUHSC aligns with the NIST AI RMF and the Texas DIR framework.
652. Given that Service Specifications carry 55% of the evaluation weight, can TTUHSC provide additional detail on how this category will be scored? Specifically, will evaluators be looking for a specific methodology, or is the proposer free to recommend its own approach? Are there specific elements (e.g., innovation, risk mitigation, cultural fit, speed of adoption) that will be weighted more heavily within this category?	Evaluation is against the criteria in Section 4.3.2; the Proposer is free to recommend its own methodology or approach. TTUHSC has not published sub-weights within the category. Please ensure the proposal is clear and discernable to the evaluating reader.
653. Is there a not-to-exceed budget for this engagement that proposers should be aware of when developing their pricing proposals? If so, can TTUHSC share the budget range? If there is no fixed budget, what criteria will be used to evaluate pricing reasonableness (30% weight)?	- The cost shall not exceed \$750,000. - Costing for any solution offered is at the discretion of the Proposer. Cost breakdown within a deliverable line or a separate cost line is not a differentiator for TTUHSC reviewers. Please ensure costing is clear and discernable to the evaluating reader. Any modifications to price would be handled through a change-order process.
654. Will TTUHSC issue responses to all submitted questions in a single consolidated addendum, or may multiple addenda be issued? What is the anticipated timeline for addenda publication relative to the September 21 submission deadline?	TTUHSC may issue one or more addenda. Responses to questions will be posted to the solicitation on the ESBID and TechBid portals in advance of the submission deadline.
655. The RFP references that TTUHSC has already provisioned enterprise AI tools but that current utilization is isolated and low-complexity. Can TTUHSC provide any baseline metrics or estimates of current AI adoption across the institution (e.g., number of active users, departments currently engaged, types of use cases in production, frequency of use)? Is there an existing maturity or readiness assessment, or will the proposer be expected to conduct the first baseline assessment?	- Baseline metrics have not been established. TTUHSC conducted some AI baseline surveys in 2025 and 2026, but the Contractor is expected to bring a method for measuring the baseline and, later, the ROI. - Current utilization is isolated and low-complexity. No formal maturity or readiness assessment exists; the Contractor is expected to conduct the first baseline assessment. TTUHSC maintains an active AI tool inventory.
656. Who is the executive sponsor for this AI adoption and enablement initiative? Is there a designated internal leader or steering committee responsible for driving AI enablement across TTUHSC (separate from the AI Governance and Risk Committee)? If so, what is their reporting structure and decision-making authority? Will the proposer report directly to this sponsor, or through another administrative channel?	- The Chief AI Transformation Officer is the executive sponsor. TTUHSC has an AI Steering Committee which is the oversight body of the effort. - The Contractor will coordinate with the Chief AI Transformation Officer, who is the executive sponsor, with oversight by the AI Steering Committee.
657. Beyond the provisioned enterprise AI tools, has TTUHSC conducted any AI pilot programs, proof-of-concept projects, or department-specific AI initiatives to date? If so, can TTUHSC share the outcomes,	Current AI utilization is isolated and low-complexity. TTUHSC conducted some AI baseline surveys in 2025 and 2026 and maintains an active AI tool inventory. Available inputs and lessons learned will be shared with the selected Contractor.

lessons learned, and any use cases that have been validated or deprecated? This information will help proposers avoid duplicating prior efforts and build on existing momentum.	
658. Given that TTUHSC spans five regional campuses (Lubbock, Amarillo, Abilene, Dallas/Fort Worth, Permian Basin) and 108 counties, does TTUHSC envision the workforce upskilling, leadership activation, and workflow automation scope being executed simultaneously across all campuses, or is there a preferred phased rollout model (e.g., piloting with Lubbock campus administrative units before expanding to regional clinical campuses)?	• A phased rollout may be proposed; the Proposer may recommend sequencing (e.g., piloting before enterprise-wide expansion). The initial kickoff is preferred on all campuses and the leadership enablement meeting on-site in Lubbock; overall, a hybrid model is preferred.